



SCIENTIFIC ENLIGHTENMENT

(unedited manuscript)

**SCIENTIFIC ENLIGHTENMENT
(1.0)**

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PREFACE

Why talk about something when you can simply do it? At least, that's what I always used to think, before it became clear that 'doing it' in this instance was going to involve more than one person. Consequently, sharing what I was working on was never a big focus in the beginning, only occasionally would I raise my head to explain what I was doing to somebody who happened to stumble past.

In this context, what you see here is just an early prototype in a sense, one of many. Following my first attempt – Organic Psychology (OP) – which was apparently too impenetrable for the few who got to read it, this one was intended to be a more casual breakdown. The idea was to provide a broader context than OP, and more focus on where it all lands, which in OP was still being ruminated upon. But this remains basically the same story, with the same essential bones and subject matter, so some elements are effectively repeated here, albeit in slightly different language.

However, things have moved on significantly even since this one was written, as you will see at 2EQ.org. An entirely new approach has now been adopted, something of a reshuffling of the deck, so to speak, with communicating this story having now become the main event - with this the onus to extract any practical applications now being securely passed over to the collective where that aspect rightly belongs. That part is a team game by definition.

This book is the last of the original heavyweights, and remains the best of the many 'old school' attempts I made. Even with all the added context, and the stripping down, this work still seems somewhat more accessible than OP, and more balanced as a good all-rounder for capturing in a single volume the essential structure of a paradigm that has since come to be known as 2EQ.

H.R.

INTRODUCTION

The Heart of Philosophy

It's true – nobody cares about philosophy anymore. It's all considered just so much dry and abstract bullshit, perpetuated by egg-headed academics who appear more interested in talking about life than actually living it. And maybe, in some cases at least, this is true.

So what real relevance does philosophy have in today's changing world? Why would it help me to consciously adopt a philosophy, or – even more seriously – to construct one of my own?

To which the answer is this: you don't actually have a choice. Even in daily life we are already all philosophers in the original sense of the word. You may not recognize yourself as such, but this is only because whatever views you hold have been acquired by default, and because almost everybody around you shares them with you.

Fortunately for you there were others who went before you, and charted the way. What we know as common culture is, in some essential sense, simply a record of humanity's entire search for wisdom. It is a kind of knowledge bank, a collective inheritance passed down, into which countless people have deposited their own small and hard won advancements in understanding and knowledge. And whilst nowadays we see the division of human understanding into many specialised fields of enquiry, the whole event nevertheless remains a single and unified one by virtue of its transcendent purpose. And this is what I will seek to return to here, for this unifying heart of philosophy has been almost forgotten.

So whilst you may even believe that you embody no philosophy at all, what this really means is that you simply haven't ever thought about it enough to acquire any perspective different to the norm for your particular place in history and culture. Because a philosophy is mandatory. It comes with the question, with the problem, with simply being human.

In its most essential form it is simply the way we view life. We all have very sophisticated and highly developed philosophies – the views and strategies by which we understand and navigate life towards greater happiness and fulfilment – regardless of whether we are aware of it or not; views which always contain some very basic and important assumptions, and which ultimately determine nearly everything in our life. To have never examined these assumptions does not prevent them from performing their important function, it is just a little embarrassing perhaps.

So when we say that we are not philosophers, all we are really saying is that we are probably not very good ones. Because even to claim no philosophy at all is itself still a form of philosophy, at least in the true sense of the word. All this means is that you have chosen to let go of the helm and sail aimlessly, wherever the wind of culture happens to blow you. But ignorance does not diminish responsibility, we are all at sea nevertheless, with all the promise and danger that implies.

This work, then, is not for those timid souls who simply want more of the same; to further confirm what they already believe to be true. I will not attempt to wring even one more ounce of insight out of the well used and well spent view of life we already assume. All significant insights require a new basic framework, an entirely new foundational view, a new chassis upon which to build. This will be a radical divergence, then, an adventure into the very heart of life, and it will – as you will see – demand tremendous courage. It is only for those who are seeking perspicacious insight into the most fundamental reality of their situation, so its purpose is not to console or placate. It is to finally throw hard light on the most elusive yet significant issue we are confronting. And it is, most certainly, not for the faint of heart or the weak of mind - if only because it involves a journey into the very heart of our suffering, which will feel like looking at yourself in a very fierce and unflattering mirror.

A basic observation underlying this work is that the facade of 'togetherness' most people uphold is just that – a facade. And that beneath this we all struggle with a smouldering dilemma we cannot fully explain or even define. We are broken, troubled, and we can't even really figure out why. But we are not all honest about that fact. And whilst we are all equally bound by this same predicament - and I believe you will see that we are - we are not all facing it with equal openness. There are many who are so scared or defeated by their quiet inner torment that their response to it is simple denial. They imagine that if they simply ignore it, and never expose it

to others, that it will just shrivel up and go away. But it would seem life is not always that easy. Others, in a similar gesture, take the stance of claiming to have the answer to this simmering disquiet. And do they? Well, when you see the nature of the issue at hand, I believe you will agree that they do not. Until a solution is found and made available, the only real difference is how you carry it. In particular, the only real difference between people is how honest and upfront they are about the problem. Meaning that people with all the answers are, in reality, very often not as smart as they are dishonest. Which might appear a bit harsh, but we have already been led astray far too many times here.

On the other hand, there are those who are prepared to say they don't know, who are open to the reality of their lives, and who often suffer for their courage. And it is easy to tell where somebody stands along this continuum, for the defining hallmark of these people in contrast to those suffering denial does not lie in the answers they claim to have, but in how developed their question is. Because they have – regardless of daring to confront the issues they face – not actually found the answers for reasons which will become clear as we proceed. Because those answers have been hidden from us. They have, however, in their honesty and humility, at least gained the opportunity to develop and refine exactly what the real question is. They have confronted and explored it, delved and quarried. And for this they may still feel frustrated, until they realise that the true answer – when it finally emerges – is only going to make sense to those who have had the courage to truly ask the question. So this is the courage I will seek to honour here.

The primary obstacle we will confront here, then, is the profound tendency toward the shallow. It requires energy and effort to penetrate beneath the sunny surface of life to examine the structures which support your own worldview, ensuring that a great many never bother. And the result is a kind of existential blindness, a pandemic of ignorance and confusion.

It could be said, then, that rather than being just another 'answer' to be either proven or accepted on faith, this work is instead a relentless pursuit of the question. Or at least, this is where we must begin. And I feel the need to warn you here, to at least indicate the kind of territory we are heading into, so I will begin with a metaphor:

The entire body of human understanding and knowledge we have acquired, in all its different forms, can be viewed like a tree. A decision tree of sorts – a tree of problems and answers. And the position we begin at, as a new emergent in culture, is not at the base of the trunk, but somewhere way out at the tip of a sprouting twig. The beliefs we hold and the stories we tell are like the leaves, and the branches are why we believe them. But most people never even see the branches. Like a fat frog on a lily pad, they just embrace their only leaf: Usually the one where they landed.

The game is to find the most warm and sunny leaf. And your first one may be a wonderful leaf, it may even be the best leaf on the tree. But the problem with this is that the perspectives we are at first bound to adopt are extremely parochial and narrow by definition. The problem is that whilst we might know what we believe, we may not have much understanding of why. We don't understand that we all begin by embodying a philosophy which is a branch off a branch off a branch off the main trunk of the whole tree of human understanding. And because we do not approach this position from the ground up, this blinkered state may not at first be obvious. We always begin at the fringes of understanding, with a kind of 'starter pack' provided by our immediate surroundings, and whilst this may immediately offer us some easy and readymade solutions to a few of life's issues, it does not necessarily prepare us for the job of gaining further understanding for ourselves, or even encourage us to do so. It is also a position which can, if held to, dramatically limit our capacity to appreciate the different possibilities alternative understandings of life may offer.

The view we first arrive at then, as we enter the society in which we are born, is like an internal version of a school uniform. There is a time when you are supposed to question such things, and grow out of them. There is a point where we are all offered a crucial transition, if we are willing to accept: to go from learning what to think, to learning how.

If we were to lay this tree out and chart our own personal understanding of life on it over time, we would generally see that personal understanding expands in a particular way. It can 'jump' from surface branch to surface branch in order to acquire mere knowledge, but if understanding is to be sought then it is bound to follow a different natural pattern, from the tip where it began, back down the twig, to the branch, and from there up the next branch to the next local tip, at which point what was previously only knowledge of the other tip becomes real understanding of it. The other tip then becomes another option for us to consider, rather than an alien perspective to be confronted or blindly embraced.

The healthy and unhindered progress of understanding does not stop there however, it continues without relent to expand and explore the entire territory of life. So that, as well as moving out toward all the tips which become available, it also moves inward toward the core, and in doing so becomes more and more inclusive. More branches become able to be accessed directly, not via distant observation, but through direct understanding - the point where a person with an extreme level of understanding may flood the entire structure with awareness, thus simultaneously freeing themselves of unconscious bias as well as availing themselves of a great many options. Conversely, a person may remain forever a twig level thinker, spending their entire life never questioning the narrow bounds of their historical context, and thus remain forever subject to both its assets and limitations.

Our own personal position, then, can be viewed both in terms of varying location in the canopy of this tree, and in terms of depth of penetration. In other words, both the sunny leaf you are currently selecting as your operating worldview, and how many alternatives you have truly examined. But what seems clear is that the further out toward the tips you remain limited in your understanding, the more enmeshed and unconscious you will be of your own local conditioning; the more a slave you are to the dictates of whatever culture you have been born into. And this is a situation which could be good or bad depending on the overall state of that culture, but the very fact that you have a belief system which you have swallowed whole rather than fully digesting means that you are far more likely to perceive irreconcilable difference between yourself and others of any other culture or philosophy. You remain fixed, rigid, and narrow in your stance. Ignorance fosters fear, and fear begets aggression. And all because your knowledge of other perspectives spans an ignorant void.

It is precisely across this kind of divide that wars of ideology are waged. A more penetrating view on the other hand tends to be somewhat more ductile and inclusive, and certainly far less territorial. Understanding makes tolerance unnecessary. Opposing views, with understanding, become alternative views – options to be considered and, if not taken, then for reasons you understand and can explain. And, most importantly, options which remain open to the influence of further understanding yet to be acquired.

It is probably already pretty clear that I am building a case here for expanding your awareness of life and yourself in the direction of understanding rather than mere knowledge, and for taking the time and effort required to think about things a bit before simply accepting them; for examining not only what you believe and stand for, but – more importantly – why. And what this means, in essence, is having the guts to leave your narrow confinement and expand your personal awareness, not only sideways to embrace other views besides your own, but most importantly inward toward the core of human understanding, ultimately reaching the point where all views become integrated into a seamless web of personal insight.

The most elementary thing, then, if you wish to truly understand the nature and implications of the possibilities we have to choose from, is to first transcend the philosophy we emerged within and out of - what I will call our Philosophy Of Origin (POO). True awareness is a journey into the heart of humanity, a search for the universal core of life which binds us all with a common thread. And I don't just mean human life, but all of life. It all begins with this.

It matters little what kind of POO we find ourselves in to begin with, we absolutely must transcend it in order to begin this great journey. And we do this – as was the battle cry of Plato – simply by questioning everything. And this happens firstly by capturing and defining the questions to which our historical POO is an answer, and then examining the evidence and the logic of it all.

This work, then, is ostensibly a journey back towards the trunk of this tree, but the point in this instance will not - as you might expect – be an exploration of the existing canopy. The basic orientation I am alluding to here, that of penetration and transcendence, is simply a necessary prerequisite to what I am really going to be leading you toward.

This work is not a compression or synthesis of historical perspectives on life. And although the essential tenets of many of those branches will probably become clear along the way as we pass their junction points, I am not going to be stopping to explore them. This is not about offering a view of the whole tree, or some grand synthesis of the entire canopy into one integrated field. If that is what you are seeking, and I would certainly encourage it, I would suggest you begin with Ken Wilber.

Presuming you have such under your belt, then, the point of this work is not to further acquaint you with that which is already known, but to prepare you for something completely unexpected. Something massive, something secret even.

What I am aiming for is not a comparative view then, but a new emergence. So not span, but new depth.

In the end, what will be delivered here will be a fundamental rethink of the entire situation we face, it is something entirely new. It is, ultimately, a fundamental divergence from the way we have tended to view ourselves and life in general. And penetration is key here, because you cannot simply jump to this new position at the shallow level of the canopy, it is not something to simply be accepted. The implications are just too great for that. For this new emergence is not just another branch, but more like another whole tree. It effectively means climbing down from the current tree, walking for a bit, and climbing up another whole tree entirely. It is a possibility so profound that nobody ever seems to have considered it, but also dramatic enough to mean that there is no point attempting to understand it from any shallow perspective, or to try to make sense of it from any 'twiggy' point of view.

You simply cannot put this alternative tree on the end of your narrow and limited twig of understanding without something going awry, without somehow missing the point. It simply won't take the load, and won't make any sense.

So, to understand the nature and implications of what I will be defining in this work requires a comprehensive reconsideration of the tree itself, of the whole structure, and a fresh grasp on the problems it is all seeking to solve. It requires a fundamental level of enquiry, and profound consideration.

In the end, such conscious penetration requires considerable effort, so it will disturb you greatly if what you are seeking here is something that is going to fit nicely within your current frame of reference, and therefore will not be accessible to everybody. Thus, as mentioned, not for the weak of mind.

This also means, and it is worth noting: to walk this path is in some sense to cut strongly across the grain of common culture.

Something well worth considering, then, in relation to this penetrative approach, is that this general orientation is not fostered by common culture. And this is because the kind of shallow penetration which results from lazy thinking and social conformity bodes very well for a certain kind of blunt social cohesion, and a false sense of emotional security. So the great majority of people simply feel their way to the most comfortable point of their local branch, and stay there for the rest of their lives.

People in this shallow state inevitably tend to borrow most of their thinking from others. They simply accept standard answers from the culture they 'belong to' without ever really even knowing the questions, and as a result they all end up behaving like a single giant organism.

Not really knowing how to think for themselves, they just think what everybody else thinks, and can thus be led around like a flock of sheep. This also makes this state somewhat attractive to those in any seats of power. And this is perhaps why shallow penetration is subtly yet pervasively promoted, especially when confronted with opposing groups with similar levels of ignorance. Ignorance makes people predictable, it makes them easy to control and coerce. It also seems that the less energy people put into establishing and maintaining good belief systems, the more energy they put into holding onto the unexamined beliefs they already hold. Meaning that the less examined or inclusive a point of view, the more likely it is to be confused with identity and defended with great force.

It is a strange and often under recognized fact that those who spend the greatest of time questioning and examining what they believe – and who therefore tend to adopt much more rounded and balanced perspectives – tend to hold those views with much less certainty than those who never bother to question anything at all. Whereas those who do not take the time and energy to penetrate life tend to put the energy this would demand into simply holding more firmly to their less examined beliefs – as well as into defending others who hold the same view. We all know this, I suppose: that POO tends to stick together.

Fanaticism then, is a common disease of the twig, a symptom of the shallow. Something we consciously tend to abhor. However, when somebody - or some country - starts throwing POO, we generally like to have plenty of

POO to throw back. Patriotism, nationalism, any kind of exclusive membership mentality, is generally planted and grown in POO. It is all an unfortunate consequence of what I have come to call the 'dominance of the lower' – that it only takes one bully to lower the tenor of all playground politics; that the lower tends to reduce everything to its own level. In contrast, deeper understanding tends toward more refined and harmonious relationships, involving more subtle approaches to conflict resolution and mutual fulfilment. But this is also an approach which requires a less armoured stance, and this makes it more easily disturbed. It is a sad fact: it only takes one person with a broken bottle to stop a hundred people dancing, but the reverse cannot be said. In this universe anyway, the lower always holds sway.

Shallow culture, then, as I am defining it here, is at least partly a natural consequence of a search for general social cohesion in the presence of very real threats, both present and historical. I suppose as a society we still need to carry a blunt object because there are still bullies in the global playground. We need a level of society we can mobilise and dictate to without too much dialogue or force, against similar cultures when they turn against us. But the very unfortunate outcome of this is that we end up fostering a culture which doesn't ask too many questions, and sooner or later it must be realised - that most conflicts come down to this: My POO is better than your POO, and that these arguments themselves are very often ridiculous events caused by the very blunt objects we use to defend them. POO is, by definition, not ever an inclusive answer, no matter where it is sourced. It has no penetration, and therefore no power to grapple with or solve any real problems. It is always merely a reflection of socially enforced ignorance, like a kind of culturally transmitted mental callous on the knuckle of humanity's right fist, a fist it only uses to thump itself.

What makes all this relevant here is the fact that in adopting the penetrative approach it means we are bound to confront whatever forces generally oppose such. And there are a few. Just like the sap pressing outward toward the tips of this great tree of understanding there is a strong social current we must push against if we are to gain the kind of penetration required to get to the heart of what matters in life.

If you want true insight, then, you are in for a hard swim against the current of common culture. But this pressure does not only come from culture. Learning to think is not about what to think, but how. And critical insight is not only demanding, but also has other consequences - you must be prepared to stand apart if necessary, from all the sheep. There are deep emotional components. Einstein was no towering intellect by ordinary measurable standards, leaving his achievements somewhat enigmatic. Until you realise that when discussing not knowledge but understanding, the issue at hand is not brains necessarily, but more often courage and commitment. So in the end they kept and measured his brain looking for clues, when perhaps they should have been measuring his heart.

True philosophers, then, as I am defining such here, are not necessarily those who have the answers, but those who have taken the time to ask the important questions - and who therefore have not just fixed knowledge, but dynamic understanding.

The point is that the intellectual tools required for acquiring deeper understanding are very different to those needed to merely hold onto and assert whatever knowledge you may have been given by others. And if you do not have those tools, or cannot intellectually or emotionally afford them, then attempting such a journey is obviously going to be somewhat futile. Which explains why this is most certainly the path less travelled.

Daunting, then? The whole prospect of this penetration? Perhaps, but with every cost there is a commensurate gain. For instance, as you penetrate toward the trunk of this great tree the more weight each thicker branch is carrying. This means that the options you have in answering the question that branch represents are many. But the questions themselves become simpler. The whole structure becomes simpler as you make your way in, and it also becomes more personal, which is not what most people expect.

What does 'more personal' mean?

Most people have a vague appreciation of philosophy being abstract and dry, like old dead wood. And this is entirely understandable given that most of the philosophies they have ever encountered were probably exactly that – old dead wood. They tend to collect and keep this dead wood in special storage facilities called 'universities'. But a true philosophy is a living process, it is a dynamic and evolving event. And the heart of true philosophy, whilst it may be burdened and troubled, is not dead. It still beats strong. It pushes forward ceaselessly, searching for something it has not been able to define, but it pushes on regardless, for it is not out there somewhere in the dissociated world of objects and others, or in some book somewhere.

The true heart of philosophy – is your heart. Your very own. The questions it addresses are none other than your own questions, your real questions, direct and practical questions, about issues which lie at the very core of your own life. And I mean your real life, not some abstract idea of life. The subject of true philosophy is YOU, it is entirely connected to and driven by your own search for greater happiness and fulfilment, or whatever words you may use to define your own deepest aspirations.

In essence, this is all true philosophy is. It is all an extension of one basic question: what is happiness, and where might it be found? And it is yours. It is for you, in you, and by you.

The entire search for human understanding can ultimately be boiled down to simply this. And without any relevance to this, philosophy becomes a kind of hollow and redundant intellectual masturbation. Meaning that even if something is ‘true’, if it has no direct and practical value in the real process of living, then it is - in my opinion - not part of a living philosophy. It is dead.

This living connection must always be able to be demonstrated. All branches of the tree lead back to the same issue or subject, and that subject, the root of the tree - is you.

So it is here that I am forced to disclose my hand, and in the process lay down the gauntlet. We need to reclaim this great challenge from the grip of the so-called philosophers, from the scientists, from the priests and politicians – from all those we charge with the responsibility of charting the territory of life for us, and with bringing to us our maps, because they have all grievously failed us.

All the collected wisdom of the ages can be seen expressed as the culture around us, particularly in the form of deep and pervasive mythologies. These are our great stories, narratives which generate meaning and context for our lives, and within which we can place ourselves in order to give our lives some perspective...stories we tell ourselves more often than we tell others.

These stories embody our living philosophies, they light our way, and within this narrow illumination we chart the way forward. The entire human search for knowledge and understanding can be seen within this context, especially the elements deemed worthy of collection and transmission within the institution of culture. It is all about you, you are the Rome to which all these roads should ultimately lead.

And this is my point here – that question, the underlying unity which defines the entire quest for human understanding, has not gone away. It has simply been forgotten, swept aside, pushed under, because it has not been answered. For common culture it actually remains a great source of embarrassment. In many ways, common culture has actually become a flight from the question itself.

The important thing is that the maps we have available to us – as presented by our culture – are supposed to be a summary distillation of everything we individually need to know about how to live a good and fulfilled life. They are supposed to be balanced, simple enough to grasp and use in practical terms, yet powerful enough to at least capture the most important issues we will face on that journey. And here is my point – they obviously should never omit any of the most significant landmarks.

Here we can begin to see just how lost we have become, and how roundly failed we have been by those we have trusted with the resources we have afforded them. Why do I believe this? Surely we have been delivered more than enough, perhaps not by any traditional point of view, but certainly by science? But this is simply not the case.

Please don't get me wrong here, however, I believe in the power of science to light the way. In fact I hold it in such high esteem that I am enraged to have been so let down. And you will find this disappointment repeated throughout my works, because I grew up around scientists, and I find it completely reprehensible that what I will be seeking to bring to light here has been so profoundly overlooked. It is a very deep failure on their part, as I believe time will tell. And it is not that they have not been smart enough, or that they have not had the tools. It seems to me that they have simply been too scared, and that the entire structure and culture of the scientific community seems to only encourage that fear rather than diminish it.

I am obviously laying out a significant challenge for myself here, but it's really not that hard to point out the enormous gaping holes in our general appreciation of life, as given to us by common culture. And I'm not talking minor details here, let's start at the top –

What is the single biggest question in life?

The interesting thing about this question is that it immediately sets our mind off like a dog looking for the biggest bone in the garden, and that we expect to see it again any moment – for of course, we know the answer to this. Of course we do! But the disconcerting reality is that it doesn't return.

You are supposed to know this. Of all the responsibilities carried by those you have invested with your trust, this is the one thing they are supposed to deliver to you, before anything else. And you don't know the answer.

It is not your fault, they have simply failed you. And the reason our culture avoids this question, is precisely because it does not know the answer. And bear in mind, the answer is simply another question, it is not even the answer to that question, whatever that may be.

So let us at least begin here, with the bursting of this bubble – You do not have a living philosophy until you can at least answer this first question.

The answer to this question is actually the same as the question itself. You must think I'm kidding. But it's obvious really. This is the elementary trunk of the great tree of understanding. And it doesn't really mean much in this self enclosing purity, but it's worth knowing it nevertheless. This is where it all begins.

So that's really not much use to us, except as the correct place to begin. But how do we make that useful somehow, how do we refine it down and extract something practical? In other words, after learning this on our first day at school, what should we have learned on the second day?

Which, in my school anyway, would be this elementary refinement: Who's asking?

Human society is, before it is anything else, ultimately a group of individuals. So if all human efforts to acquire understanding are ultimately for the benefit of the individual, then the answer to this first great question must be confined to only what is relevant and useful to that individual.

In other words – I only have a small brain, and inhabit an enormous universe of complexity, so if it doesn't affect me, I don't need to know about it!

It is logically inconsistent that the single most important thing for me to know might be something practically irrelevant to me. The sole and only point of any individual's acquisition of understanding is to benefit their own capacity to live in accord with the implicit goal of life as they themselves define it – which in our case, is generally presumed to be what we call 'happiness'.

We are told by science that truly 'objective' knowledge is the only valuable kind, but this presumes a truly objective end user, and no such thing exists. Thereby, we are often completely missing the most important point about the ultimate subject of our enquiries.

So here we have our first narrowing down of this great flitch: the answer to the first most important question in life must be something directly relevant and useful to whoever is asking it.

The greatest single question, then, as it relates to us, is not the pursuit of universal truth, unless it happens to ultimately converge and be indistinguishable from this –

Of everything it would ever be possible to know, what is the single most important thing to know about being human, and about being happy?

So there you have it. This question is the practical summit, the Everest of all the inner mountains we have to climb. This is the mighty trunk of the entire tree of human understanding. And here you thought it was going to take the rest of the book to get that far down from the canopy. But no, we don't have time for that. So here you are, this is bedrock. That's all there is to it.

The entire mobile of whatever understanding we ever acquire must – if it is to be at all grounded and relevant – hang from this single point.

An obvious and immediate ancillary to this question is whether or not, at this point in our history, we already know the answer to this? What might a culture look like, then, if it had not answered such an important question? Surely that would have negative implications?

To which anyone who is even half a brain might be tempted to say – look around!

You'll now have to decide what's more disturbing, the fact that you don't know the answer to this question, or the fact that you've never even actually asked it! Or maybe you have, and good on you if so.

What you are looking at here is just a sign post, then, not a destination in itself. But it is an important one. It is THE important one perhaps. Because whilst it is just an arrow, it is – in particular – the arrow which points to the single biggest beast in the entire jungle of potential human understanding. And what makes this great mammoth so important, is that if we don't know the answer to this question, if we have never actually caught one, then we technically don't know even the first thing about living.

So I need to clarify just what it is that we are talking about here. In terms of our quest for knowledge, life represents a kind of territory to explore and master, every peak of potential understanding in that territory bringing with it progress and relief from suffering. The higher the peak, the greater the progress, because these are the terms we are addressing in this instance. So what we are talking about here is the very highest peak of all time, the most significant single advancement we as a species ever stand to make. This question is basically the Everest of philosophy.

In the finite and limited landscape of the Earth there are many high peaks, but there is only one highest. And prior to that ascent in 1953, we as a species had not yet gone as high as we would ever go – but after that, we had. Never again could anyone surpass this mark, for the territory simply does not allow for it. And anyone who followed even to equal that mark would never really do so, for they would always be doing so in the full certainty that what they were seeking to achieve was actually possible.

Therefore that ascent represented one of those rare thresholds which once crossed can never be uncrossed, or crossed again. It was inimitable, and therefore prone to legend and myth, because in some sense – like the first steps on the moon – it belonged to all humanity.

It is interesting to consider, then, in the context of the highest peak of understanding we are discussing here, that the same thing can be said. And also to ask the question: Are we already in possession of such knowledge, or is it yet to come? Have we already crossed that threshold, or does the very highest peak still remain ahead of us? Is it back there somewhere, or yet to come?

No other single question holds so much hope and dread in its balance, for if this point has indeed been passed, then we can perhaps look forward to a somewhat bleak future. But if it, or any other high peaks for that matter, do yet remain elusive and unconquered, then to that exact degree there is ground for much hope. And this is why philosophy is still so important – because it alone contains all the gear necessary for such an elevated ascent.

Therefore, I am wiping away cobwebs here, dusting this old sign off. I believe that at present we do not even have a firm grip on this question, let alone any answer to it. And that the result of this ignorance is what we see as common culture. We are lost, and it shows.

Maybe this question has even been lost to time precisely because it is the source of such great embarrassment, not because it has already been cracked. And this is important in the context of what I am going to be addressing in this work because it's the one they don't talk about, the one that science has turned its back on, the one that we are all led away from just in case we ask it in public and cause a blind panic. Because our culture does not presently contain a sustainable answer to this question, and to realise this is to set ourselves adrift on a sea of angst. So we tend to avoid it like the plague.

This is obviously pretty bold talk. You can't in all fairness make such a claim without in the same breath also offering some kind of proof. Indeed, anyone who makes such a statement in the company of scientists had better

have some kind of elephant in their pocket. And yes, we'll get to that. But my point here is actually higher than this. As true today as it was in the Pleistocene age, hunting mammoths is a team sport by necessity. Regardless of whatever I deliver here, or its merits, we must still reawaken the quest, and never again surrender it.

In particular, as indicated above, science is failing us. On the fringes of ancient mariners charts lay a solemn warning – 'here be beasts'. Which now seems more than a little hysterical given what we know about geography and sea travel. But so it remains today with science, in relation to the last great frontier – human subjectivity.

Regardless of their inability to be empirically proved, subjective phenomena are nevertheless very real, if only by indirect effect. But even experientially they cannot be taken as unreal, because of their relevance to the very purpose of all scientific enquiry – people.

Who is science for, if not for people? It has to be recognized that in many senses – for the individual experiencing them – subjective experience is even more real than objective phenomena.

How can it possibly be considered unimportant? It is people who embody the very purpose of the entire human quest for understanding. We have ignored subjective phenomena for far too long.

The point is - these questions are too big for any individual to bring in alone. The mammoth has been hiding from us in the only place it knows we won't look. And if anything is the answer here, it is science.

When scientists finally decide to enter this particular race, the real game will begin. Which might make it sound like I am shunning science, but I am not. A new science is needed, that is all, one which addresses subjective phenomena with subjective methods, and which delivers subjective technologies. There is an opportunity here for scientists to redeem themselves, and win back the vast majority of hearts and minds which have rightly fled the barren lands of scientific objectivity in favour of patently absurd perspectives – but ones which at least address their true concerns and experiences with some degree of bearing.

Science has missed people, and is missing people, precisely because it has failed to address and capture the central issue people are confronting in their lives, and it has done so almost completely. And all, as Thomas Kuhn so eloquently summarised in 'The Structure of Scientific Revolutions', because of academic fear. But if the quest demands we go into dark and murky waters after the only one that really matters, then it is time for one last experiment before you leave your lab – it is time to test your mettle.

The challenge facing science, then? If people look to you for guidance, then you are a mapmaker. You have responsibilities to uphold, one in particular, and people are watching you. What you are doing is part of a greater quest. Remember who you are working for, and what the real question is. You are obliged to start at the top, with the most important features of the map.

Until you have done this, you are not free to diverge from that path. There is really no point filling in some tiny detail out on the fringes of relevant understanding if the headlines have not been outlined. Even people raised on science, who believe in science, are sick to death of scientists wandering back into the village with brightly coloured birds that actually have no meat on them, watching as they try to squeeze even one significant practical implication out of them, in terms that impact on the actual process of their lives.

Where have all the scientific heroes gone? We must rediscover the true ground of unity, of power, and of hope – and that is to remember the goal, the objective, the singular and only destination.

We need to recover the purpose, the original face of our whole quest for understanding.

We need to bring back to the fore the forgotten Holy Grail of all human knowledge, and to thereby relight the transcendent beacon for those who lead us, to show them the way, so that they can in turn show us the way.

We all need to remind scientists what it is they are ultimately looking for, because without this they are lost, and destined to wander aimlessly in the wilderness forever. The amount of useless or irrelevant knowledge we could accumulate is actually without limit. Scientists should not be spending time answering questions that only scientists ask.

That beacon, that ground, is the individual and what troubles them. It is, once again - you. So if whatever map is ultimately delivered ends up useless or inaccessible to the common individual, or if it has missed any of the very highest peaks, then it has fallen short. It is even tempting to say that it is essentially worthless regardless of how beautiful it is, or how true, because the very purpose for which it exists was not actually addressed.

But what if the common individual is not capable of understanding the answer to this most important question? In that case we would need science even more: to translate and to bridge this gap with emergent technology. More people like Carl Sagan, who was always prepared to make the pilgrimage back from the frontier and deliver great feasts in the market square. He understood who he was working for. That is perhaps all that made him different.

The question is not whether what you are doing is important, it is whether it is the most important thing you could be doing, as defined by the needs of those you serve. As a scientist, failure to make this connection, and to demonstrate it, is corruption. It is to disown the transcendent quest, and ultimately to be disowned by it. It is open betrayal.

So it all starts here –

What is the question you are asking, what is the nature of the problem you are trying to solve?

Of everything it would ever be possible to know, what is the single most important thing to know about being human, and about being happy?

In other words - When we look back in a thousand years, from the year 3000, when we know everything significant there is to ever know about life, and ask the question - *'what was the single greatest advancement in human understanding we ever made'* – what will the answer be?

You don't know?

This is philosophy, then. You now have what you need to begin this journey, and to start to understand what success in that might mean. It is to be prepared to ask the really big questions, and to go after the really big answers, no matter where that journey may lead you.

Never forget, however, and do not let any degree of complexity blind you from the simplicity of the purpose of this quest. All contributions to collective human knowledge must and can only be judged according to their ability to be accessed by the common individual as part of a working worldview, or by the power of those views to address the most central concerns of that individual at the deepest level.

This is the target of our quest. And for success in such a game to be seen as meaningless by you is simply absurd. The degree of impact such an answer ends up having in your life is precisely what defines it as being the apex question. So if this peak does remain as yet unconquered at this point in time, then the achievement of such will undoubtedly change your life, and the life of everyone you know.

PART ONE

Homo libera

I have to start off with a warning of sorts, and try to somehow prepare you for the scope and depth of what I will seek to outline here.

What follows is a ludicrous idea! It is staggering in its implications if it is basically accurate. And I will do what I can to indicate those implications once the basic structure is laid out, because they are an important part of this – what it is may well be significant, but what it means for the individual and for the world might be something else again. So I will start here with the basic context, then the structure of the idea itself, and then outline just a couple of its obvious implications.

The context is about as broad and deep as is possible, so deep we do not tend to ask questions at this level as a result of them being considered somewhat grandiose and overly ambitious. Actually, as already ventured, this appears to land squarely in the realm of ‘holy grails’, but this was not intentional, the idea itself appeared long before its ultimate context or implications became clear, based solely on logical extensions of another idea altogether.

So how big is it, how deep? This is the bit I hate, but there is no choice here. It is always embarrassing to begin with, but I will do what I can to validate and explain this context in the following content.

Consider all the questions that might ever be asked. I mean, pull out the stops.

What are the really massive and overarching dilemmas we face at this time?

In an enclosed ecological system, one species has gained an almost overnight strategic advantage over its cousins in the great tree of emerging and competing life, and has proceeded to dominate all other species. It did this, broadly speaking, by its capacity for imagination, and all the things that result from such (tool making, language, culture, a capacity to change the environment rather than be changed by it...etc). And as a result of an apparently unstoppable process of expansion, their own success has quickly become the greatest threat to their survival, as population and consumption and pollution begin to rapidly exceed any environmental capacity.

Can you argue with this basic summary?

My point here is not to point a finger at the human species as selfish or greedy, but rather to lay the foundations for understanding just how natural what we now see may really be. And that, in the right circumstances, the very same ‘selfish’ forces may now become our greatest asset.

My assumption is that every species, if it could, would take over the world. The only thing that made us different was that we got the chance to do that. Other species are not somehow ecologically benevolent in a way we are not, as vegans may imagine, they are simply restrained by forces they cannot overcome.

Imagination emerged as part of an evolutionary arms race. The universe is a violent place, how quickly we forget. We got a lucky break, in the form of a serendipitous convergence of certain functional potentials which at some point combined to produce an emergent ‘leap’ – one which has resulted in a dramatically increased capacity to ‘simulate reality’ (future probabilities in particular) in a way other organisms cannot do, but one which has also resulted in one very negative and overlooked outcome.

This overlooked event will be the subject here. But before we get to that we need to establish the context a bit more clearly, and some of the questions it may begin to answer.

We have been left in something of a dilemma. Where we might now fit, in ecological terms, in order to find some sustainable balance is clearly not where we once did. We left a stable and balanced position in a very well regulated ecosystem, and have not yet found another stable alternative. We have usurped our position in the great chain of being, effectively eliminating all organisms above us in the pecking order, and enslaving all the rest below. All of which leaves us with something of a quandary when it comes to considering our rightful place,

or even considering in what context such questions should be framed. And please bear in mind that ecology is not actually the subject matter of what follows, so all of this is not the point – just the background. And we may come back to our place in the greater scheme later as we pass a couple of milestones that roundly answer this, as ambitious as that sounds, but that is not actually our target here. That is just a sideshow, or at least a downstream effect of a much more significant or fundamental problem at last finding a permanent and stable solution.

This deeper problem is our goal. I am just indicating how big it is, and the level of the problems it will directly resolve – its basic magnitude as a potential solution.

Let's be more direct, then, and begin to box it in, starting with what you already know very well: Look around.

What you see, everything you see, is a result of only two things – natural universal processes, and human influence. Of course you will immediately respond to this distinction with the assertion that it is shallow and ultimately false, and I agree as you will see below. Of course we are ourselves a part of natural processes unfolding. But for now I will draw this distinction so as to begin to isolate and define one very important event that – whilst it may be natural – is most certainly at odds with the overall evolutionary symmetry that produced it. And this event occurs only in humans, it seems, or at least only humans have the capacity to inflict its negative effects on the environment in ways that make it extremely meaningful.

The 'natural universal processes' indicated really require no introduction, and cannot – for the most part – be affected or controlled. The natural processes of cosmological unfolding, ecological development etc, are what produced the whole game we are playing, and set the basic framework within which all of our discussions occur.

Of course we can damage or influence natural processes, but we did not produce them. Indeed, even though we have now gained the power to screw them up, they remain largely beyond our comprehension in their level of depth and intricate sophistication.

'Human influence' is more relevant, if only because it has become the dominant ecological factor, and because (we imagine) we can control it. Which together make it very important, and this is no doubt why we spend so much time discussing such. But I am going to make a very simple connection here, and one which goes some way to undermining the basic premise of such optimistic assertions as 'being in control'. I don't believe we are in control, not in the way we imagine.

That connection is very simple – The human collective is merely a group of human individuals. It is a river into which 6B tributaries flow. And if those tributaries are polluted, then it is effectively impossible to remove that pollution at the last minute, as it flows into the sea. You can dam that river, but ultimately what goes in one end will eventually come out the other.

It is as simple as this: What we see as our affects on the enclosed and limited biosphere, and the ecosystems which support it, are not the result of any 'mass', but the direct result of a single individual – you.

No I am not being unfair here, I am simply using you to illustrate a point. I could choose any individual, because they are all the same in one essential sense. And that sense is this – all organisms, humans included, will strive to be happy. By happy I mean that they will strive to move away from tension and towards ease. They will move away from pain and towards pleasure. They will seek to fulfil their 'desires' or the equivalent thereof, and move away from their 'aversions'. This is universal. It cannot be controlled. The expression may be blocked by force, but not the origination. Once again, like a river – what goes in one end will eventually come out the other end.

The world as we see it today is, in this sense, an organic unfolding. We imagine we are in control of it, but it actually emerges and develops along organisational pathways determined largely by random and local transient influences. Most development occurs outside and beyond the control of government as we recognize such. It is growing like a crystal does in a solution, following an inherent matrix the solution defines, but with no ultimate plan or predetermined structure.

So what is the ultimate source of that matrix or pattern? Where is that development heading, and what does govern it?

That pattern was once an embedded symmetry defined by the fluid and self balancing processes of ecological diversity, but this music has been largely silenced or at least subsumed. The pattern of life as a whole has been

lost. The new pattern now comes directly from individual human desire and aversion at the base, and feeds into natural hierarchies in the way power is distributed. And the people at the top of that pecking order are not malicious, it is just their privilege that makes them responsible, and they are simply responding naturally to the forces they are confronted with. The entire world is morphing out of control in search of solutions to just one driving force: What people want.

The world as it has been, as it is, and as it will be, is simply and always and only a direct reflection of what a group of individual people desire, or the result of what they want being frustrated.

This is what drives and also defines 'progress', this is what presses change forward, this is what determines what happens and what doesn't happen. All geopolitical events simply reflect this underlying momentum.

It is not much different to ten kids in the playground fighting over five sausage rolls. This fight is not being caused by the food, but by the underlying hunger. And what I am trying to point out here is that this cannot be changed. What people want is fixed. Any individual person's relationship to what they desire may vary, and they may ultimately compromise as a result of scarcity etc, but the basic underlying forces which drive the formation of desire are essentially fixed. Given the chance to explore full expression, they will, if not tempered by moral considerations, eventually stabilise only at a level of consumption well beyond what most people presently display. And further to this, they will be no happier than most people are now. Which is very strange but statistically reliable.

This has been well documented in research on lotto winners, and through happiness in relation to various income demographics. Given no limitations, the typical human organism will move toward significantly more consumption, but will not find significantly more happiness as a result. Not beyond a certain point.

This is the foundation then. Think about it in purely systemic terms, as a cause and effect reaction. Individual people presently want more than they have, and what people want is now the defining force of change on Earth. Which means we have to prevent people from having what they want over time, if we ever hope to curb the impact of such high levels of consumption in a limited environment. We are not trying to push people back the other way, and this is where all our troubles are going to be coming from soon.

Building on this basic foundation, we now have to note the most obvious and unfortunate feature of human culture as it relates to this underlying driver: namely that controlling people is no longer allowed. And I am not saying it should be, I am simply making the point, and stating a fact. Democracy has enshrined it as a fundamental axiom around which civilization is based. And this is why you so seldom see it even discussed, because it is considered sacrosanct.

Which is strange in a sense, because even in this brief outline we already see the roots of our emerging problems, at least as they are reflected collectively and ecologically.

The problem is this: to be happy is considered a fundamental right. The freedom to be happy, within socially acceptable bounds, is fundamental to the way we have come to understand almost everything we do. It is the reason for the reason.

Basically, to be allowed to have what you want is considered and upheld as a most basic human right. And the only clause in this contract seems to be this - as you do follow this recipe, you must not ever prevent others from doing the same, which is obviously not a limitation on its impact, but a further extension of such.

This underlying driver is actually so overwhelmingly embraced that we do not even notice it for the most part. It is not ever questioned. And I am not saying this is wrong, it may even turn out to be the answer here, but we will get to that.

My point at this stage is that it is a kind of blind spot, an a priori assumption that slips through the philosophical net using some kind of diplomatic immunity. And my only reason for bringing it forward here is that whilst it may not be addressed much in common culture, in pulling this most obvious fact into the light here we do gain a chance to begin to clearly formulate our overall dilemma in very simple yet powerful terms.

Which could be put in this way: What people want is the foundation of our collective structures, it forms a kind of fundamental equilibrium around which all collective efforts and developments occur.

Imagine an orange in a fruit bowl, you can push it up the side of the bowl if you have the energy to spend, but it will simply roll back down to the middle again and again because the structure of the situation defines that as the point of least tension. And the universe abhors tension. So it is all perfectly natural.

This equilibrium is what I want to draw your attention to here. This is the important thing to pick up at this stage.

In the simplest terms – because we live in a bounded ecological system – the individual **emotional equilibrium** (what people will naturally consume and contribute if they are not constrained) and the **ecological equilibrium** (what the planet will sustain over time) are **effectively opposed**. And this has been the case for some time, perhaps even for the entire time civilization has been emerging, but it has only recently become a pressing and unavoidable issue because we are now approaching a point where we are confronting a terminal threshold – basically because there are now so many of us. We got bigger, and the planet did not. And it never will. But we are not stopping.

Indeed, this is what I am saying above – we do not even know how to stop, we have no mechanisms in place for such. Because stopping means placing limits on people, and therefore on happiness, and that is against our agreed ‘rules’.

Bear in mind that in our discussions here we are viewing all this from a purely practical perspective, not really from the human position we are accustomed to viewing everything from, but rather from the perspective of the alien looking on and assessing how everything fits together to form some kind of harmonious and sustainable future outcome for the wider process of life that is the biosphere.

Imagine for a moment that we do not own this planet, but that we are servants, merely stewards of it. So what we are doing here is basically looking at the environmental effects of the individual, by the time they have, do, or be, whatever they need to be truly happy. Which is actually pretty simple.

So where does it stop?

Where does the typical person ultimately come to rest? As already indicated – if you ask this question truly, of any typical individual, you will find that they are basically already being held in some degree of disequilibrium – that they are being frustrated in many ways by forces beyond their control, and that if given the chance to express their desires truly and freely they would probably adopt a significantly more costly state over time.

What does this mean? Why is it important?

You only need to consider what would happen if everyone was free to suddenly do this. We simply can’t afford to all do that. It is just not possible.

In reality, what we already see is a degree of disequilibrium being imposed on the individual by the collective, which is basically selective oppression. But it is self-enforced oppression in this sense, and necessary for our own survival. We call this being poor. We are basically squabbling over scarce resources using rules that we have agreed upon for the most part (criminals apply different rules), and the result is what we see as social inequity. Which once again I am not decrying, this reflects the way nature arranges resources almost exactly – survival of the fittest etc. But in this case the traits required to be at the top of this pyramid are not selected by natural forces, and are not necessarily indicative of true virtue in any grounded sense. They are even somewhat arbitrary, tending to mostly cluster around those who do not threaten the status quo. And as a result we see great resources amassing in the hands of a very few who did not rise to their position on the basis of who might be best to govern such. It is generally the bully who gets all the sausage rolls, and who then decides who to give the leftovers to. The good kids, and the smart kids, can often go hungry.

So who is in control?? Here we see the nature of politics as it relates to this underlying force of emotional equilibrium in the individual. The most elementary reality of politics, or of self-organising any group of people, is that you can push any individual into disequilibrium up to a point, but that there are ultimately limits to such. There is only so far you can push an individual away from their natural point of equilibrium before they will react negatively and attack the collective or its representative. And here we see the other side of this coin: the dilemma of all those in government – that in such positions you are being asked to govern people towards what

is best for them, but that you cannot ever do so in a way which negatively affects their emotional state. Because if you do, you will be immediately ousted and replaced by a more compliant individual or governing structure - unless you have a lot of guns, and the populous you are governing don't.

How much simpler could it be? People struggle to get a handle on our greatest problems, but this is really all there is to it. It is concise and exact and conclusive, but we avoid it because it is apparently so intractable, and because it has such profound personal implications. We like problems we can solve, especially ones that do not have an impact on our own personal lives. Because civilised progress generally means movement towards the fulfilment of the desires of the individuals who ultimately define such progress. Which is, of course, us.

So if you want to know where we stand, it is not that hard to figure out. In fact it is so easy that our general unawareness of such immediately exposes just how much denial we are in. But it is pretty basic: we are slowly but surely increasing our capacity to securely fulfil our personal desires. Therefore, in a bounded environment, you need only ask how much an individual consumes when they are achieving optimum emotional fulfilment, and how many such units the biosphere will sustain. It is that simple.

How does it look, then? Through this simple lens we already see the burgeoning crisis in clear relief: in our explosive and unbridled boom we have suddenly spread to every corner of the planet, and have now reached a point where we are already consuming significantly more of available biological and environmental resources than our enclosed ecosystem will sustain, whilst simultaneously discharging more toxins than it will assimilate.

We are already on a crash course even now, and we have only just begun. And the forces driving such are not in the hands of the leaders as we constantly imagine, but rather in the hearts of the people. And the individuals are almost completely blind to the wider effects of their immediate actions and choices – the connections are simply too complicated to compute as they go about their myopic little lives, bouncing from one stimulated gratification to the next.

The situation defined above is already unsustainable, and it is a situation entirely and ultimately defined by a most unwelcome subject of attention – what you yourself want. And if this sounds a bit dire, now add to this what is about to occur. Consider that approximately half of the world's human population has been held in a state of artificial disequilibrium as a result of either poverty or dictatorship, but that by the middle of this century this pressure will be entirely released. And that is not far away. Then also add at least another 3B people, bringing the population peak to somewhere around 9B by 2100.

To put this in perspective, at present 20% of people consume about 80% of the resources available, and we are already beyond the sustainable threshold. But this is about to change dramatically. In less than a century that 'developed' 20% will grow to more like 80%, and that will be 80% of a population that has grown again by at least half.

It is not even that the emerging culture will be happier for it. Even the developed 20% at present still struggle to be happy, just as much as those in the developing world. They are by no means resting in some stable state, and would themselves consume even more if they could. In fact they are often still so dramatically unhappy that a large amount of their surplus resources go into drugs, alcohol or other stimulated distractions.

This is our situation. This is the underlying reality we are facing, in its most simple terms. So if you want to know what the future will look like, you need only answer this question: **how do you govern such?**

How can you possibly hold 9B people so far into emotional disequilibrium? How do you deal with 9B very unhappy people? You don't. You can only take their power away and impose control. You have to determine lives and limit behaviour and expression. There is no option. The situation is intractable, leaving only totalitarianism as the final outcome, with or without civil war in the interim.

It is this context that we do not generally apply when we consider our options. I don't know why, because it is so simple in essence, and so clockwork in its predictions. So if we are serious, then all roads lead here eventually. And the way we generally conceive of positive change must ultimately reflect this overriding context. Which it does. The way we generally view change, and all the glimmers of hope we do still find, pretty much boils down to one of two things, or a combination of these two –

1. Finding some way of allowing people to be happy with less.

2. Finding some way of making sure what people do consume has less negative impact.

Importantly - Both of these are also generally conceived as developmental events. They are both expressions of the basic ethos that progress means costly development, in the same way as a caterpillar becomes a butterfly. We imagine some transformation to a better and more refined state – whether that be inwardly through education, or externally through technology or somewhere in between through the emergence of better or more refined culture.

At which point I have to ask: what do you imagine may realistically emerge in the next century that will possibly outstrip the devastating effects of what is about to happen as we overload the planet?

There are really only two things that stand out, as far as I can see:

The first is the emergence of technology in some form that mitigates the effect of the increasing fulfilment of human desire on the wider supporting biosphere. In other words, we will somehow find ways of modulating or modifying how we source such fulfillments so as to be less destructive or even beneficial. Free energy, for instance. Or turning waste into food. We will still get what we want, but we will do that in less damaging ways.

The second is to limit behaviour voluntarily, to find ways to allow people to govern themselves in more direct and responsible ways. What this means is to bridge the great void which presently exists in every individual's awareness between what they do right now and the ultimate effect of that action globally. I believe people already have the moral will to live in ways that are significantly more responsible than they are, but that they simply cannot figure out how. And whilst education is a factor, as well as moral development as supported by culture, this is not the problem here. Even when there is the will, the way is not easy to discern. The systems are simply too complex, and we cannot compute the cause and effect relationships. But I believe it can easily be demonstrated that if we could, that we would all voluntarily and automatically choose very different modes of behaviour overall.

Both of these options have much room for gain, and both may be coming in many respects. Both of them harbour significant promise. And there may be others beyond this, which could altogether make a big dent in our coming dilemma. But what needs to be noticed is that both of these are, in some form or another, pushing individuals or systems into disequilibrium. They are generating tension, which will always want to release.

In particular, however, the capacity to bridge the gap between individual action and global consequences will be a watershed moment for our species. And if present trends continue, then it is coming quite soon. What it will require is ubiquitous connectivity, effectively infinite computing and storage capacity, at practically zero cost. Information delivered on demand instantaneously. All of which will emerge in the next two decades.

Moral effort is the foundation of any gains this will produce, and those gains will be significant no doubt. Moral will only works up to a point, however, beyond which the very information which enabled such will produce an increasing potential for spontaneous massive failure as waves of negative social energy propagate through the information systems which connect us. By waves, what I mean are all those things we do because everyone else is doing them, thus giving them weight. These same waves will be beneficial at first, as positive events propagate, producing spontaneous collective actions. But beyond a certain point of tension, as we are pushed into disequilibrium, they will become equally destructive just as suddenly. I am just trying to outline here the best scenarios, and their likely outcomes.

As far as mitigating the effects of individual actions on the supporting environment, all technological or organisational advancements have an associated cost. If they were the easiest, we would already be doing them. Of course good design can increase efficiency, but ultimately limits will be encountered. Unless ways are found to source resources from beyond the limited gravity well of the Earth, then the power of these advancements to stem the effects of such radically increasing demands on the environment will ultimately peak and diminish, in similar fashion to peak oil. Beyond an initial boom such technological advancements will become harder and harder to access, with less and less capacity to affect the underlying negative spiral. We will exhaust them very quickly.

It all looks pretty grim. If you run it forward and look at it all in graphical form you get a sober shock – you see the gaping void that exists between what 9B people will at minimum accept as a standard of living, and what our already buckling biosphere will support. And remember, what we are talking about here is how far people can be

pushed before they emotionally explode, and just how far the limitations we are now confronting are going to push them beyond that point. Which is quite far.

This overlap is a problem. The emotional gap it represents is an imminent recipe for a loss of governmental control. This gap is a planetary time bomb. At best it is a mandate for global military dictatorship, which may well be why we see such quietly emerging in the name of 'security'. At worst, it is the unavoidable crucible of a looming world war.

As a summary, here is an outline to represent this situation, and its unavoidable outcome:

- 1. If the underlying forces in the individual are effectively stable and fixed, meaning that the emotional equilibrium they are governed by is fixed, then people will always tend to want certain conditions to be present if possible. They will always tend toward this point, even if they are prevented from having such. And even if they choose to suppress such desires, that suppression will itself cause a degree of unhappiness that will want to resolve over time – ceaselessly pressing toward again emancipating the underlying desire. Ideal human desire is fixed.
- 2. The fulfilment of human desire can be provided to varying degrees, but can only be thwarted up to a certain point before it causes negative action on the part of the individual to assert their right to fulfilment. And it can only be thwarted beyond that point by the application of leverage or threat to prevent such action. And the levels of risk increase the further you go. Ultimately desire represents physical need, and so at an even further point thwart of desire will not be able to be applied even in the face of mortal threat – people will ultimately rather die fighting than die of starvation or depression. The conclusion of which is this: In a free and open society, there is only so far you can push people away from what they naturally desire before there are consequences equal or more negative than allowing them to fulfil such. Maximum safe distance from ideal human desire represents a clear threshold, it is a fixed point as defined by the force any society will agree to apply. You can push people in a good direction, but you can only push people so far before they push back and make things even worse than doing nothing.
- 3. The amount a typical individual will consume or discharge – even at the maximum stable distance from what they ideally desire – is defined by biological and cultural forces that cannot, in a free and open society, be controlled or determined by external force.
- 4. A significant component of this general desire is procreation – a primary emotional driver of all species – leading to population increase over time to a level approximately 1.5 times what we see today at minimum, in a world where in 2005 20% of the people alone consumed 25% more than the planet will sustain.
- 5. Conclusion? By the end of this century, if all these things are true, then based upon current broad consumption levels, and as emerging economies develop fully, we will be consuming and discharging somewhere around 7.5 times what the planet will sustain.

This is using the lowest estimates available. And there is no escaping this situation, we do not have a spare planet to jump onto. So we are basically out of control. Those in positions of power and responsibility, when we come to approaching this point above, will have no choice. If they are going to serve the people they govern, then they will have to oppress them or allow them to disintegrate into violent anarchy. The choice will be Maoist China or Mad Max. And based on what we know, this is intractable. We are moving towards a grim global reality, and humanity will do whatever it has to in order to survive, it always does.

The solving of one problem as the developing world emerges from drudgery is flying directly into the face of an already overloaded broader issue – one that has no conscience or room to move. It is a proverbial brick wall.

There are soon going to be 20 more kids in the playground, and at least ten of them are going to be big enough to be bullies. And by then there will not even be five sausage rolls left. Resources are diminishing. So when the 16 or so hungry kids finally decide to get together and get their share, the current bullies are going to have a fight on their hands.

It is precisely because of the gravity of what I have just outlined that we do not hear about it much. Because it is too much to take in, and because we have no answers for it. It causes despair. But this is not my purpose here. I would not be mentioning it myself, or bringing it up in such obvious fashion, except that I am forced to do so by the nature of where we are going here. Because you cannot examine big answers, without first introducing big questions.

So I started off by saying that I must first warn you about the scale and depth of the idea I am leading you towards – and hopefully you are beginning to get the basic level here. You are generally not allowed to discuss questions at this level, because without answers they are basically too painful. And I would apologise, except for the fact that the answer to all of this is laid out below.

Therefore, I will now move on to the solution to this problem, as I see it. Which, as you can now see, is an embarrassing thing to even propose given the scale of what we are discussing.

Indeed, what I just outlined basically sums up our growing collective dread. It is within this growing awareness that we can now frame all dialogue about what is important, and what to do next, or even what might possibly be done. What we see above is the final dilemma, in its simplest rendering. And as a culture we are nowhere near to even putting this up on the table, let alone addressing it in any significant way. It is so deep, and so serious, that to become fully aware of our actual situation is simply a recipe for disempowerment. So we avoid it, we simply go on with our lives and do what we can to keep our minds from wandering back to it like a tongue returning to a chipped tooth until it is raw. And maybe we can imagine we will live out our natural days before all this bears down on us with its iron boot, and perhaps even take some comfort. But if we love our kids, this is not so easy.

What, then, can I say here that is of such epic significance? How can we possibly change this situation, or even alter this trajectory in the slightest? What can possibly be added to this picture to unlock a puzzle that appears so implacable?

With the context now broadly established, I can finally begin. I will begin to introduce something with a very curious and potent anatomy - something almost entirely negative as it turns out, perhaps even the most negative thing you could possibly imagine, which really is the best thing about it. And one thing is for sure, it is something you have never seen before, or even heard of.

A Hidden Path

I will need to start out by pointing out a few things that are probably completely obvious to you already, and ask a few obvious questions -

Consider the root of the unfolding dilemma outlined above. Why are humans suddenly so dominant to the point of being a threat to their own survival? Why do we consume so much more than our closest relatives, with whom we share 95% of our genetic material? Why, exactly, do we tend to ‘want’ so much? Or, conversely, you might ask – why are we so unhappy?

The entire problem we face results from what human beings feel. In particular, it results from what we desire. And this is what we will open up here. My point will be – it is not what it appears to be.

Let’s begin by laying down a basic foundation -

The apparently fixed underlying emotional foundation within each of us, as indicated above as the primary driver of all human culture and civilization, I will call our ‘motive agenda’.

For the purposes of our very simplistic discussions here you might imagine it as being something like an emotional shopping list that we set out to acquire every day as we go about the task of being as happy as we can. It is this shopping list that is basically taboo to talk about or question, as it forms the basis of our entire social structure. Because experience tells us that whilst some things we might desire can be oppressed by culture, or suppressed by ourselves, to do this to any significant degree will produce very negative results. Happiness is, by dictionary definition, the fulfilment of desire - the opposite of which is any number of explosive or degenerative negative outcomes.

All animals have such motive agendas. They relate to need and biological expectation as defined by evolution.

For instance if you put a horse in a paddock on its own it will become unhappy. This is because horses need company, they are social creatures, the company of other horses is essential for their internal equilibrium. Take this away, and they will quietly suffer in ways they may not be able to express.

The point is that there is a reason for what animals feel – it is via submission to such impulses and tendencies that they express their natural behaviour as defined by the niche in which they evolved and prospered. If following such feelings was not good for them, they would not still be here – they would have become extinct. What makes horses suffer when they are alone is what makes them successful, because it also makes them stick together in the wild – which has the result of producing more horses. And so forth.

We are no different. We have a natural motive agenda just like every other animal, and just like every other animal this emotional foundation – including all the impulses it produces – can be trusted. Truly, if happiness really is the fulfilment of desire, then we have no choice. If we do not follow and fulfil our desires, we will – logically – never be happy. Ever.

My point will be this however: There is a very good reason why this does not feel entirely right. And that will be the subject of the rest of this work.

We don't trust entirely, we hold back and control many elements of what we feel, and I will seek to explain why that is. What we feel, what we desire, has been exploded way beyond what we actually need by a single definable cause that scatters countless impulses into the wind of daily emotion. And that this is the cause of most of our problems. As such, it is also the root of most of our solutions because this causal element can be removed, along with all of its downstream symptoms.

For instance the amount we tend to eat, relative to the amount we actually need, does not match. It is not even close. There is something wrong with it. For some reason what we feel no longer bears much obvious resemblance to what we need. The problem is far deeper than simply educating people and making healthy choices available. The problem is that if people have the choice, they will choose the lesser option, because only the lesser option functions to fulfil the deeper emotional element. There are many such examples, all of which have the same basic root.

This much deeper originating cause is the one thing that has been missed here, overlooked completely. And it is huge. It is so huge that there is really no way to even prepare you for it.



The small symbol above is The Owl. You will see it in many different forms, in and around my work. It has very many meanings or connotations, but primarily – as a simple graphic form – it represents the correction of a single critical error.

It represents the cleaving of one thing into two, with the central element representing a blade – the theoretical axe that emerged when all this first became clear to me.

More accurately, however, this form represents the recognition that there have always been two, but that this fact has never before been noticed. It represents many things actually, a recurring motif throughout this work, but primarily it represents a new perspective. In particular it represents the way we view ourselves, so I suppose you could say it is a mirror of sorts.

The opposing view could perhaps be represented as simply –



The common view sees only one, where in fact there are two. These two have been so fused and confused that they have never been clearly differentiated.

It is as simple as this: There are two things going on here, not one. The fusion and confusion of these two is – I believe – possibly the greatest fallacy of all time. It is greater than the mistake that claimed the world was flat.

Every picture ever taken of the human state is actually a picture of two distinct things, not one. Our behaviour is the direct result of two separate motive agendas, interwoven in an intricate struggle. Two completely separate events, with different anatomies and different origins and different purposes. And please bear in mind that I am not talking about any simple minded mythic concept like good and evil.

Of course this is a very bold claim, but I believe I can provide some very robust support. In fact it is so obvious once you see how it works that you might even wonder how you could have possibly missed it. The number of otherwise enigmatic features of human behaviour this explains is impressive, but that is nothing next to the practical implications, and what it ultimately means. But we will get to that.

I will seek to briefly define the actual mechanics of these two and their relationship below, but for now I will start off with a graphic metaphor, because at this stage my intention will be to capture only what is required to broadly indicate the significance and implications of this being even roughly accurate.

If you will: imagine the native human agenda as a great and beautiful tree. This tree represents the actions of natural humanity, our collective emotional and behavioural inheritance. Then imagine another climbing plant – winding its way up and all over this tree, with leaves that look just like the original, but with fruits that taste bitter instead of sweet.

With even this rough sketch we already capture many important things. The nature and origins of this secondary and subversive event are obviously important, but the most important thing is that this has not been noticed. And there are many reasons for this, all of which this theory must itself provide. One of which is that differentiating these two events requires significant foundations to even begin to clearly define. After all, we are discussing the single most complex system ever discovered in the known universe, and then an equally complex secondary event occurring within that system. So clearly separating these two in functional terms necessarily demands first of all a full anatomical model of the native agenda and all its functioning, then also a full definition of the nature and origins of this secondary event, and thirdly the dynamic relationship between them. Meaning that defining this situation in detail may ultimately be the most complex undertaking in human history. But it may also be worth it, as we will see below.

The main thing is that it all looks like a single event. The profound and diffuse psychological enmeshment means that we are forever looking from this event rather than at it, and that we are thereby forever trapped by it.

The very confusion caused by this secondary presence has prevented the anatomy of the underlying native agenda from becoming clear, meaning it has remained obscured, hidden in plain sight so to speak.

This is one of its defining features. Another is how stable it is. If you attack it or seek to remove its negative effects, it will only perceive this as 'pruning' and a great opportunity to grow. Or it will give more sap to another limb and produce equally negative effects elsewhere.

Remember, what we are discussing here is desire and aversion. And so this added event is like someone adding an extra bunch of items to the bottom of your emotional shopping list every day – things you may not actually need to be truly happy, but for which you will be emotionally punished if you do not provide. It really is decidedly unfair.

Several significant things can already be introduced here, even at this point. One is that this very messy situation puts us out of kilter relative to our native and normal equilibrium – and so it has been very difficult to fathom the complexities of human behaviour using any predictive model. Which is a situation that resolves completely actually, once you subtract the secondary event.

Seeing this is an emancipation of integrity, like lifting a millstone off from around your theoretical neck. The remaining native agenda meshes completely with existing foundational understanding of the universe and our place in it. All of a sudden everything makes sense, and the resulting structure provides the foundations of an operating worldview that makes both the world and ourselves much more comprehensible.

Conversely, on the negative side, the great fallacy this view resolves and corrects extends into every level and form of culture and historical understanding, it is an epic error which has been universally embodied. And so, as a result of correcting this error so profoundly, this foundational platform explains many things beyond the scope of our discussions here, and will likely be unpacked for very many years to come. If it turns out to be broadly accurate, then there are few stones it will leave unturned.

The other thing of more immediate interest to the dilemma outlined above is that this secondary event can potentially fall away, as already indicated. It is not intrinsic, and not necessary. It is like an epiphyte, a parasitic organism. And just like any organism it can be pushed off balance. And if it is pushed far enough it will eventually fold and fall away completely.

Of course, what this might mean depends on exactly what it is. We really need a comprehensive definition of exactly what we are talking about here in order to see the significance of what this might mean. But for now, for the purposes of this metaphorical sketch, let's assume that it is pretty big, and that the effects of its presence are serious and deep.

This secondary event is a body of emotional process, a complex matrix of twisted and sinewy desire – and what ultimately defines this entire mass as separate from any other bit of mischievous dysfunction is that it has a singular taproot. I am tempted to say that it does not represent anything valuable to the underlying organism, but that is not entirely true. You might say that it produces an overload of emotional production, sometimes even in positive directions, but that even when that is the case there tends to be far too much of it to be considered healthy. It makes us want things we don't actually need, and it makes us very unhappy if we don't get them. It has been part of what has made us successful, and it is now the cause of all the problems associated with becoming much too successful for our own good.

Consider the climbing plant, strangling the elegant tree. How would you remove such?

This could be achieved intentionally of course, but it can also happen purely by chance. In either case, in relation to the event we are discussing, such is very rare at this time in history. But yes, it might simply die of natural causes, if it is weak or sickly for instance. And what would it mean for someone for this to happen? What would someone 'get' in that event? Nothing. Something would be removed. Such a tree would actually have less. But what might it feel like? Amazing, the restoration of an effortless capacity to be happy, with very little necessary external support. It would feel like some kind of miracle, like the whole substance of existence has changed. Because everything would 'feel' different.

So how might someone explain it? They couldn't. The only way to explain such a state would be to explain what had left, what fell away, which is not something they would necessarily know. They would in fact be less qualified than the typical person to explain such, given that they no longer even have one to study.

The significance of such an event – if all this is basically accurate – might be what? This obviously depends on how damaging it is to a person's life, and what that removal costs. But the mere fact that such an event is possible is a staggering revelation, if in fact it turns out to be so. Because if this secondary event is effectively subversive in effect, then what this means is that very often what feels good is not necessarily good for you, or for the planet. But that its stable removal would spell the effortless restoration of primary integrity – meaning what feels good would actually be good for you. You wouldn't even have to try. And that if it was not intrinsic, and also had a single point of origin, then it has an Achilles' heel. It means it can be strategically attacked, and that its subsequent removal would potentially be permanent and stable.

Am I getting ahead of myself here? Does this all sound a bit fanciful or overly enthusiastic? Perhaps I should provide some basic anatomy here, just so that you can get an idea of what it is we are actually talking about, how deep it is, but also how much sense it makes.

The one thing we cannot diminish, however, is just how significant it is. Its personal and collective implications will always make it difficult to discuss. So as we get into it I will have to keep adding layers of warning, so that you can brace yourself and not simply have it bounce off you in some kind of intellectual or emotional immune response.

Firstly, however - if this were true, if this is so big and if it could fall away entirely and permanently - surely we would have seen it before? Even if it were very difficult to achieve we would have seen it occasionally. But this is not necessarily so. How many people flew before planes were invented? None. But was it always possible? Yes. How many people split atoms before Rutherford? None. But it was always possible.

In this case however, we have seen it. Many times even, I believe this can be easily supported. It is just very difficult to validate because it is almost entirely subjective in nature, and as a result of there never having been any substantial explanation available it has always been wildly misinterpreted.

Put yourself in this position, then – something profound has happened to you subjectively, but you can't really get a grip on what it is...but you also can't keep it to yourself, it is too dramatic. And people start to notice. So you begin to talk, as best you can, and explain what happened, and what it is like. But people only get confused, and frustrated, because whilst they may resonate at some level they do not actually experience what you are experiencing. And this is because you do not actually know what you are talking about. You only know what it feels like when it is gone. And so you interpret it using the only language you have.

After all, you did not actually get anything in this event – you were not imparted with some magical wisdom or endowed with superhuman virtue. You simply want less as if by some kind of magic, and so you are significantly happier. In fact what you want, and what your body needs for its optimum functional state, become the same. Happiness, deep and fathomless happiness, becomes extremely simple. And so you tell your stories, true stories, but who can understand? And eventually all is lost to time, and the reality you were seeking to convey is never even understood – even by you. And 300 years later, what remains of your futile efforts becomes known as a 'religion'.

So if you were to 'Google this', what would you search for? 'Spiritual Enlightenment' perhaps. And you would get about 8 million hits. Or you could try Moksha, Satori, Nirvana, Awakening, Sahaj Samhadi, Self Realisation... etc.

Unfortunately, if the potential I am referring to is what they are all referring to, then not a single one of those pages explains what it actually is. In fact the explanations they offer for it are as understandable as they are regrettable, in that they have obscured from view what may turn out to be something of profound practical significance, by couching it in language that is entirely inappropriate given what it actually is. Entire cultures have been founded upon an understanding that this potential exists (India, Tibet, etc), but because there is only misunderstanding as to its actual nature and significance it has remained almost completely invalidated as a practical reality in the mainstream. And this is because in their explanation of what it is they are not only a little bit off the mark, they are miles off. And the vast and convoluted theoretical frameworks they use to surround it

are even worse. Like heroin, what it feels like and what it actually is are two very different things. Never ask a junkie what reality is.

The implications here are many, even beyond the obvious philosophical dead wood this emerging paradigm might pile up and burn. It asserts that, as a result of a significant and undifferentiated active presence in almost every living person, a potential exists for a dramatic transformational event to occur - an unnoticed potential, lying dormant. It points to something that would never occur naturally, but which might – under just the right circumstances – result in an entirely different subjective experience of life, and a very different behavioural equilibrium as a consequence. It validates an event which has happened occasionally in the past, even accidentally, but which has never before been understood in meaningful terms. And what I am seeking to indicate here is just what an emerging understanding of such might mean, how significant that might be, if this is actually so.

Of course this is all very bold to the point of being almost ludicrous, but I hope you will follow me as I now unpack the basic mechanics of how it works, and then lay out some of the implications of this. It is really not that mysterious, and it makes perfect sense. In fact it makes a lot more sense than the paradigm we presently employ to explain many important features of subjective human anatomy and common human behaviour.

The only obvious and unavoidable obstacle here is that you are presently subject to the very thing I am defining. And its very purpose for existing – as you will see – is concealment. So I will be seeking to swing a mirror in your face here very quickly in an effort to get you to look AT this event for just a moment, rather than FROM it, which is what you are doing right now. But once you get hold of its tail, I hope that like me you will find it just too tempting not to drag it right out into the light. Meaning that once you basically see it, you begin to see it everywhere. And I'm not sure if I will get you across this line here in such a short space of time... but it's worth a shot.

The Core Anatomy

I guess you would like to know how it works? Please forgive the brutal simplicity of this rendering, I only want to try to give you a sense of the basic mechanics involved. It is too big for a full layout here.

Let's start with a basic hierarchy:

The body grew the mind, and uses emotion to control it. Of course I am being simplistic here for the purposes of brevity – you might say evolution produced all three, but the order in which they emerged is the point here. The higher functions emerged because they were advantageous to the lower.

These three things you might envisage as a pyramid, with mind at the top, emotion in the middle and body at the base. The conscious level of experience is a product of the operation of the lower two as they constantly generate tasks for the conscious level to fulfil, in the same way as people might elect a leader and empower them to act on their behalf. Emotion, in this case, is how popular the leader is – which means the amount of tension present basically equates to how close they are to being kicked out. And just like such a leader, for the conscious level of experience to not be sensitive to such influence is highly unlikely, given that they depend on such for their position.

The conscious 'self', therefore, is charged with one simple task – following what it feels. If it does this, and achieves the objectives such tensions should naturally represent, it will experience peace as it resolves back into calm and undisturbed emotional depth, and physical wellbeing.

The mind serves the body, and if it does a good job, is rewarded with bliss.

This state of positive accord, all three in positive harmony, is what I will call 'happiness'.

Happiness is real in this sense, and cannot be manufactured 'artificially'. It is a functional potential that represents a deeper alignment, it is not an emotion – it is a state. Nor can 'not feeling how unhappy you are' ever approach this state. Not feeling and happiness are opposing terms.

So what's gone wrong? It is as simple as this: There is a common misalignment between the top two layers – most people struggle to fully embrace what they feel, or to follow it. Their deepest dreams and desires often remain unrealized. But what they do not generally grasp is that this is not because they do not have the resources to make this happen. It is deeper than that, as anyone who wins the lotto will tell you. The struggle between conscious action and the resulting emotional state is actually a product of a deeper issue, which is precisely what they find out if ever they have the courage to resolve the surface level misalignment. The actual misalignment is between the body and emotion, well beneath the level consciousness can access directly. Which really is a profound conundrum for conscious experience.

In a few broad strokes, the basic outlines of the deeper rift look something like this –

- The intrinsic behaviour of human beings makes sense, and fits perfectly with our evolutionary history. The tendencies involved fit exactly with our biological requirements both individually and socially, and obviously also include a few rough edges and bits of baggage we collected along the way – all natural and healthy parts of what it means to be human. And this includes our most recent advancement – imagination. All of which is in intrinsic alignment with natural ecology, because such is where it originated.
- Supporting and upholding this functioning is a high degree of structural and energetic integrity. If this integrity ever broke down historically we became less able to meet our needs, and evolution made sure we didn't get to pass on our weak and ineffective traits.
- The emergence of imagination, because it became employed in simulating reality via the remarkably accurate calculation of probabilities, provided not only the functional possibility of experiencing emotion based solely on imagination, but the certainty of such. Therefore, because imagination is always only a guess at best, introducing the possibility of significant error in the way emotion is produced relative to the actual organic needs that such is naturally intended to represent.
- Contrary to certain intrinsic and necessary biases present in all organic systems, there are no observable boundaries in nature. A deeply counter-intuitive fact, the sense of distinct 'self' we experience is not an objective fact, and the presumed foundations for such very quickly vanish into thin air as this proposition is more closely examined. The profound subjective experience of such is an enclosed illusion of simulated reality, in our case immensely compounded and extended in the wake of imagination.
- In an unforeseen event, then, an error in the way one particular aspect of erroneous imagination becomes embedded in our emotional hardware, which then comes into contact with an intractable reality (the idea of 'self', and the reality of death). This has the result of producing the conditions for the emergence of unprecedented and immutable and ever increasing fear at a level not able to be either stopped or contained. As existence itself appears to become dependent on physical survival, an emotional spiral of ever increasing magnitude is attempted in an effort to separate the ultimate need from the ultimate thwart. We become hyper-motivated to a debilitating degree.
- Surely I would remember? But who is 'I' in this case, and if such an event was going to be removed from awareness, who would be the target of such? Do you remember nightmares as a child? The ultimate result of such high emotional production is functional deadlock, and eventually the necessary containment and management of debilitating fear by natural repressive mechanisms. Which – because the overblown emotional products in question are the result of entirely healthy functioning – involves the distortion or limiting of systemic integrity. Conscious levels of functioning are necessarily excluded.
- Therefore, because healthy emotional functioning is being interrupted, and energetic integrity actively thwarted, the resulting efforts and behavioural tendencies are directly opposed to the functional purpose for which the brain exists (to promote and support the ideal wellbeing of the organism and its functioning). The body is effectively forced to attack itself, in the same way you will inject yourself with antihistamine in order to prevent asthma from killing you. Histamine is part of a natural and healthy bodily function, but if you have to you will turn it off in order to save the body as a whole. And you will keep doing that as many times as necessary, even for your entire life if you must. It is natural to subvert healthy functioning when it is behaving in a way that is threatening to kill you.

Sometimes the body does stuff quite by accident that is quite dangerous, it realises potentials that it did not foresee. This is one of those cases. And of all the things that could have gone wrong, this is an absolute whopper.

The detailed anatomy of this is the point, such is required to get a really clear handle on the nature of the particular error involved here, as well as the context in which it arises. Such details also explain just how vast and dynamic it is as a result. But the essence is pretty simple – an abiding and unrecognised error begins a process that eventually results in a permanent process of necessary containment. It has to prevent an event spiral that would – if left unchecked – otherwise very quickly become a torrent of existential fear. And because that event is actually built from entirely natural and healthy functioning, subversion of healthy psychological functioning is implied in its effective containment.

The result of which is a permanent energetic double bind, and impossible emotional puzzle for the conscious frontal self to figure out. All of a sudden it has the task master of emotion standing over it with a big stick, asking it to sit down, and stand up, at the same time. Which is not only very hard work, it is very painful because it is constantly failing to do one or other, or both. It is working very hard, and getting beaten, at the same time.

The primary function of this secondary agenda is concealment, therefore. In particular its function is to scatter and separate these two scrapping dogs (self and death) permanently, and to distract or disorient any functions that might ever seek to put them back together in the presence of surplus energy. And also, in the process, it must also conceal itself.

The result of which, at a conscious level, is an extremely dynamic and perpetual process of activity to try and resolve this ‘mysterious’ dilemma and find happiness (which is now dramatically limited) and an unconscious and very adaptive subversive process working tirelessly in response.

The details of this dance as these two agendas feed into the emotional core explain the common human state in great resolution. It is a full predictive model of human behaviour, in great detail.

At the surface of life it is impossible to tell the two apart. They are fused and confused at every moment, like two different fruits in a blender. You need to be able to see deeper.

The point is to understand what the agendas are doing, and why.

So let’s have a look: The native or intrinsic agenda is acting to fulfil biological needs and maintain structural and functional integrity. Its target is effective behaviour. It comes from the body basically, via the emotive core, and delivers its results outwardly. This is why emotion follows the same basic path, because it is part of this natural system. All emotion has outward expression, because that is its purpose for existing.

Now add to this the other event: The subversive agenda is a product of the deep unconscious, in response to an overwhelming and mysterious threat. It is a primal response to an unrecognised causal element that is still present in the system.

The target or purpose of the subversive agenda is the avoidance of one very obvious and difficult to control potential, and its main method in achieving this is to subvert healthy functioning in the least damaging or conspicuous manner possible. The primal system clearly doesn’t even know what this potential is, it only knows the consequences and that it is very dangerous and difficult to reel in once it begins to animate. But because the potential being avoided is large and somewhat obvious, and being produced by healthy functioning, and because healthy function is upheld by energetic integrity, then energetic integrity must ultimately be limited or disturbed.

So the target of the subversive agenda is inward, it is effectively an attack on the system itself, albeit a benevolent and completely covert one. However because energetic integrity is being actively disturbed, the result of its operation is emotional tendency resulting in ‘consciously inexplicable action’ in order to maintain such disturbance, and an equivalent and very dynamic limitation on everything that depends on energetic integrity for its existence: namely – what we call ‘happiness’.

Happiness is not the intended casualty in this situation, it is simply an innocent bystander, but the resulting situation makes sustainable happiness a very difficult thing to achieve. Less difficult, however, if you have less

integrity to disturb. Which is why ignorance really is bliss, and why genius often borders on madness. But only in this disturbed state. If you remove this conflict, completely different axioms apply.

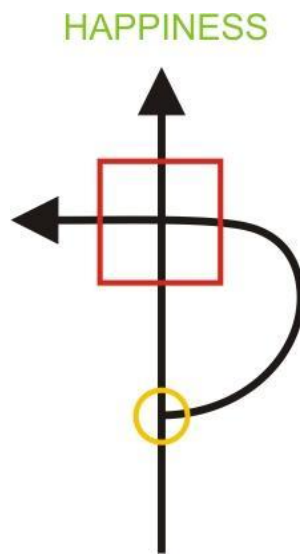
You might look at all this as the overproduction of a good thing to the point of detriment – like anaphylaxis. Too much of a good thing in a sense. The drive produced by the error at the root of all this is a drive to survive – it has put our survival instinct into massive overdrive. Which up to a point produced very good results for our species, albeit somewhat stressful results due to the force with which we seek them. But upon crossing the finish line of organic success we continue to spiral out of control and keep running like maniacs, and then have to learn how to deal with the overproduction of this drive, which just keeps on coming. We are flooded with tension, overloaded with motive drive, which must then be shut down to prevent it from attacking the very thing it is seeking to promote. We want to live so much that it almost kills us.

The result is a very stable and self governing pattern of functioning where the conscious self is left somewhat bewildered and trying to figure out what appears to be an incredibly complicated puzzle in a situation that should naturally be completely simple. Of course, we do not consciously know this has even happened, and because everyone we know also has it we have presumed it to be normal. We do not realise that what we generally call happiness is only a shadow of our true potential for such. And because we are actually basically unhappy a lot of the time, or at least struggling with some deep abiding yearning or discontent, we naturally presume the conditions for happiness are not present, and therefore consume more in an effort to find them.

When you see the intricate anatomy of this secondary event and all the ways it can dynamically shift and operate you begin to see just how much of what we know as common culture is a direct result and reflection of it. It is truly not an exaggeration to say that it is most of what we do. The two agendas are fused and confused in every moment, in constant dynamic union. The harder the native agenda pushes toward organic equilibrium, the harder the subversive agenda must work to push us back. We see these two in the obsessive compulsive cycle for instance, and in all the other countless forms of emotional, physical and psychological struggle people deal with. A typical person will spread it out and apply sophisticated backups and contingencies, and they will call that being ‘well balanced’. Which is not a bad name given how difficult it actually is. It is pretty much a circus trick, which is why a great many people cannot achieve such with any degree of reliability, and why most people who do achieve it generally do so on the back of considerable emotional compromise.

And if people refuse to comply? Addictions, compulsions, dysfunctions, imbalances, mysterious cyclic behaviours, an army of unconscious activity, constantly working, ceaselessly acting to prevent the restoration of primary integrity, because that would naturally reanimate this smouldering event. A constant stream of embarrassing failures and mysterious acts of self sabotage is generally the result.

Failing to submit to the limitation associated can result in a situation that is just like having two personalities. The basis of a personality is an integrated emotional support base below the level of conscious awareness. And what we see here are effectively the entire emotional bases of two distinct personalities, completely interwoven. The native system makes sense, if you can extract it and view it in isolation. But it is so mixed up with the other event that it is normally very hard to see. The secondary event obscures it from view. But the secondary, the thing that would remain if you removed the native activity, is so incredibly strange and seemingly infinite in outward form that it defies any unifying thread. It seems completely random and scattered in terms of the behaviour it produces. But that is not true at all, it makes entire sense if you know how to piece it all together. It is not trying to produce behaviour, you see, it is messing with internal functioning which is miles upstream from the event it is seeking to determine. The outward behaviour is just an unfortunate side effect. The function and purpose of that massive event is actually very clear, and its means of achieving that end are equally definable. You just need to understand the systems involved, and how they work. It is simply and only an ever changing response to the natural and ongoing attempts of native functioning to restore lost integrity and equilibrium. And it is extremely stable.



Consciousness is only naturally equipped to be aware of the part of this picture inside the red square. For most people, that is everything they know about themselves and about life. The point of this diagram is simply to emphasise one thing –

That both the problem, and the possible solution to it, occur in the yellow circle. There is no answer in the red box. You have to go beyond and get to the source, or you are basically completely wasting your time.

What does this account for, then? How big is it?

I could, I suppose, take a slice through it and show you how it plays out in specific detail, but that would only give an imbalanced impression. I don't want to play favourites, it has so many expressions in life that picking on one person's rendering of this would be unfair. In fact, by and large it is spread over so many systems and functions that it is difficult to put your finger on, and only becomes really obvious when it clusters somewhere for a time to produce an obvious swollen symptom.

Some of which can look like this –

Depression (all rivers dammed – feel nothing/feel bad)

Insanity (the aftermath of fear. Burse dams, flood damage. It is very funny to think that psychiatrists have the same disease as patients, but with more stable and refined repression. Meaning some of their patients may well be suffering from higher functional integrity in certain key regards.)

Religion (immortality projects – solves an imaginary problem with an imaginary solution)

Procreation (immortality project – solves an imaginary problem by directly contributing to the worst problem on the planet)

Obesity (organic imbalance – feel nothing. Obesity is not an eating disorder. It is an emotional disorder. You are as heavy as you need to be to feel safe.)

Unhappiness (general symptom)

Addictions of all kinds (you name it)

War (take away my god = I will die = I better kill you first)

Romantic love (security blanket – a primal fear eliminator)

Banishment of intimacy from common culture (emotional oppression)

Cognitive damage (direct obliteration of involved hardware)

I could write pages of these...they are all connected in a fluid and dynamic process, which can easily shift and adapt moment to moment. It is a massive interconnected network of potential at the front end, with a single purpose at the back end. We will probably not ever really grasp just how big it is until it is gone.

The nature of deep causality produces a very diffuse and dynamic effect at the surface level of life. By the time this underlying event is manifest as emotional drive and action, the two agendas cannot be distinguished. No surface action can be isolated or judged as belonging to one or other, as the relationship of surface actions to the

deeper event is often only a matter of timing, or degree. What may be mostly healthy one day, in one context, may be entirely dysfunctional the next day, even in the same context. The overall balance of dysfunction is the point, and the very slippery and dynamic and pervasive processes that maintain such over time.

It is only the deeper symmetry of these two events that allows them to be clearly differentiated. It is only when you see the core anatomy of the functions involved, and how those functions are affected by actions at the surface level, that it all becomes clearer. And we don't have the space to define this anatomy here, but what we can discuss, even with this brief outline, are the most important things this idea brings into view. Namely – what this all means for us at the most basic and simple level.

The most important thing it means is that no matter what we do we will not resolve this issue, or any of its obvious symptoms, whilst the underlying conflict remains in place. It is very stable. Attacking it at a surface level is like trying to get rid of a fireman who is dousing your party by using a baseball bat to hit the water coming out of his hose, from 50 feet away. The ultimate cause in this situation, and the final symptoms, are dramatically separated systemically.

All of which means we are kind of chasing a rabbit down a hole here – we have gone from the global dilemma to the individual action that is causing such, and now from individual action to another whole level beneath that again.

Free energy is the primary currency of life – even a plant knows to grow towards the light. And the goal of positive organic transactions is to get a lot without giving too much. Energetic profit = life. Transactional demands cost energy, and feel bad. If you are hungry, then running after a tasty critter only works if you get more energy than you spend. You wouldn't run ten miles chasing a sparrow.

The subversive agenda does the same thing, because its function necessarily involves the subversion of functional integrity, and because integrity is upheld by free energy, it has the effect of deliberately avoiding or wasting energy. So in the end, it is all basically equivalent to VERY hard work. Not to mention all the other negative outcomes further downstream. And it never ends, except in deep sleep. Even in dreams we wage this war. And as we struggle to find a comfortable place to rest, in our mad stampede we are trampling everything in our path. And we don't even know this is happening. With only inmates to run the asylum, we imagine this is normal.

2EQ

With this in mind, I will try to at least outline just how big this really is, which is sometimes not immediately obvious or easy to visualise if you are not accustomed to some of the ways dynamic systems work.

The result of this is that the idea I am introducing lands fair and square in the very deep end of the pool, where almost nobody is swimming, miles away from the crowded shallows. Meaning that people, even very smart people, don't generally grasp this immediately, perhaps because it is so fundamental, and because it has such direct and significant personal implications.

The equation I began with at the top, which defines the root of all our global dilemmas, is pretty simple. It is basically this:

1. What people want (at minimum sustainable level)

Multiplied by..

2. How many people there are going to be.

Divided by..

3. What the planet will sustain.

And the outcome is clear: we are miles over the line already. Which is just for human survival mind you, let alone what an ideal formula might look like that also took all other species and living systems into account in some balanced way.

One thing that is never questioned is the foundational tenet of this equation. In all such discussion the one thing that is never considered is the basic emotional equilibrium of the individual. After all, it appears very stable and predictable, which seems to make this historical stance entirely reasonable.

The main thing this new idea introduces is the possibility that for every individual there are in fact two stable equilibriums (2EQ), not one, and that these states are not closely related energetically or functionally, but are actually vastly different in very significant ways. The other thing the mere awareness of this would tend to suggest – because it also indicates complete prior concealment – is that we are rapidly approaching a point where the second potential is going to become much more accessible as it is noticed and understood for the first time.

In the most unexpected and dramatic fashion, because the secondary event can be securely removed, it explains two completely different stable equilibriums for the human individual, and therefore for the human collective by extension. And the entire question of what it means to be human is reoriented in the wake of such an insight. So if you ask almost any question about what constitutes humanity in any particular respect, you first have to ask – which one? Because there are two, and they are very different indeed, so different that they could effectively be classified as distinct species, in that they have completely different behavioural characteristics, longevity, morality, cognitive ability, carbon footprint etc.

We are *Homo sapiens*: conflicted and disturbed. The Latin is – ‘wise man’. So what is the other possibility? *Homo libera* perhaps: simple and serene. This version might roughly translate as – ‘free man’.

Using the tree metaphor once again, these two states are what we might call the ‘common state’ where we see these two events fused in a dynamic interplay, and then the free or ‘native state’ where the secondary event has been summarily removed.

These two versions of humanity are very different functionally, and when you transpose them onto the larger picture it changes everything. A world populated by *Homo sapiens* will always struggle with problems that remain mysterious and intractable. Whereas *Homo libera* would return us to the fold, and dance with the Earth. *Homo libera* is who we really are, and who we were meant to be.

What is not immediately obvious until you examine the difference in depth is the scale of such a fundamental possibility relative to other potential solutions we might consider - either individual or collective. And the challenges associated are also not easily conceptualised to begin with. So in every argument regarding what is naturally human and what is not we may soon be left to ask a more fundamental question: which one? Which version of humanity are you referring to? Because there are two. And more than this – of these two, the one you see now is not even the intrinsic or natural version. It is the aberrant one.

There are two versions of you, that’s what it means. And at present you do not have what is required to even see the other version, let alone realise it. We’ve been tricked, all of us, by the only person smart enough to get away with it for this long – by ourselves. But that is all about to change. The thing you have spent nearly your entire life avoiding may be about to become unavoidable.

And will that be bad? No.

There are endless things you can say about this understanding finally emerging at last. Long before it makes any of the indicated potentials practically available it already provides a clear map. It immediately restores dignity to see it, as well as compassion. To know that a vast amount of observable human character is not intrinsic to us, and that it can fall away, is a liberation at the deepest possible level. To know that we are basically far more benevolent than is commonly presumed, happier and more peaceful, but that this has been obscured by an event we have not been able to either see or control, is psychologically emancipating.

In the end a summary is this: if what is outlined here is broadly accurate, then on the one hand it represents a problem so deep that no amount of random surface leverage will ever affect it. Like pruning, it represents a problem that will adapt to any such efforts in order to maintain the present level of functional equilibrium in the

individual. And this is why happiness remains very stable across all demographics of wealth and circumstance – because it is not being defined externally, but rather internally.

This is why developmental conceptions of solutions to our dilemma are all heavily burdened – because, as in the case of cognitive development, there is very powerful downward pressure being applied to the individual internally to prevent such. Developmental gains simply get washed away again unless they are constantly reinforced, which is very hard work. The result of which is a profoundly stable and dynamic underlying equilibrium that is ultimately producing the vast majority of problems we face, and which – if it is not addressed at its source – will continue to do so beyond our capacity to determine or affect. It is a profound and dynamic dilemma.

Conversely, this very same situation introduces a solution of equivalently staggering proportions. The very same forces that produce this dynamic, and the scale of the damage it produces, are what allow for such a dramatic unfolding if this dam can be breached. Because whilst it might have been difficult to capture, and whilst we may have been so swayed and trapped by it that we have not even been able to see that it is happening to us, once we do see it and begin to overcome the barrier its resolution represents the result is an equally stable and dynamic solution. It is even more stable that our current conflicted state in essence, once the defining threshold is crossed.

We occasionally see people finding this other state, but I would wager that in all the time we exist into the future that we will never once see anyone go back the other way. It is simply not possible to un-pop a balloon.

The Path Ahead

In order to set some of the context, I should finish off this outline with just a little about the nature of where we stand at present, in relation to what will likely now occur as this emerging process begins to unfold. This is not a social bomb, it is not something that will emerge like a loud noise on the basis of great force and then dissipate as it radiates outwards. It is an emerging epidemic, and the model emerging here is its transmission vector. It will begin very small, incubating in obscurity, but will gradually get louder as it moves. There is already enough here to begin it, already enough by miles, so in some sense the outcome it inevitably leads toward has already happened. The only question now is how fast, and whether we make it in time.

The most important thing about all this, and the thing that very many people may not truly grasp until it happens, is what makes this situation different from everything else we have ever faced before – not only how dramatic and deep it is, but the overall systemic loading it represents. What this means is that it is different to all other options we imagine to be solutions to our deepest problems, particularly in relation to how we answer one very simple question: how could we possibly make all this happen? What do we need to do?

People don't believe in most ideas, in most movements, even when they are well intentioned. And this is precisely because of what we are outlining here. This is basically because they don't ultimately work. It is because there is some underlying inertia that always wins in the end, some deep and nebulous and frustrating negative force at work that always ends up pushing efforts backwards into powerlessness and resignation.

People don't believe in such causes because they are surface attempts to address deep causes, they do not believe in them because they are basically not smart enough. They are not self-generating, nor are they targeting deep causal events at their very root. And so people gradually give up, and stop believing in what once seemed so clearly possible. They basically don't believe in most efforts to produce change, because they simply don't work. And they don't work for reasons we can now see: precisely because they do not address deep and unrecognised equilibriums, because they are pushing against a tide they cannot see, a tide that originates ultimately as a result of their own unrecognised individual fear. They don't see this or make this fundamental connection.

This is different. This is simply not the same. This is another dynamic altogether. Belief is not even required. Not only will this require no effort to unleash, this one can probably not be stopped.

It is a paramount brute force approach, soft power – desire driven change, and I will explain more about what that means presently. It is made possible only by the very dramatic underlying situation and the potentials it implies. What makes this different is that we are at bedrock here, because ultimately the tide the other options are pushing against – the tide that will push them all back – is the very target of this event. You can injure an

enemy many times, and they will come back stronger and more determined the next time. But you can only kill them once. A summary resolution is different, and made possible only because the situation we are in is not as we imagined it is.

We are actually in a completely different situation than we imagined, and have completely different options than we thought we had. And as soon as this is realised, there will be an initial nibble, then as that nibble finds substance there will be a bite, and then a ruckus will ensue. Sooner or later we will see a well-organised riot.

The potential all of this indicates will leap out into full view, scared and already on the hop, like a greased pig at a festival. By then its number will already be up. There will be no escape this time.

As mentioned above, we tend to conceive positive change in terms of development – in terms of making people smarter for instance, more sophisticated somehow, either culturally or individually. And in that context we can also see two stable equilibriums occasionally – as in the caterpillar-butterfly example – two completely different states for the same thing.

We often imagine our situation in this way: that we are waiting for the magical breakthrough that will allow such dramatic and stable development to occur. We tend to imagine new worlds, higher worlds, things that do not presently exist coming into being. But this is not like that at all, this is better, this is much, much better. Our basic conception of change is inverted here, this is a form of change we are not accustomed to.

This is not a butterfly emerging after a gruelling transformation which involved development. It is a relinquishment. It is easy. It is less, not more, a millstone off from around your neck.

We have already got everything we need for this, we have already got way too much. It is not a 'get', it is a 'let go'. This is not building a house – this is burning a house down. This will not need to be encouraged, and it will not need to be managed. It will be a spontaneous event spiral that already knows its way home.

This one is different in one crucial respect, in that in this situation we get to fight fire with fire, unlocking dynamic spirals to defeat dynamic spirals, rather than pushing wet shit uphill with a sharp stick. We may presently be in considerable strife, but if ever we wanted an answer, then we really couldn't have asked for more than this. It is the best form an answer could take, in the best position, and the biggest scale imaginable. And it has been completely overlooked.

Its only power has been concealment – power it no longer has. So do not let the nature of what we must necessarily confront and overcome discourage you – if you can remove it, then the worse it is the better. And the bigger they are, the harder they fall, etc.

Two stable equilibriums provide the foundations for a kind of solution that is simply not possible when there is only one. With one, all you have is pressure toward disequilibrium, which will always be overcome in time. This is what we know.

But two stable equilibriums can only be the result of two things – the possibility of a very stable and positive emergent development, or the summary removal of a stable negative event. And in this case we are incredibly fortunate in the most unfortunate sense. We are unfortunate in that we have made it so very far without it even being noticed that this magnificent structure is not an intrinsic part of who we are. And fortunate for the same reasons, now that we know. Because the removal of a negative is much more rapid and stable and easy than the development of a stable positive event – if such were even possible in our case. And nothing we might ever add or develop could ever come close to the degree of stable positive change the removal of such a deep negativity would produce.

Both the problem, and the solution to it, are larger and more dynamic than we ever could have imagined, feared, or hoped for. What has not been clear is that if we do not solve this problem then no other solutions will matter, because this deeply embedded conflict will simply compensate and leave us in essentially the same intractable dilemma. But if we do find the collective insight or resolve to solve this problem, the scale and depth and dynamic nature of it means that not only will other solutions become available, they will by and large become completely unnecessary. The entire nature of the game will change.

It is a fundamental problem protected by ignorance and fear. But it is also a fundamental solution that stands to fall away in a singular wildfire event that will only take a small bit of kindling in just the right place to ignite.

In the end it is not because this insight points to such a great and unnoticed opportunity that it is compelling, it is because it points to such a great and unrecognised underlying problem – one that will outsmart any surface level efforts to improve any aspect of our lives that directly impinge on its purpose being fulfilled. So it is not just that this will work, as much as finally realising how effectively any failure to achieve this will prevent anything else from working.

We can now finally begin to see the true nature of the trap, and where we have been stuck. This epic, stable, and dynamic individual conundrum is the true problem. And so solving it is the true answer. All else is futile. All else is ignorance.

We have two basic options – we fix this, or we fix nothing.

Therefore, because common culture is a reflection of the individual state, and because the individual state is fundamentally centred around the active denial and avoidance of a very significant and vast event, any culture that seeks to reverse the debilitating effects of such cowardice will be founded on what is effectively an antidote to the forces which make common culture shallow. It is an immediate licence to fathom the deep, in yourself and in others. It provides not only maps and incentive, but ultimately imperative. There is a massive secret we are all keeping from each other, and from ourselves, and supporting that process is the underlying social contract. But this great secret is at last about to be revealed, and put up on the table for all to see, which will make an hour in such a context more intimate and real and healing than a lifetime in common culture.

What we are looking for is NOT a matter of will. If we have to rely on will, we are basically screwed. We need an answer that will spread as fast as Crack, without any coercion whatsoever. We need technology to unlock an intensely desired potential that will, beyond that point, become effectively free.

This is what soft power means: it is attraction in action. This dam is bursting with latent energy, there are already millions of people who have bravely abandoned common culture, but who have really got no idea where else to go. The alternative has not become clear, and that is because the essential defining template or primer has been missing. But that has now emerged, at least in outline. And will continue to develop as fast as support allows. This was the hard part, but this part is now done.

This kind of event is essentially over long before you even see it coming. And what this means is that if you are reading this, then it is essentially over now.

The final points are these:

- This is new.
- You would never find this.
- It is huge.
- It is near.

The only thing that was missing was the primer, the template, the essential anatomy of it. And that is now here. Once it happens, we will be left wondering how it possibly took so long to emerge, because it was so incredibly easy once we simply knew where to look.

So that's it. All the options you imagine or work towards, all the cultural revolutions, all the technological developments – they all exist in and are bound by the narrow disequilibrium of the terminally conflicted common state. When you eventually have access to the sum of all human knowledge instantly...when your genome has been restored to allow you to live 150-300 years...and when we have learned how to desalinate water via limitless energy from cold fusion in a teacup...you will still be left struggling to undo this seemingly intractable emotional knot, because none of those things will touch this.

Truly, all of those things will only be harnessed to further amplify the actual dilemma you suffer from, one which all of common culture both reflects and thereby entrenches. You might even be happy, but it will not be the easy and natural form of happiness you were born to expect. It will be an expensive and demanding form of happiness based on the sophisticated mitigation of a massive and unnecessary conundrum deep in your own

being. It will be a proxy state, in the same way as sophisticated counterterrorism is never the same as true peace, equality, and freedom.

Perhaps some kind of final summary, then: we generally conceive of our individual concerns as being in conflict with collective ones. We generally imagine that what is best for the world involves personal sacrifice. But what if our two biggest problems – the individual and the collective – were actually being caused by the same thing? What might this mean? What if they are not only related, but actually the same?

What if the happiness you have been looking for turns out not to be the ethical problem you imagine? What if that alone can solve our growing global crisis? And what if the solution to both of those things was inherently profound in depth, and dramatic in scale? What if reality ends up being more consoling than fantasy ever could?

At some level, if it is true, you already know all this. You already know exactly what I am talking about, because you have existed there forever. That's why your current state is unhappy, that's why it hurts, because you cannot shake the recollection, the certainty somehow, that there is something else, something better, and deeper, and much more free. And this is what now begins to open up, as if out of nowhere. But it was, paradoxically, and all around you – right in front of you all along.

So where will it come from? If you support what is emerging here, then it will come from you. You will get to say that you were there when it all began, and that you were part of it. Or you can attack it, and thereby support it once again, merely by bringing awareness to it. Or you can do nothing at all, and it will make no difference, not if at least a few others do choose to look. It will change you regardless in that case, because an event at this scale - requiring only information in an information age - has essentially already happened by the time you even see it coming.

PART TWO

The Life You Desire

Imagine for a moment that life was like this: we were all on a different journey of expression, discovery and adventure, and that the destination of that journey was unique to each of us. But that somehow along the way we all fell into the same big hole. Meaning that we can no longer see where we are going, and that even if we could we would have trouble getting there.

The subject of the remainder of this work is this big hole, something we all share, it is something we all have in common. But you are a unique person, there is one thing which makes you different from anyone else, and that is where we will begin here. Because that is what this common affliction has stolen from you.

Your own unique path or calling is what I am pointing at here, as defined by your own deepest nature or yearning.

What we are talking about here then is the life you desire. The life of your dreams. And the point is that for you that is different than anyone else, which means I can be of almost no help when it comes to assisting you with the actual content of that creation. But I may be able to at least offer a few tips about what it takes to embrace such a life, just in case you were considering such.

What we are looking for here is a ‘story’, in particular – ‘your story’.

Culture is a story in a sense, or a collection of such you could say, and the stories it tells allow us to explain or express some of our experience. But common culture tends to run out of really good narratives when it comes to the really deep stuff. Myth, in the sense Joseph Campbell defined such, is a way of expressing the parts of ourselves that we can’t otherwise share or validate. The surface structure of a mythic allegory is not important, what is important is what it touches within us, and how.

In particular what mythic allegories offer is a way of gaining access to our own deeper selves, and also a way of expressing such to others. They help us form and develop this ornamental bridge, or what might be called your social mask. Masks are what, then? The persona, in psychological terms, is the animated boundary between self and world, it is an agent of self-expression. We all have masks that we wear in different contexts, but the idea here is that our overall expression should be an accurate and appropriate reflection of who we truly are beneath. In particular a mask that is too light will inevitably repress all the dark within us, and this will dam up and eventually flood us. Or you could imagine your mask as a tapestry woven from the authentic threads which issue forth at your core, and an inappropriate expression being anything that leaves too many left over threads which will in time begin to weave a sub persona which will seek expression in some other way.

This kind of rift is common, and is what psychotherapy generally seeks to explore and resolve. The stuff we don’t like, which our masks act to censor, is what we call our shadow self.

The ideal function of the mask is not to censor or control, it is to open and express. It is a means of allowing us expression of our deepest experiences, and of allowing others to share and gain access to such within us. It is a doorway to our depths, and an access portal to the depths in others.

The idea, then, is to find your true story and the mask that represents it. To find and express who you truly are, and thereby allow others into that realm. The mask given to you by family and cultural expectation is always a false mask, and so the first thing you need to know about becoming authentic is that it will demand at least some ability to stand alone.

Foremost amongst the functions of a healthy and adaptive persona or mask, and the story beneath it – be that mythic or otherwise – is its relationship to your own deepest vision, truth or desire. This is the traffic this bridge will carry into the world, and so this will be our focus here. Because once we know what this is – what tune we are dancing to – the rest is easy.

Firstly, I have to show my hand by explaining that all of this is a trick. None of this works. Well, that's not true entirely, for most people great gains can be made by applying even some of the things outlined here. But in the final analysis there is a problem with this approach. It will get you off the ground if you push it hard, but it won't generally fly very high. And that is not because it is wrong. It is because it is exactly right.

This section is in fact a summary of ideal functioning as it relates to what we feel, and how we act as a result. Which is precisely what has been afflicted. And so, as we journey through this territory, we will on the one hand be outlining the way things should naturally be, and on the other gaining direct evidence that something is not quite right, and that the huge issue I will be explaining in the remainder of this work is actually hidden right there in front of us, in plain sight.

The upshot of which is that you will find that like most people you probably do not know what you really want. Or that, even if you think you know, if you get what you imagine that to be you will likely remain somewhat unsatisfied and therefore begin searching again. Which is very frustrating.

This is what it means to be in this hole. So I am in a somewhat awkward position here. I already know what you want. Anyone who understands even the basic outlines of what is really going on with common humanity probably knows more about what you really want than you do, even by some considerable margin. Because, actually, in this case everybody wants the same thing.

No matter who they are, or what journey they were once on – what they now want is to get out of this hole. What they really want is to be able to know what they really want. And to do that they have to firstly understand the nature of this hole, and secondly what getting out of it might mean.

The single most important thing there is to know about this hole is that we don't even know we are in it. Awareness of this has, until now, been completely absent from common culture even though we do already deal with all of the downstream effects of such. We just don't have any clear idea where they come from.

If we turn this around, and address the positivity that is being disturbed: happiness is the subject here, and we all grow up with some view of it – what it is, and where it might be found. But what is remarkable is how few people ever really consider it deeply. We all come to believe certain things about it, and often define our entire lives around these beliefs, but yet most still never bother to examine these basic assumptions. And perhaps this is because most people around us share these conceptions, and also our typical frustrations. To struggle to be happy is often considered completely normal. But why?

Let's have a closer look at it: the world tells us that happiness is basically the fulfilment of desire. You very likely already presume this. And do I disagree? No. It is pretty simple, at least on the surface of it. Because if this is truly the case then it sets the foundations for a very matter of fact view of life, and actually quite a simple approach to being happy. If it really is that simple then all we need to do is embrace what we desire, and work to achieve that. It's not rocket science.

If you take a deeper look at this simple equation, a very elementary structure emerges in relation to life itself, and to our notion of self. It would appear that as 'conscious experiencers' of life that we stand at the boundary of two distinct worlds – the inner world of feeling and impulses, and the outer world of relationships and objects. And that happiness is something which we, as dwellers on this threshold, consciously experience.

In some sense our entire lives could be seen as being defined by the relationship between these three things. So what is the connection here, how does it work? And what is the best arrangement?

Desire is an inner phenomenon. But fulfilment of such is not, this is an outer phenomenon generally. So which comes first?

If we look at the basic outlines of all this I believe it is possible to see that there is a causal relationship here. A functional cooperation – Three separate parties in some kind of dynamic relationship.

If happiness really is the fulfilment of desire, then what is desire? Desire is emotional attachment to an outcome not yet achieved. So what happens to desire when such fulfilment is found? It disappears, and in its place there is emotional peace and harmony – happiness.

Desire, then, could in some very real sense be seen as a disturbance of the natural peace and harmony which would otherwise exist emotionally. It would seem to exist in order to disturb the conscious self, and spur it into action. Does the conscious self produce desire then? No. It would appear to be entirely subject to the influence of emotional tension, including desire.

It has to be asked, then, if happiness = desire/satisfaction, then why not just negate desire? Surely that is easier than going to all that trouble of fulfilling it? Can we turn desire off then, if we don't like it? A bit of an oxymoron perhaps – not liking what you like.

To which the answer seems to be : Yes. Any emotional process can be repressed by the force of will. But not without turning off all emotional experience in the process – including happiness. So we can avoid or in some way 'not feel' things emotionally, and thereby turn desire down, but also all other emotional states, including happiness.

It seems we are supposed to feel it. Which leaves us once again with the same crucial realisation about what it means to be human:

To NOT FEEL how unhappy you are is not the same thing as BEING HAPPY.

I am going to repeat that a few times by the end of this work, because it will keep being reconfirmed in many contexts. 'Happiness' and 'not feeling' are mutually exclusive terms, as previously indicated.

All of which leaves us with one obvious conclusion – The most secure and obvious way for the conscious self to avoid the tensions associated with desire, is to act to fulfil it. This would seem to be the only way to retain a full emotional life, and thereby retain our whole capacity to be happy. It also begins to tell us about the very purpose of desire, and the function of the conscious self.

So where does desire come from, then? There is certainly a hint in all this that perhaps the conscious level of experience is not actually the boss here! What emerges if you look at all this deeply enough is that our own perception of conscious autonomy is to some degree a fabrication. It is a convenient façade belying the reality of this situation. And that is this – the body grew the mind for its own purposes, and through the production of emotional tension retains control over it. It is a relationship that makes sense.

Under this view the conscious level of experience is simply an intermediary. Its only purpose for existing is to serve the greater organism of which it is a part. It is a servant, not a master.

The outcomes being sought by the body are transactional ones, in relation to the environment, and the conscious level is the go-between. Emotional tension is leverage, and the conscious self has evolved so as to remain subject to the influence of such. If not, then the body would not have been able to maintain its basic requirements, and would have perished. So the mind (conscious self) has a job to do, and if it does that well it is rewarded with something it enjoys (emotional bliss), and if not it is disturbed with emotional tension of some kind (unhappiness).

As a motivational system it is simple and beautiful. It basically ensures adherence by the conscious level of life to the dictates of the deeper level from where desire emerges. The body grew the mind and uses emotion as both whip and carrot to motivate it, and retain control.

Desire is a creative force, then. It forcibly arranges circumstances so as to conform to its own specifications – or, more accurately, to the outcome chosen by the organism at a deeper level. Circumstances do not produce or determine desire. Some might say that circumstances do actually do this when they offer temptation – but this is not the creation of desire. It is actually only the stimulation of latent or repressed desire already existing. If you are not presently hungry, no kind of food will represent temptation. Temptation is always only the direct result of prior repression. So to find yourself saying 'lead me not into temptation' is to tacitly admit to already having been led into repression.

You cannot fake true happiness. You do not get a choice. You can only ignore, fulfil or repress true desire. And only one of these options results in happiness.

So the most secure and obvious way for the conscious self to avoid the tensions associated with desire is to act to fulfil it. This would seem to be the only way to retain a full emotional life, and thereby retain our full capacity to be happy.

This could, in fact, be the very reason the conscious self even exists. And so to not understand and respect this basic process, or to limit it in some way, is probably an obvious recipe for suffering. The conscious level cannot thwart or ignore desire without suffering in the process, and it cannot repress or 'not feel' it without sacrificing its own capacity for feeling in general, and thereby its ability to experience happiness.

The reason all this might be worth knowing is pretty simple – that if happiness is something we consciously experience, and if it pretty much results from the fulfilment of desire, and if desire is seeking outward change, then if we can know what desire is basically seeking then we can be ahead of the game and perhaps even assure happiness permanently.

This means, rather than forever being shunted along the path like a donkey being whipped by desire, if we can discern where we are basically heading then we can run out ahead, and in doing so never again feel the whip of desire on our conscious hide. Or even better, if we can figure out the final destination of this path, maybe we can even gallop off and lay there in the sun, amongst the flowers, eating carrots. Happiness. Why not?

Which is not what most people do of course. Most people are, like donkeys, pretty stupid in this sense. And I am not being mean here actually, as we will see later there are some pretty good reasons for this, but the fact is that for whatever reasons they are too short sighted to see their own highest potential. Most people adopt a pretty short term view, which for the most part sees them simply reacting to circumstances with immediate desire or aversion, and never really stopping to consider the bigger picture of their lives or what – for their own unique character or values – greater happiness might ultimately look like.

So what would happen if we did do this? What would happen if we decided to take this deeper view, to apply what we already basically presume about happiness to its ultimate degree? And why don't we do this already? After all, it seems pretty simple. If happiness is the fulfilment of what we desire, then we need only clarify what we are looking for, embrace that, and then act to fulfil it. The desire part being an inner thing, and the fulfilment part being an outer thing. From a conscious perspective we seem to be in a perfect position to access both, and to bring these two things into perfect alignment. Why not? If that's all there is to it, then how hard could it be?

The answer here then, for the conscious self, is to know everything it can about what it desires. And then in the wake of such, to develop all the skills and attributes possible to assure the highest fulfilment of such. Which if you examine it is pretty much what we are already doing, but if only by degrees. So what if we did it properly? Why don't we simply abandon ourselves to this openly? Why are we so scared? Could it be that we don't feel that we deserve to have what we really want?

What we are talking about here then is the formulation and integration of all desire (inner) into a seamless process of creation and change management (outer), and in the process the stable realisation of emotional bliss – otherwise known as happiness.

An allegory for this might be to take all the ingredients you have rolling around your pantry of desire and to lay them all out on the kitchen table. And then to begin creatively exploring them in search of the ultimate recipe - your own unique recipe in a sense, one which makes best use of what you have the most of, but which also does not leave any elements out.

This process, then, can be a little challenging if we have never even been in the kitchen before. First of all it may involve the recovery of all the ingredients that we may have pushed to the back of the shelf because we never knew how to use them. And some of these might at first even seem a bit toxic – like mustard perhaps – until you understand where they fit, at which point you might also realise for the first time that, even though you don't need much, how indispensable they might eventually be to the final creation.

What we are talking about here is our entire body of desire, and really feeling it. Which can be uncomfortable of course, given that happiness and desire are opposites. In fact for many people this can be very scary, because of how raw and unprepared these emotional ingredients can be if they have not been taken out and developed previously. But this is what it takes. If what we are defining here is accurate then this is the true price of happiness.

The embrace and creative fulfilment of desire is the common definition of the path to happiness. So it is surprising how few people really take this at face value and live it. Because to the degree we limit or curtail this process, even at this first stage, the outcome will be to suffer. And this is because if, at the end of the day, we are left with ingredients still sitting on the shelf because we couldn't be bothered figuring out how they fitted into our recipe, then those elements will remain unfulfilled and forever represent a source of persistent unhappiness.

So the obvious key at this first stage is to dig deep, to ask the question without reservation, and embrace everything we find without judgement or discrimination. We don't get to choose what we want.

Altogether, the summary force of our deepest desires set a high bar that we somehow have to learn how to jump. If we lower the bar because we can't be bothered building up such strength, we will not find contentment. Our true passion will not simply vanish in the wake of such apathy, it will haunt our waking and sleeping worlds and quietly drive us mad. It will eat away at us from the inside out, forever reminding us that we are not being true to ourselves, and fulfilling our native potential.

If you set out to be less than you are capable of being, I warn you, you will be deeply unhappy for the rest of your life.

– Abraham Maslow

Let's say we are prepared to believe, then, prepared to believe in ourselves and to at least entertain the idea that we might actually deserve to be happy – to have our ultimate dreams fulfilled. And as a result we take the time. We dig deep within ourselves and although nothing is entirely clear we do sense some great body of yearning. There may be a few elements of that which are already clear, but likely quite a few which remain out of focus somehow, or just beyond reach. Yet we can feel them, and would certainly know if they were to find fulfilment.

Then comes the really creative part. What to make from all that? And this process is not what many people think it is. This is not a conscious act, this is not something you figure out with your conscious mind. The key to all this is the eventual formulation of an integrated vision for your life, one which is a true reflection of who you are at the deepest level, and which combines all your motivational streams into a single great river of force.

It is big. It is actually too much for the conscious mind to manage. And this is where many people get stuck, even if they have had the courage to really feel what they desire and connect with it. Because the one thing to know about this process, in fact every stage of this, is that it hurts. The point is not to look for the answer, but at this stage simply to ask the question. To let it burn you alive, to completely forget about the answer and simply stay with developing the question. That is the key here, at least as I understand it. It is this aching void itself which eventually pulls something new out of the ether, in a very tense moment of pure creation.

From nothing it will emerge, as a result of a vacuum, a tension you generated with your ability to simply feel this great question. The conscious mind is only capable of three points of concentration at any moment, whereas the unconscious mind is operating at 120,000 processes per second. The job of the conscious mind is simply to direct this event, to ask and develop the question, and to drive the unconscious mind as crazy as possible.

The sum of all desires is the sum of all emotional tension, so to ask the unconscious to find a way to weave all these ingredients together is to embrace a point of great tension. The true creative power of the conscious mind is in the roll of conductor, not musician or composer. The true composer is the unconscious mind, and the key is to apply the only leverage it understands – pressure. This is a heart thing then, not a head thing. It is about your own capacity to generate change by the strategic application of emotional leverage.

The conscious mind, in this situation, is simply stoking a fire, and throwing more and more ingredients into the pot. The fire is the heart, and the pot is the unconscious mind. It is the heat of this process which matters, and the full embrace of all ingredients. And you need to watch out for the sneaky unconscious, and learn how it works. Sometimes, because of the uncomfortable frustration experienced as an answer remains beyond conscious reach, there will be great unconscious temptation to lower the emotional heat so to speak, or to remove some of the more troublesome ingredients from the mix. But the key is to persist, to be fierce but patient. The unconscious mind moves slowly, and will take time to figure all this out. But it is also extremely powerful, and when the answer does finally arrive it will do so with a big thump as it is placed on the doorstep, already finished and in some essential sense complete.

This is all a matter of clarification and integration of many diverse elements into a seamless and single stream. Many threads into a single tapestry. And as these clusters of integration first begin to emerge they will often come in lumps. And these pieces will sometimes need to be unpacked, and organised, and this might even take some time. This part is conscious work.

The organisational part of the brain is completely different to the creative part – which is almost completely disorganised. And so to become focused on simply trying to organise what you feel or already know about what you desire is completely backwards. That will slow you down a lot. You have to accept the chaotic nature of pure creation, and allow it to deliver a nebulous but pungent result, something unexpected essentially, which can only then begin to be organised by the conscious mind.

So when do you stop? When do you release this question, and your heart's embrace of it? Never. No matter what comes, you never consider it a final answer. You simply keep developing and refining the questions, and generating this vacuum with all your might. It is a permanent state. The only release of tension possible in this embrace is the fulfilment of what it demands. The answer is to perpetually create the life this vision defines, and in the process to champion your own heart. The tension associated with this process does resolve however, but only as you approach and maintain the formulation of an accurate and worthy definition of what your life is all about, just as the resulting summary desire itself eventually subsides within the fulfilment of whatever it defines – which is what is meant by the term 'self actualisation' - the highest stage of personal development.

Happiness is a perpetual victory in a fight that never ends.

It is worth noting that any question can be answered this way actually. In this case, however, the question is perhaps the greatest one possible for the organic system that is asking it, given that the very purpose of the mind itself would seem to be the fulfilment of such desire and the organic needs that it represents.

Learning to manage tension strategically is to finally understand what it means to be dynamically creative. In this case the creative process is being applied internally, so as to produce an internal result – the formulation of an integrated picture of what you truly desire. But in another sense desire itself can also be seen as a tension, that it works in exactly the same way but that the outcomes it produces are generally more outward in nature.

Creativity, in the truly generative sense, is not a mystery then. It simply costs. In particular, it costs emotional tension. It involves a degree of suffering, and if what you create is significant, then that degree of suffering will generally be on an even par. So you obviously need to make sure it is worth it.

Creativity, and the driving of the unconscious mind to achieve feats impossible for the conscious mind, simply involves the embrace and careful management of great emotional tension.

The entire process we are outlining here can be assisted in many ways, it can be refined and economised, facilitated and supported in ourselves and in others around us. The skills associated with such a life are things which emerge over time as we persist. It is really pretty simple – the more time we spend in the kitchen the better we become at cooking.

Another way to look at all this, then, is that it is actually not so much a search for what you are going to cook from all the ingredients you are given, but more a search for what you really enjoy eating. If you want to be a good cook, you must first become really good at enjoying food. And raw ingredients often don't taste that good.

Your own emotional core is simply trying to tell you something. The formation of desire is not very intelligent in this sense. It is all presented raw, scattered, and sometimes a little awkwardly. This is the body's rudimentary attempt at something, it is searching for something, but it is having trouble communicating that to the conscious self. But the thing to understand is that it does actually know what it is looking for, even if it can't communicate it. It's like charades, it knows what it is trying to say, and will certainly recognise it if you do happen to put that together. In which case it will reward you kindly. The trick is to be creative, to fill in the gaps, and to try new things and think outside the square. Look for the pattern in the madness, the symphony within the scattered chords you find resounding through your deep inner landscapes. It is all a creative act, an ongoing process which – once begun – will develop and refine. From chaos to art. But only if we dare to begin.

What is the other option, then? In contrast to all this we could stop for a moment to examine the opposite approach. Is it possible to not do all of this? Is it possible to never learn to cook, or to perhaps never even go into

the kitchen at all? Could we somehow end up in a situation where we never manage tension in any creative way, or even realise that this is possible, and as a result never find stable fulfilment in life?

Obviously this would be very easy, maybe even too easy. Even with just the little we have outlined here we can see that there are many points at which all of this could fail, or become stalled, or otherwise falter. It could easily break down.

Actually, of course this is many people. Many people are almost completely unaware that this kind of life even exists, let alone what it might demand of them. They are not ever taught the most basic skills required to adopt this elementary relationship with themselves, and so become conformists instead of expressionists, sheep instead of wolves. And this makes them very easy to control and coerce, which is often precisely why these skills are not fostered at the crucial ages that matter.

So people grow up and look around and try to imagine what to do with their lives. But all too often the limitations inherent in childhood itself predispose them to think very conservatively about what is possible for themselves. They do not realise the power they have, or that to be truly happy is not a bad thing. They are taught all the way through childhood not to trust themselves, and to listen to others for guidance. They have forgotten how to cook, or even where the kitchen is. And as a result they look outside themselves for answers, and choose their life path from a list of options on a vocational guidance form. They simply follow the path of least resistance through a random landscape and eventually end up lost, confused and wandering in the wilderness. And so here, for most people, we see a radical alternative emerging.

It is actually possible to rip off whatever uniform you were given as you entered this world, and to begin to fashion something which far more accurately reflects who you really are. To begin once again to live life from the inside out, rather than the outside in. To find your own true music within, and have the courage to begin dancing to it.

The result of persisting with this question, then, is the eventual emergence of an integrated vision of life as you truly desire it. And this may come quietly or suddenly but the effect is the same – it will move you. Because without realising it the very act of asking this great question, in the way you have been doing, is to formulate a single and integrated definition of what you are seeking, which has not just one but many anchors deep into your own emotional core. And this is why people don't do it – it is because your own true passion is a wrecking ball, as well as the single greatest adventure you will ever embark upon. You do not get a choice about whether or not you will then follow it.

From the moment it emerges it is thundering hot. So if you do not want the life of your dreams, if you are not prepared to be who you really are and to make your own true mark on the world, then do not even begin this process. Because you will be sorry if you do.

The price of the discovery of your own true purpose, and the source of all deeper meaning in your life, is submission to it. The deeper the submission, the deeper the answer you will receive.

No submission = no answer.

What is the final stage here then? What do you do next once you have been prepared to really dig deep within yourself, and stay with the question until this vision finally becomes clear? Nothing really. The first parts done fully make this last part pretty simple in one sense. If you don't know where you are going you are lost. You never know what to do next, or how to find others to join you on your journey. But an integrated vision of life is a defining principle. The various paths you may travel are at every moment defined by the destination you have chosen. It is a high point from which the pendulum of behaviour and expression can freely swing, it tells you exactly what to do in every situation, and in a social sense it tells you who you are. Because as soon as you develop the ability to communicate this higher point to others, only then does it immediately become possible to discover what degree of alignment exists between yourself and others.

So the last part is less important in this sense, even though the fulfilment of such is the whole point of everything prior. But it simply tends to take care of itself – this is the very function of deeply anchored desire.

You will be moved, and you will simply end up doing whatever it takes. If you are not moved, then you either already have or are exactly what you are looking for, or you have missed something in the earlier stages.

Actually one of the great obstacles to the formation of an integrated vision is too much consideration of the 'how' part. We keep jumping ahead as the frustrated unconscious throws up answers to consider how we might possibly achieve them, or what they might cost. A kind of 'can I afford it?' approach to life. But this is completely backwards. The thing is to just ignore these early attempts and not follow them unless they meet absolutely all the criteria set in the formation of the great question itself. You just stay with the question, develop it even, make it harder. Whip the unconscious, understand its power and how much it hates emotional tension, how much it hates unanswered questions. And never consider the how part. Always imagine you will be given ultimate power and freedom, if only you embrace your truest desires, your deepest vision.

The point is that we often lower our standards down from what we really want, or feel strongly about, because we do not feel like we either deserve it or have the ability to achieve it. But the very fact that we settle for a creation which does not touch us most deeply is the reason we do not ever experience the power such might require. Which is to say – only your true passion carries the power necessary for its own fulfilment. Anything less will have less power. But conversely – if you are ready – your ultimate vision will come with ultimate power. You simply have to be ready to believe in that, to be prepared to embrace the tension required to drive your unconscious to integrate it, and be completely ready to submit to whatever emerges.

The rest is just courage and commitment, which even if you do not have them will simply arise out of the situation itself. Great things are just what ordinary people do in extraordinary situations. And in this case becoming an extraordinary person is not what we are doing. We are simply generating an extraordinary situation. Perhaps even a very uncomfortable situation in the beginning, because of the gap between what you desire and what you actually have. But also a most creative situation, due to the power of that tension to change the circumstances of your life over time.

So people often wait until they are ready, they delay their passion. But you know what, you are never ready – in the end you just do it.

It is even possible to be given this answer – the key to the singular integration of all your desires. This happens all the time in smaller ways, but there are also many examples throughout history of spontaneous embrace of a solution to this inner question which came from an outer source. Some people simply want to make a difference, and need only find the most powerful way that fits their own resources and capacities. And it is certainly possible to be given such a recipe.

You need only find a path worthy of your time and energy, and in embracing such discover the foundations of a meaningful life. In just the same way as great recipes have emerged over time, the one you are looking for – or at least significant parts of it – might already exist. You never know, you just have to keep your eyes open, and always be asking the question so that you will recognise such an answer if ever you see it. Your defining purpose could easily be to become part of something greater, something with a degree of significance any individual effort could never attain.

There are obviously many things which might stand in the way of this process for some people, mostly the result of fear or conditioning from their past. Nevertheless, this path remains available to all who are prepared to make a commitment to themselves, and to the world.

And I mention the world here because it is important. One major stumbling block here is that people don't trust themselves. They don't trust the fact that they are basically good, and that if they were given the chance to have everything they wanted that they would almost certainly discover what so many have found over time – the one thing which is so simple and profound but which the very failure to pursue our own true vision prevents us from realising a – and that is that it is far greater to give than to receive. We are only selfish because we are hungry, and we are hungry because we do not wholeheartedly follow our own dreams.

We do not put ourselves first. And so we doubt, and always pull back. We perhaps imagine that if we somehow remain unfulfilled that we will consume less, and therefore there will be more for others. We imagine that if we ever really let go that we would consume everything in our wake.

But the reality for most is very different. The more fulfilled we are, the less we consume. Beyond the fulfilment of need and desire at the lower levels things change, and we eventually follow our passion down an unexpected path – that of service. And this is not altruism. It is the highest form of healthy self centeredness. It is to

understand once and for all that to give really is better than to receive, on purely self centred grounds. It simply feels better. But more importantly it is to realise this – you cannot give from an empty cup. The condition of truly powerful benevolence is powerful overflow. You must – if you are going to give a lot – do so from an overflowing cup. Meaning that your own happiness becomes a priori to the emerging path. But – and this is important – this outcome should not be pre-empted or mechanically sought. It is a natural flowering of the path of true selfishness. It is the highest form of selfishness. Which, I suppose, is not selfishness really, but overflowing self centeredness.

We doubt our own desires, we hold them back because we imagine we are only selfish. But this is not the case. Trust yourself. “If you love something, set it free...”

There are many layers and extensions to all this, and many more things to know which the longer form of this work must eventually capture, but what we have outlined here is the basic structure of what it takes to live a life of power and passion, and in some very real sense to know what you truly want – and, therefore, to know who you truly are.

Some of the questions you might begin by asking yourself if you embarked on this journey of self expression might be something like these -

- What am I better at than anyone else alive?
- What do I have more of than anyone?
- If someone walked up to me and showed me what I have always really wanted, or wanted to say, would you recognise it?
- What would it feel like, looking back, if I achieved my vision? (Of course your destination could be a process, but the same question applies.)
- What do I really love doing, more than anything else?
- What is the single most important thing in the world? What is the second...etc
- What would I die for, without even a moment of hesitation?
- If someone who really knew the ‘secret me’ visited this place after I was gone, how could they tell that I had been here? What mark will I leave?
- If I knew I was about to die, what is the one thing I would wish I had been given time to do, or finish, or create, or change?
- If I could live my life again from the start, what would I do differently?
- If an all knowing and benevolent being was given my body and situation tomorrow, with a mission to produce as much positive change as possible, what could they achieve with it by the time it was spent?
- If I was single and met someone new, what would I put on the table up front as unconditional aspects of who I am? What are the things which are more important to me than any relationship? (if you do not have such, then you are truly lost, and good relationships will elude you forever – because such things are what define good relationships, and destroy bad ones.)
- If you had one chance to say something to the world, one opportunity to express what really needs to be said, what would you say?

Another possible key to defining your own highest vision is to understand that the essential pattern or crux will not ever consist of common ingredients. It will not be found in the common elements such as food or love or sex or money or status or in having children. All of these are things that everybody needs to some degree, they are common desires. The kind you might find in your cereal packet. The things you are looking for are X-factors, something beyond all that, something that you will likely not find but which you will need to create. Something only you could create, something which is more than the sum of its parts. Something novel, something profound, something completely unexpected. Something never seen before. And most importantly something which for you has very great meaning.

So if you think you want to fall in love and be rich and famous you have completely missed it. That’s a hedgehog dream, and it will never come true. That’s junk food. It is not specific, not concrete, and in that dream all the spicy stuff is still left on the shelf. You only want that because you have never had it. Because if you had, you would find that it still leaves you wanting.

Money simply amplifies things, it is just energy. So if you are confused or negative then this will just turn the volume up and make it unbearable. What do you think Elvis died of?

All this is a direct search for meaning, and a sense of completeness. And that will not be found in ‘relative’ terms – in your relationship to what others have or do not have, but in ‘absolute’ terms – in the relationship of your life to your own true values and inbuilt sense of purpose.

It is a relationship with your own heart. So nobody can tell you what that is for you, only you know this answer. It is sacred to you, which does not mean it is private. Sharing this with others is perhaps the most powerful thing you can do. Talking about it always helps to engage your unconscious mind. But the answer will not be defined by what others have or do, but by values which come only from deep within yourself.

Conclusion

Does it work? Can our own hearts be trusted? Should we really just embrace what we feel, and follow it without reservation?

Yes. It is right, it is even completely natural, but there are reasons why we do not already embrace this approach without reservation. So no, it does not work as we imagine it would. Desire, the very axiom around which all of this functions, is not as integrated as we might expect. It should be, it makes sense that it would be, but it is not. And this only becomes really clear when we take it out of the car park and really get it rolling. Which is all very strange indeed considering the body is extremely integrated in relation to what it needs.

The body does all fit together and make sense, and so we should naturally expect desire to do the same. But that’s not what we generally see. So is this entire approach faulty, then, is it wrong? No. It is exactly right. There is simply a deeper problem. The game is not fair. Something has occurred at a level that consciousness cannot access, between the body and the formation of desire, and this explains everything we see in the world today. It explains why we consume so much, it explains why we remain unhappy in a sea of abundance, and it explains why consciousness cannot fix this problem, or even clearly identify it. Because a conflict in the integrity of desire forms an intractable dilemma for consciousness. Consciousness is not intended to be able to look beneath the level of emotion. That is the equivalent of an elected official rigging votes.

The implications of this basic assertion are very deep. It is even possible to still discern your own true passion or calling in this situation, but the burden of conflict will have to be carried as that moves toward fulfilment. Meaning that for most people there is no answer to this dilemma by following what you desire.

In this case your emotional compass cannot lead you to happiness, ever. And this is why we live in a world which abounds in mistrust of self, and imposed codes of behaviour – where the ethic toward ‘we’ and away from ‘me’ is imposed on the weak and controlled masses, rather than fostered as a natural expression or flowering of true individual freedom and power.

If you can do this, then, if you can put your own puzzle back together, then you are very lucky. But if not, do not be dismayed. Your adversary is formidable. Keep asking. Keep pushing. Never give up. There is an answer to all this, even if it remains a little complex and unrefined at this time. It is coming. And the nature of that answer means that it could all eventually unfold like a domino cascade.

The hole we are all stuck in is perhaps more akin to water stuck behind a dam, and that even one small hole could spell great change for everyone. As many people simultaneously recognise the key to their own recipe, the embrace of such could ignite a mighty process of change.

So we should never stop asking this question – “what do I want?”. Because even to understand this hole and to find your way free of it will not take you to your final destination. It will simply free you to begin that journey, and allow the process outlined in this section to occur naturally. So remember everything said in this section, because we will eventually return here as this journey comes full circle.

What are we all waiting for, then? There is obviously something askew here, a spanner in the works. Which is a very big problem. But accordingly, resolving this represents another whole possibility. The greatest move in any game is one which changes the rules. Everything you see here as evidence of something not quite right is just the visible tip of a far greater iceberg. To see what that really means, and what we might do about it all, we will have to go deeper again.

PART THREE

The Nature of Happiness

As a species we are the most complex organic structure on this planet so far, and whilst this might seem to make us special, nevertheless every element of our functioning reflects the same basic principles of development as any other organism. These principles account for all of it. Everything - including what we call happiness - has a functional reason for existing as it does. As a species we hold no intrinsically special status amongst animals. We were merely the first to reach a certain point and realise capacities which gave us a particular edge.

As species develop, they acquire more capacity to respond to their environment in complex ways, and therefore require functions which are capable of managing these transactions in an ever changing world. So I will make a distinction here – between the lower or base organism, and the higher functions which help that organism govern its relationships. The higher and more recent systems and functions of emotion and mind emerged to serve the interests of the lower organism, and are intrinsically set up so as to be governed or influenced by the lower and its concerns. The body required these functions as it – and its relationship with the changing environment – became more complex, so it developed them. This is evolution in a nutshell.

So how does the body control the mind? Well, first of all, there is no mind without a body, so that is pretty strict control. Absolute dependency is implied. But beyond this ultimate sanction, what influence does the body exert on these higher functions to ensure that they act on its behalf? After all, they are given control of the whole ship. The ‘modes of influence’ are what the ‘executive functions’ of mind and the conscious persona experience as ‘emotion’.

Emotion is systemic tension designed to produce action and change. The conscious frontal self maintains the outward appearance of autonomy, but is actually a product of many underlying operations moment to moment, and is designed to be directly subject to the energetic influence of the body, via the generation of emotion.

So how does emotion motivate the higher functions? In contrast to emotive tension, undisturbed emotive energy is designed to feel good to the conscious self. It is therefore via the direction of these polarities that integrity is insured between higher and lower.

Surface (mind) is the puppet, core (body) is the puppet master, and in between (emotions) are the strings.

So the higher, more complex systems of emotion and mind are deeply connected to the primary physical organism. This may seem obvious, but I mean this in a very literal sense. It would seem that most or even all of the higher emotive and mental functioning the human organism has developed has been necessarily and directly interwoven with elements of very basic organic functioning.

Like those elected to govern a country, the higher functions have emerged with this primary connection not only so that they will remember who is the servant and who is the master, but also as a functional platform from which to gain the integrity they require merely to operate. Like tying a fragile and spindly tree to a powerful and straight post, it gives the higher functioning its source of strength and resilience, by rooting it in, and connecting it to, the most basic elementary functioning of the organism as a whole. Without this, the more refined and less ‘physical’ functioning becomes, the more susceptible it would be to losing integrity. It could easily forget who it is working for, go off on some tangent, and never come back. It could ignore its very purpose or reason for being. Of course it would not survive such a foray ultimately because of the implied dependency, but neither would the body survive such, so this integrity has been ensured by evolution. So this grounding means that - at least to some degree - to bend the optimum and healthy functioning of mind and emotions out of shape, you must also inevitably bend the body. And the body, at its most primary level, will assert itself. After millions of years of evolution, and being pushed around, the equilibrium of the physical organism is very robust – it knows how to push back.

So just to repeat that – to hold the mind or emotions off balance, you must be prepared to hold the body off balance, and confront the tensions associated with doing that. Thus, the body is both the single beneficiary of all this higher functioning, as well as its primary source of its functional integrity. The mind’s job is to look after the body, that is its only reason for existing. And the job of emotion is to connect the two, the right way around.

Which is precisely what we see...Ain't evolution marvellous!

Happiness and Need Fulfilment –

We should examine this a bit deeper here actually, because this fundamental connection is persistently overlooked in common culture.

Science will tell you that happiness is purely metaphysical. Which is to say – because we can't poke it, it does not exist. Which is complete bullshit of course. It is happiness, or should I say the lack of such, that is consuming the planet. It is an empirical reality, at least in effect.

So how can subjective phenomenon be seen as real? They are as real as the projections on the screen of a movie theatre. Not real in the sense that when a bomb goes off on the screen, the screen is damaged, or when it rains on screen, the screen gets wet, but real nevertheless in the sense that something real is watching them, and being affected by what they see. It is subjective phenomena that determine behaviour, and also a large degree of general wellbeing. Which together determine many things in the 'real' world.

There is a fundamental or elementary relationship here, and to put this happiness-need connection into its necessary context we will have to go back to the beginning. It is important, and I am spending time on it here because we will need it later.

The body grew the mind. Not as any matter of intentionality, but in the same way as galaxies spiral or crystals form along a particular matrix a certain degree of order appears to be intrinsic to the way matter organises itself.

Everything flows toward entropy and disorder overall, but not completely – there is also order arising in almost equal measure, a process of patterned complexity clearly exists within that downward flow.

In other words, as the river of universal change flows downstream, occasional whirlpools will form and even move upstream at times, always driven by the downward flow. Life itself is such an event spiral, doomed from its inception, but also destined to be what it is fully, until it fades away.

That's all life is – an event spiral. An isolated and temporary upwardly complex event, within a general downward flow. From atoms to molecules to cells to organs to organisms life emerges, and with every stage of development – more need. Complexity is a burden, costly to construct, and costly to maintain. So with every new need must arrive some new advantage.

If it costs more to have it, it must therefore confer some advantage, or at least not push the organism over the tipping point of non sustainability. If an organism was unlucky enough to mutate and develop something which cost more to maintain, but delivered no equivalent advantage in acquiring such fulfilment, it generally perished as it lost its battle against the blind destructive forces of the environment. In this way the very destructive tendency of the universe, which prevents complexity from arising in the first place, is the very thing which drives its upward development toward more complexity once it has a foothold.

Of all the things which define organic structure, and the way it sustains complexity over time, the foremost is the relationship of energy to form. The more complex the form, the more energy required to maintain such. And in this way, in the most elementary sense possible, all organic structure represents a very simple bounded economy where costs (complexity) must always be outweighed by gains (available energy). And this is why the most basic or fundamental principle of all life is always the same – acquire energy. Life is all about the acquisition and management of energy, in some way you could say that this is all life is. Life is simply and only material that, due to the form of its organisation, directs energy toward the maintenance of its own complexity over time, against the general flow of universal destruction which is always trying to pull everything apart.

This connection, then (the imperative that all emergent complexity must confer equal or more advantage than the need it generates) is what enforces integrity between the basic organic level of an organism, and all of its 'higher' level functioning and need fulfilment strategies.

In other words, if the destructive tendencies of the universe mean the body grew the mind in order to look after its concerns, then the body had to make sure it retained control over the mind, and made sure it did not simply waste all that energy and information processing on meaningless pursuits.

It also means that for the body to gain the benefits of such advanced functional technology, it must to that same degree surrender control to it. So there is clearly a need for some kind of accountability and motivation in this situation, lest the mind forget who it is working for.

In the human brain, then, we see three major stages of development – the reptilian brain stem, the mammalian brain, and the frontal cortex. The physical, the emotional, and the mental brains respectively.

The basic connection I am seeking to draw here is that a necessary pattern exists here, a pyramid of integrity with physical at the base, emotions in the middle, and mental at the top. And a hierarchy of sorts, with the more elementary organic level of the organism generating emotion, which in turn directs and governs the processes of mind. And it is all for the body ultimately – the body has a mind, not the other way around.

There is, in fact, just the body. It is all just the body, and the body will die, as will the entire process of evolution it is a part of. But in the meantime, that process of evolution has ensured a degree of integrity in the functioning of the organism, a remarkable degree of such in fact.

So what about happiness? Is it an emotion then? No. Emotion (as a systemic tension) has been defined by evolutionary imperatives to make sure the body retains control of the mind, and therefore intrinsically represents the organism's primary needs. And so it comes from the body, and has the intended and deliberate power to disturb and upset the mind. And also motivate it, providing it with the energy it requires to function.

In particular, we find the basic and elementary drive toward the acquisition of energy represented at the higher levels as what we tend to call 'feeling'. Quality of feeling expressly represents the presence or absence of surplus or free energy, and thereby ensures that the mind – which enjoys such – is always motivated toward maintaining optimum health and functional integrity. Which works because surpluses only occur once all structural needs are met and integrity is being upheld. Depth of feeling, in similar fashion, ensures that this motivational foundation encompasses all aspects and levels of the organism in a single span. And this is why we always want to feel good, and feel deeply, at the same time.

What we see here are three levels, all covered by 'feeling' in a single span –

The mind: Free attention = bliss

Emotion: Free energy = bliss

The body: Need fulfilment = bliss

And on the basis of need fulfilment, free energy and attention = not just an emotion, for it is a much deeper state involving all three levels in unity, true triple bliss. Happiness.

Happiness has a day job

Fortunately, actual organic needs are quite simple to fulfil. There is a continuum of potential need fulfilment, a spectrum, from 'completely met' at one end, to 'completely thwarted' at the other. Completely healthy at one end, and completely...well... dead, at the other.

We are talking about the base level of the pyramid here, the source and purpose of all the rest. The body. The actual physical organism, with all of its various systems, structures, and processes.

Unmet □-----BODY-----□ Met

So there is an emotional concomitant for every stage of that spectrum – completely blissful at one end, and completely tense at the other. And above that as well – the associated mental state resulting – completely active and disturbed at one end, and at rest in stillness at the other.

Another interesting observation here is that the perfect or ideal state all this functioning is seeking to achieve, is singular and integrated. There is a singular definable desired outcome, an achievable one. And that, by definition, everything other than that is some degree of dysfunction.

The positive end of this spectrum is singular and integrated, and the negative end is scattered and infinitely diverse. There are a million sources of unhappiness, but only one source of happiness, if happiness does indeed represent need fulfilment. Like the winning number in a lotto, a million wrong combinations, but only one right one.

So what is the task that the higher functions are charged with achieving? The conscious self of the mind is rewarded when it does its job well...so what is its job?

Well, normally, you would simply say that its job is to follow what it feels, in that this would be to respect the correct chain of command within the organic system, and thereby ensure overall integrity. But let's look deeper for a moment – what should the governing energies of emotion be directing the mind toward?

Obviously, the body is seeking its own highest good. So the ideal transaction would be one that ensures and maintains the optimum physical state, both internally within the organism, and externally in relation to its environment. And the body makes sense, it is truly integrated and seamless in its requirements necessary for equilibrium. So if you examine the primary organic agenda these higher functions and their governing emotions serve, you can imagine that an ideal point of integrity is possible - an optimum relational state which serves the organism best.

What I mean is that because all authentic primary level needs are met in direct relational transaction with the environment, that an ideal transaction can be assumed to be possible. Therefore, imagine a single transaction which integrates all relational needs into one relational stream, a perfect and seamless symphony of need fulfilment, with energy to spare.

This is the cake the frontal self is charged with baking, from the ingredients provided to it as emotion, by the body – emotion which contains all the motive energy required for the fulfilment of this agenda. And so, if there is integrity between higher and lower as we are presuming, because the higher systems are charged with finding and maintaining this ideal physical state at the lower level, then the basic trajectory of this lower agenda can be expected to be reflected at an emotional level as a potential culmination point of all positive emotional states. So that the ultimate point of organic fulfilment is represented in the ideal transactional state, which has its counterpart at the highest level, as the culmination point of all emotional states. They should match.

Which is, I believe, exactly what we see. At a primary organic level we see a continuum of potential functioning ranging from ideal health and relational **'wellbeing'** at one end, to all manner of **'unhealth'** and struggle at the other. And we also see that same continuum reflected at an emotional level, with its own distinct polarities - **happiness** and **unhappiness**.

Happiness and unhappiness, in this context, are simply general terms we use to indicate the overall positive/negative balance produced by many emotive functions as we navigate our way toward the fulfilment of an agenda which is not actually emotional at all, but much deeper than that. What we are actually doing is fulfilling need. Positive emotional states are simply our reward for a job well done. So, emotive functions do not exist for their own sake, or just to make us constantly feel good or bad. They represent a conglomerate of underlying primary level transactional concerns.

The primary organic level is the business, free energy is the bank balance, and happiness-unhappiness is the pay offered to the CEO for doing a good job.

These two levels, then, are directly associated functionally, and should naturally move together. The positive end of both levels being singular and integrated, whilst the negative polarities being scattered and infinitely diverse.

Happiness, then, very simplistically, is not an emotion, but the state of positive accord between the three levels of this functional hierarchy. It represents a pinnacle ideal as defined by the nature and functioning of the system itself, it is a point of positive integrity toward which all this activity strives.

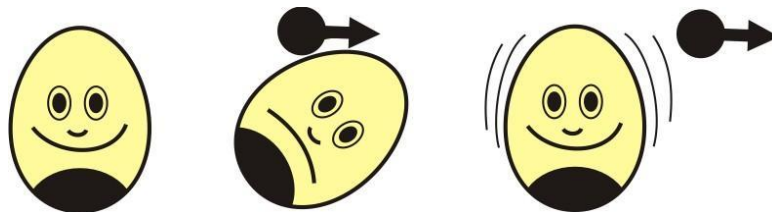
Moreover, it is a state which is entirely achievable. If happiness is designed to represent need fulfilment, then we must be capable of happiness. Because if we were not, we would not be capable of need fulfilment, and if this were the case we would not still be here.

Does that not make some kind of obvious sense?

An ideal physical state can be imagined, then – the perfect symphony of activity and need fulfilment. So if integrity can be presumed, then this must be reflected at the emotional level as a state of reward, as the absence of emotive tension. And at the highest mental level – as peace, stillness, absorption into ease and bliss. Happiness then, is not any of these things, but all of them, all at once. It is both positive, and deep, at the same time. Physical, emotional and mental. It is a state. The positive end of a vast continuum of potential, with endlessly varied negative potentials at one end, and a singularly integrated ideal at the other – need fulfilment. It is a necessary functional polarity, with an important job to do. Its job is to provide the emotional foundation for consciousness which assures positive motivation toward the goal. Therefore alignment with that goal is essential, it is absolutely vital.

This point of integrity acts like the weight in the bottom of a Weeble, always keeping it upright no matter what affects it. A Weeble is a kids toy that looks like an egg, but which always stands up no matter what you hit it with. And when upright, the Weeble experiences no tension, and comes to rest peacefully, awaiting the next negative event to overcome. The next wobble to correct.

A vertical state, in this metaphor, would result in physical level need fulfilment – purpose of all the rest. A self governing system – beautiful.



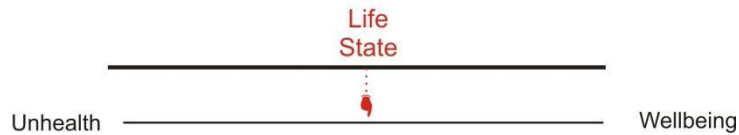
Consciousness then, is the cork on this changing tide of functioning. It has expressly evolved to be subject to the dictates of the changing emotional landscape like a ball in a pinball machine. It is not designed to change that landscape, or to question internal stimulus, just to submit to it.

Of course this doesn't work half of the time, but that is another story. I am defining here how this system works when it is actually healthy, which is not what we see in most people. In most people, this is exactly what doesn't work, that is my whole point. But I am not showing you a leper here, for the moment I am showing you what a natural and healthy person looks like.

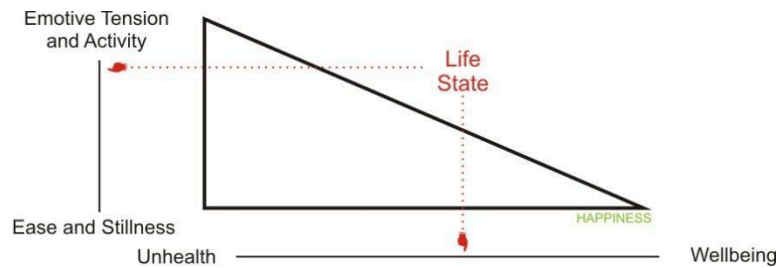
Anyway, what we see is a system which is delivering a very clever and self balancing motivational base, in complete alignment with its natural requirements, to the part of its own functioning that it has given all the power to, and which is ideally prepared to receive such. It's just like any group or society electing someone to look after their interests, they have to somehow be motivated in the right way.

So what we see here is a working relationship which makes sense. If you viewed this relationship in a visual form, with health-unhealth on a horizontal axis, and happiness-unhappiness on a vertical one, you would get a wedge or ramp which functions to ensure ongoing need fulfilment.

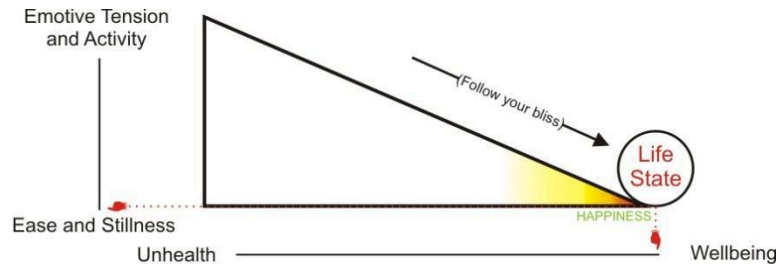
So we start with this –



Then we add emotional and mental tension (unhappiness) and get this –



Then we add conscious experience to get this –



From the perspective of frontal awareness, free energy and free attention is the point of integrity at the tip of the wedge, where zero emotive tension converges with no mental activity or demands, on the basis of ideal physical health and relational wellbeing. Happiness.

The sum of all higher functions, the conscious self, is charged with managing the relational affairs of the organism, and is motivated/controlled by the emotive core, whilst at the same time given everything it needs in order to achieve this. It is a beautiful system.

The point at the tip of the wedge, where organic need fulfilment and low subjective stress converge, is where consciousness is always trying to roll. That point is called happiness. And happiness is simply a function of this system working well, nothing more, nothing less. It is not mysterious, and we are not the only ones to experience it.

Happiness, in these terms, is clearly not an exclusively human characteristic. In some sense it could even be presumed that all organic systems experience their own version of happiness, but that some do so in deeper ways. And which is better, more happy? The deeper or more simple?

If happiness is the sum, then does it really matter how big your equation is? Maybe it is in fact much smarter to take the short way there?

Maybe that's why we eat apples. It is because they just sit there, quite happily...the smug little bastards!

The mechanics of Emotive tension –

This is a subject worth examination, if only because your happiness is directly associated with this body of functioning. When happiness does finally arrive, this is where it will be delivered...

Emotional attachment is the primary tension generator within the emotive core, and there are functions whose job it is to manage attachment, and these are ever vigilant so as to allocate it to best represent need. These processes are NOT under the control of the conscious self, which only gets to choose the specific object of attachment at any point.

Attachment (at an emotional level) represents need (at a primary relational level). The core says 'food', the conscious self says 'hamburger', the core says 'OK', or 'not good enough'.

If the conscious self gives the core what it wants, it gets to relax and enjoy the energy. The conscious self is constantly shopping from a list it does not write, but which is written for it by the emotive core, and its performance in fulfilling that list determines its degree of positive emotional feedback from the core - Happiness.

So this is how it works in practice –

When established relational fulfilments become disturbed, and change is required, deep emotive processes swing into action to adjust or recover the emotive attachments associated. These deep emotive processes are the architects of our changing inner landscapes, and the conscious self lives in the emotional world they create. The conscious self does not control these processes, they control the conscious self, and are anchored in the emotive core, ultimately in the body itself.

To illustrate this -

Let's say an object of need fulfilment is lost. Deep emotive processes at the core are automatically assessing the situation, and set in motion higher functions which must a) either recover relationship with the established fulfilment, or b) begin the process of establishing another one (frontal awareness experiences this activity as subjective disturbance - emotion).

The outcome the core/body is seeking, by producing pressure and tension, is continued need fulfilment, whether that be a return to a familiar fulfilment structure from the past, or the acquisition of something entirely new to replace it.

The first of these options is usually the easiest and preferred path – emotive tension generated and directed toward protecting the current attachment. This broad function is typified in an active protection or recovery of something we are attached to, and expressed commonly as what we would recognize as frustration, or perhaps even **anger**.

The second option is generally more costly as it involves more subjective re-organization and therefore more emotive tension. This is the relinquishment of what was lost, including the attachment associated, and the finding of something to replace it. This means the active de-constructing of an existing attachment and integrating the underlying need deep into the emotive system somehow in the form of a loaded emotional tension. This tension retains the integrity of the system, and is designed to disturb things and sets activity about formulating and establishing a new relational fulfilment over time.

Such a need, which has been integrated as an emotional tension, is called a **desire**. And the most obvious expression of this broad function – which begins with the relinquishment of an old attachment, and ends with the eventual establishment of a new one - is what we generally call **grief**. The intermediate stage of grief is to embody or repress unfulfilled desire.

This is why it hurts. And this is also why it doesn't hurt if the needs in question can be immediately replaced.

The process of anger is resolved when (the original) need fulfilment has been recovered. The process of grief has been resolved when (a new) need fulfilment has been established. They are both very adaptive and necessary processes for managing change and staying well adapted to an ever shifting environment.

Anger and grief (in their broadest meanings) both serve exactly the same purpose, but in a different way. And they are very easily interchanged, as we can all probably attest. They both protect need fulfilment by dynamically managing strong emotive attachments. Each is a healthy and adaptive response in the right circumstances, and without them, the system is crippled.

But what if primary need fulfilment is threatened seriously, and if neither of these two options is practically available? In this state the system has no real place to go. Need must be fulfilled. The emotive core's only option in that case is to simply apply more and more subjective pressure until one of the two other options finds a way through to re-established fulfilment. The powerful primary structure simply whips the higher management functions until they find a way out. Such massive emotive tension has the effect of offering the higher functions more resources, and more leverage systemically – like a government in a state of national emergency or marshal law. Many normal physical functions can become suspended, like in a country when at war. And like war, such high tension is also very costly. This state is what we call *fear*.

All I am seeking to do here is give you some idea of how these different emotional energies fit into the bigger functional picture, and what part they play in our overall fulfilment. The point is that they all make sense, and should be respected, but also that they are all different, and subject to a deeper pattern or agenda.

Fear, then, has no direct and valid function, except to force action down one of the other two paths - anger or grief. In itself, fear is not a productive emotive tension, and it only subsides when one of the other two paths is taken. Fear represents the highest valence emotive tension possible in the human system. Fear is the big guns, a somewhat toxic and very costly emergency response, which is actually little more than a stalling of other vital functions within the system. Fear is basically emotional constipation.

In a fair situation, then, the frontal systems should be able to do their job as directed by the core, and be rewarded for their efforts with a sense of wellbeing. This is how it should work, this is how the organism functions to meet its needs. And this is how it does indeed tend to work in our natural state.

Eventually, in adulthood, stable strategies of fulfilment become established and run almost automatically (unconsciously). Any transaction with a positive physical outcome is anchored and supported emotionally, creating a behavioural preference. The natural integrity of *emotion* in relation to primary *need* is simply implied and presumed. It is not generally questioned too much unless problems arise.

So there is an innate and necessary integrity between the lower, middle and higher levels of this system. Tension at a primary level is directly reflected at the frontal higher level. Like the individuals elected to govern a country, stress at a lower level will be reflected in the higher levels – because it is the lower less intelligent levels of power which nevertheless elect the higher. And in the same way as those in positions of power can cut off and ignore the concerns of those they serve, the higher functions within us can do the same, but will inevitably become more and more distracted and disturbed as other functions arise with the support of the core and move to take power. So just like in a country, if activity in the higher systems does not respond to lower level concerns or influences, energies will automatically mobilise to overthrow and replace them. Like the electors in a state, the core or base level ultimately holds the power, and will support whichever functions offer the greatest advantage to the organism as a whole. We have all experienced this kind of inner overthrow at some time.

Anyway, what we see here is effectively an unbroken chain of leverage coming from the primary organism, via the emotive core and its dynamic energy management, through the higher functioning of the cognitive systems, and into the world in the form of action and relational exchange. We think we are acting autonomously, and that we are free to do whatever we like. But this is just an illusion belying an enormous and constant conglomeration of forces converging as what we call our 'conscious self'.

We – the mind – do not live, but are being lived. This is how the organism affects the flow of change so as to retain an advantage over the continuous tendency of the universe to try to pull it apart. When the universe pushes, it is via this sophisticated chain of leverage that the human system pushes back. What we call our 'self'

is simply the result of this process, moment to moment. It is actually the body itself which experiences true happiness, as the mind resolves back into the bliss of stillness.

And I repeat – it is actually the **body** itself which experiences true happiness, as the mind resolves back into the bliss of stillness. The integrity of this whole system is implied then. Because the body grew all this functioning, and controls it via feelings, it can simply be presumed that feelings always represent the total organism's highest interests. All the frontal conscious self has to know is that you follow what you feel, and things work out. The result is both depth and positive quality of feeling.

What feels good, must naturally be good for you. When things go wrong, the negative emotive tensions which result activate and disturb the mind into producing action, and also contain all the motive energy necessary to put things right. And to the degree that is done, emotional depth and bliss is restored. It's a fair game. If the conscious self listens to what it feels, and follows that, it is rewarded with positive feeling states.

A Spanner in the Works

Happiness, then, is directly related to the fulfilment of what we need, and what we need is finite. Actually, what we need is quite simple. But this is obviously not what we see in the common person in many instances, and so I will need to explain this further because there is more here than meets the eye.

The connection which must be established as elementary is the relationship between happiness and need fulfilment. This seems almost so elementary that it approaches sounding as common sense as 'the sky is blue', but it is easy to overlook such assumptions and miss their most obvious implications. So we better lay it out in more detail.

Need is absolute, it is not relative. This means: what you need is not determined by what others have or do, or by fashion, or whatever...it is fixed. It is defined by your genetics, and by the environment in which you evolved. So whilst the specifics of organic need may vary during stages of your life cycle, the overall pattern of need for any organism is set, static, and stable.

You are an ape. You are an animal, like it or not. Less than 2% different genetically from your closest relative, and less than 5% from quite a few relatives, all of which have needs, just like you.

Are the basic needs of a human organism significantly different to those of any other great ape then? Biologically I mean?

If so, how exactly?

So the question has to be asked - How did a 2% shift in genetics produce a 2000% increase in resource consumption? That's just a guess of course, it is probably much more...

How can you assess what something needs, then? Easy: An organism which does not function to fulfil its needs perishes. If an organism survives and even flourishes, it can be presumed that - amongst all the other things it is doing - that it has at least amply fulfilled its needs.

We survived and flourished long before we developed language, or wore clothes, or organised sophisticated civilizations. We fulfilled our needs completely, or at least adequately, for millions of years even in harsh and arid conditions, when resources were scarce and hard to come by. Indeed, evolution occurs over millions of years, not tens of thousands, so it is these conditions that we have evolved to encounter, and for which we are biologically suited. We have evolved to completely fulfil our own needs in harsh environments with few resources, and to do this sufficiently well to raise healthy offspring and teach them to do the same.

Our needs are modest. Our needs, and the needs of any other great ape, are effectively identical. Go figure... this raises a few questions. We remain unhappy, discontent, in a sea of resources. An embarrassment of riches. Why?

Why do we expand and consume? Are we consumption machines? What if this was not the way we naturally are?

There is no other possibility. Either there is no direct connection between happiness and need fulfilment, or that connection is not direct or has been corrupted somehow.

I am going to assume the latter, of course, because I believe I can produce a lot of evidence to support it.

So what if our emotional sense of need was unnaturally inflated somehow, what would the result of that be?

What if it was not only inflated, but also conflicted, so that its integrity was lost relative to what we actually need? What if, effectively, the emotional shopping list for happiness was raised to an almost ridiculous degree, and even then still limited in the happiness that could result?

Welcome to life on earth. Multiply this by 6 billion.

So what if we could find a way to restore the natural equilibrium and integrity of this system? And yes, it is just a system like any other. If it is broken, why not fix it?

Reality²

What we are trying to gain here is not only an appreciation of how the natural system is intended to work, but also prepare ourselves for the prospect of understanding the nature and origins of the subversive event we will be looking at in the next section. And so far we see some basic outlines of how organisms express their needs in the form of energetic leverage on the systems they have developed to manage their relational transactions with the environment, and with themselves. Which explains why certain things happen the way they do, but does not necessarily explain how.

So how do the systems charged with fulfilling this shopping list know where to find the things on it? How do they know which actions will have the outcomes desired?

Strangely, answering this may assist in answering another question – what, exactly, is science?

This subversive event likely emerged with our last great advancement of functioning – Imagination. It may have been the price of imagination in a sense.

In order to help us navigate a very complex environment, we have developed the power to experience real emotion based purely on imagination – to experience as emotionally real something which is in fact only a thought. We extend and supplement our direct perceptual experience of reality with constructs based mostly upon memory and probability, and then use these to navigate through life, always searching for the optimum possible path. It's like modern pilots – they only look out the windows if there is a pretty sunset, the rest of the time they trust the instruments to tell them what's going on. And so regardless of whether the wing is about to fall off, if the instruments say it is, then they get very upset indeed!

The integrity of this process is obviously vital. The whole point of this 'reality supplementation' is to assist us in relating to 'actual reality', so the key is to construct as much directly relevant context, with as much accuracy, as possible. And we are remarkably good at it, so good that we do not even know we are doing it for the most part.

Indeed, we don't even know this is happening for the most part, because it is so subjectively convincing. But the fact is that a huge amount of what you experience as real is just your own imagination being experienced as such. And this, by the way, puts to rest an epic debate about the nature of reality itself. There are in fact two human realities being experienced simultaneously. One is real, the other is not – it is only supposed to seem real. But here is the point – it is supposed to represent actual reality, accurately, and as completely as possible. That is its purpose for existing. It is not a toy.

If you screw with your belief systems, and adjust them in ways which make you feel better, but which misalign with actual reality – you will certainly suffer in the long run!

Anyway, that's another story...we are flying over epic philosophical battlefields here.

So as we develop cognitively, emotionally, morally, as a summary event we also develop our capacity to model reality in this way, and navigate it in more powerful and sophisticated ways. There is obviously a strong need to retain the integrity of this whole process, because of the implied pressures which might oppose such – such as the natural tendency to corrupt an accurate reporting and representation of reality in any areas which might produce significant tension and subjective stress, ie when seeing things as they really are produces pain, or when ignoring reality may result in a more blissful state etc. It is tempting for the conscious self, which experiences the emotional results of what it reports, to simply report good stuff - to just make it up. So there are functions and pressures in place to prevent this, and to monitor integrity.

This is just one of many examples of back pressure on this system, which is why cognitive integrity is so important, and more and more sophisticated means of ensuring such integrity is precisely what defines emergent cognitive development. To see things more clearly as they really are is what it means to become smarter, no matter what your IQ might happen to be. Brains are of no use if they are not being employed in pursuit of the purpose for which they exist. 'Truth' is simply reality being reported accurately to the brain, by the brain. Lesser brains do this less accurately.

Integrity = Science

What is science then? There is still debate at the highest levels about this, and that is because without the context just defined, you cannot even begin to define it. Indeed, I once asked the leading editor of one of the world's top science websites to point me toward a definition of what it actually is, any definition at all. She couldn't! How incredibly sad...even Carl Sagan went on endlessly about what was not science, but never, even once, defined what it actually is. How can you defend it, if you cannot define it?

It is easy within this context above. Over millennia great minds have discovered, collected, and recorded, methods of checking perceptions and cognitive processes for integrity, and they have done this in many different fields of inquiry (aspects of reality). The methods science employs today are simply any and all which demonstrate consistently that they achieve this end, and so are different in each different field of enquiry. Once again, science is defined by what it does, and why, not by how.

In one sense it could be said that there is no such thing as a 'scientific method', because any method can be used toward an unscientific end.

What we call science is based on two elementary premises –

1. that the universe at large is a single unified event. It all fits together, and makes sense, even if we can't see how.
2. that we as humans tend to naturally view the world in a very distorted and biased way, if we are not extremely vigilant to counteract such tendencies.

Science is simply a combination of the best available tools and methods we have at any time to overcome the biases inherent in the way we tend to erroneously view reality. It is a collection of methods, any methods, which consistently achieve this end. It is nothing more than a consensus in fact, in that the only way to check if a method is being applied in a scientific manner, is to use other proven methods. But because the aggregate cluster of core methods and theories generally agree, they form a centre of gravity around which science itself evolves and develops over time, sometimes even going through massive convulsions. But always only towards a more integrated and inclusive pattern or structure, and always in more demonstrable alignment with actual reality.

So because reality is integrated, these methods and any views they produce must also be integrated. They must all agree and sing in harmony. Logical integrity in an accurate view merely reflects an integrated universe. Logical dis-integrity indicates obvious error.

The obvious weakness of any approach which has as its aim the testing of things is that it will run into trouble if what it wants to test cannot be directly observed in any objective way. Scientists have, as part of their correct job description, the obligation to attack the ideas of other scientists.

This is healthy, this is good. This is how things are tested. But what this means is that they will regard the entire subjective realm of experience as a deeply threatening place. And if the real problem we need to face happens to

be in that area of life, then ‘sorry, you’re on your own’. If they can’t back it up with empirical evidence, scientists simply won’t work on it.

Which is just another way of saying – even though they work for us, they are too busy watching their own asses, to watch out for ours. Academic fear of the subjective realm is precisely what generates the massive blind spot in which all the various scourges of the world are free to grow, and from which they reach out and wreak endless and unchecked havoc. But whilst science may have overlooked what I will outline here, I believe science yet remains our strongest asset if we are to realise the hope all this implies.

The point again is – what if we could realign this natural system, so that the simple and intrinsic conditions for happiness were in fact experienced as such? The only reason scientists are not asking this is that they don’t even know that potential exists, or that it does in fact clearly fall within their purview.

Conclusion

So here we can see it in action, in the brief models outlined here – there is an innate and necessary integrity between the lower, middle and higher levels of this system. Tension at a primary level is directly reflected at the frontal higher level.

Like the individuals elected to govern a country, stress at a lower level (you and me) will be reflected in the higher levels (them) – because it is the lower less informed levels of power which nevertheless elect the higher. And in the same way as those in positions of power can cut off and ignore the concerns of those they serve, the higher functions within us can do the same. But if they do this, they will inevitably become more and more distracted and disturbed as other functions arise with the support of the core and move to take power. So just like in a country, if activity in the higher systems does not respond to lower level concerns or influences, energies will automatically mobilise to overthrow and replace them. Because just like the electors in a state, the emotive core ultimately holds the power, and will support whichever higher functions offer the greatest advantage to the organism as a whole. We have all experienced this kind of inner overthrow at some time - except those of us who are severely cut off from our own core I suppose, who are the equivalent of a despotic military dictatorship.

You think ‘you’ are in control? Try holding your breath for ten minutes...another ‘you’ will arrive to take your place before you even get to three. You will be chucked out of that ‘seat of power’ in a flash, for being irresponsible with something which doesn’t actually belong to you. You are the servant, not the master.

What we see, then, is a huge cluster of operations, with sensory information coming in, and motor information going out, all culminating in need fulfilment, with the tiny tip at the very peak of all that being what we call conscious experience. Conscious experience is simply the result of there being a structural need for a singular point of executive control and integrity to tie all of this functioning together, and to represent the organism as a whole, at any given moment. This point, what they call the Neuronal Correlate of Consciousness (NCC), has now been found to have no fixed location in the physical brain, and this is because it is a function of the software, not the hardware. It is a functionally elected process, not a structure. It is simply a single point of integrity which is projected, moment to moment. It is the best information the system can muster, being delivered to itself at the best locations the system can find, in that particular moment - an unbroken chain of leverage coming from the primary organism, via the emotive core and its dynamic energy management, through the higher functioning of the cognitive systems, and into the world in the form of action and relational exchange. And then you have information coming the other way via an equally complex and integrated system.

Consciousness may, in some sense, simply be where everything happens to be converging at any given moment in time, depending on the minute to minute requirements being faced.

So we think we are acting autonomously, and that we are free to do whatever we like. But this is just an illusion belying an enormous and constant conglomeration of forces converging as what we call our conscious self.

We – the mind – do not live, but are being lived. Like Mickey Mouse, we are actually just a series of still images, all running together to produce the illusion of animated continuity. This necessary projection is simply how the organism affects the flow of change so as to retain an advantage over the continuous tendency of the universe to try to pull it apart. When the universe pushes, it is via this constant and ceaseless chain of leverage that the human system pushes back. What we call our ‘self’ is simply the result of this process, moment to

moment - a process which can be relaxed if need is securely met. It is actually the body itself which experiences true happiness, as the mind resolves back into the bliss of stillness. The 'self' or source of the mind is emotion. The 'self' of emotion is the body. And the 'self' of the body is the greater universal process of which it is a natural part. And whilst you might be able to imagine that something else is going on, and even experience real emotion on the basis of that idea, it will of course only cause you trouble if you do.

Subjective phenomena, then, are simply the printout, the pictures projected by all this hardware moment to moment as it goes about its tireless task of meeting need and securing fulfilment. And conscious experience is the interface between all this activity and the world outside.

The point is that it works beautifully for the most part. In a fair situation, the conscious frontal systems should be able to do their job as directed by the core, and be rewarded for their efforts with a sense of wellbeing.

This is how it should work, this is how the organism functions to meet its needs. And this is how it does indeed tend to work in our natural state. Eventually, in adulthood, stable strategies of fulfilment become established and run almost automatically (unconsciously). Any transaction with a positive physical outcome is anchored and supported emotionally, creating an automatic behavioural preference. Life becomes habit. The natural integrity of ***emotion*** in relation to primary ***need*** is simply implied and presumed. It is not generally questioned too much unless problems arise.

A Vision of Life –

You could turn all this up the other way, then, and examine it from the perspective not of the avoidance of negativity, but of attraction toward positivity.

The same can be said – it is this very same body of functioning which produces our dreams and visions of what we want, it is the emotional landscape of the core that we surf as we seek the ultimate synthesis, the final recipe, the perfect day. It is the emotive core which seeds our fantasies, defines our deepest yearnings, and in doing so ultimately charts our course in life. When we ask the question “what do I really want?” it is the emotive core you are feeling back into, and the answers you get are entirely determined by the integrity implied therein. If you can't trust your own emotive core, what can you trust?

So why is it that you often can't get a clear answer to this most important of enquiries? Why don't we see many people going after their dreams and desires without reservation? It's such a profound question, surely the answer to that would be of some value?

PART FOUR

The Anatomy of Unhappiness

Up until this point we have pretty much been addressing only the nature and functioning of the intrinsic human system, what I tend to call the ‘native’ system. In metaphorical terms this is the primary tree in its free state, without the secondary climbing plant I have referred to. What we see there is a fabulously beautiful and integrated hierarchy of activity, with a remarkable capacity to adapt and respond in a changing environment, and thereby maintain the fulfilment of its needs. A system which pretty much runs on auto-pilot, with the ‘conscious’ level being the spontaneous outcome of a huge barrage of underlying processes moment to moment, the wagging tail of a very sophisticated dog.

The implied hierarchy encountered in the native system, whilst it bestows great advantages, also implies one unfortunate potential – that a disturbance of integrity somewhere beneath the level of conscious perception would amount to an intractable conundrum for the conscious self. And what we also see is that human behaviour and experience does not match the description of the native system as defined there, leaving such a culprit as a distinct possibility.

Of course, this is what I will be examining here. It is this potential we must now explore – what it is, where it comes from, how it works. And to do this, we will need to go back a bit, and take another swing at this whole event. Which might involve a bit of a detour, and a bit of uncomfortable territory along the way. But such may also be worth it, because getting to the bottom of such a conflict – if it exists – represents an entirely new path of inquiry into what might be the oldest and deepest of all human dilemmas. It might be to finally identify the true cause of a great proportion of human suffering, maybe to not tame it but at least put a collar on it and give it a name.

What will this cost us, then? What kind of conceptual net will we need to catch such a beast?

To catch one of these, you actually need to corner it on three sides, you need to examine it from three separate perspectives. And we have already begun to construct these views.

- a. The first is the natural perspective of consciousness, and this one needs no explaining. This is the one you already use all the time.
- b. The second is a view of life from a kind of alien perspective, an objective perspective. This is the view science employs, it is the view of the world as it is, rather than how it appears. It is objective reality, the Mack truck so to speak. It is what’s beneath what we see outside of us in the realm of actual reality.
- c. The third perspective is that of our inner realm, and of the deep functions which are going on inside us. Beneath the surface of our inner worlds.

I usually call these views *natural-subjective*, *primary-relational* and *core-functional*. Not that names really matter. All that matters is that you have at least some idea that we are in fact building these three separate views up here, bit by bit.

To begin, then, we will need to go a bit deeper again, and broader, to examine a little more of the context of this whole event. We already have a definition of the elementary functioning of the native and healthy human system in relation to happiness, in the simplest possible terms, so now we will pick up the elements necessary to explain the emergence and nature of the mysterious other event.

In order to do this there are two things we must explore in a little more depth. We have already introduced them briefly, but they need to be more directly juxtaposed here in more detail, and in slightly different terms, as these two things set the backdrop for everything else to come. These two things are the ‘nitro’ and the ‘glycerine’ which together cause all the trouble we are seeking to understand here.

The Price of Imagination

Firstly, we must explain the curious and enigmatic nature of ‘human reality’.

Human reality? Am I saying here that human reality is somehow different to the reality every other organism faces, or to universal reality? Yes, in a certain respect I am, but not fundamentally. Which might sound a bit confusing, but hopefully this will make sense in just a moment. We introduced this briefly in the previous section in order to explain the function of science in keeping this process healthy, but now we want to have a deeper look in order to see where it might, nevertheless, go wrong.

Change management. This is what we already know, it is all about change management, and a dynamic process of leverage which comes from the core of our being – for the lack of a better term – and ultimately manifests as action in relation to an ever shifting external environment.

This is the ‘how’ of action and change, but this still leaves the ‘what’ unexplained. Leverage is only half the picture here, the other half is information processing, it is also about intelligence, not just power. For action to be effective – before we can act on the universe around us or predict the outcomes of such action in a complex environment – we need to know what is going on. We need to be able to grasp reality, and our place within it. And the better we can do that, the more powerfully and effectively we can relate to it.

What this amounts to, then, is the necessity of constant assessment of possible actions, and of the likely outcomes of each. And whilst this sounds incredibly complex, we are in fact doing this all the time, without cease actually. But yes, it is very very sophisticated behaviour, especially in the way we do it.

We are effectively talking about the future here. And whilst to you and I the future may seem like a kind of obvious fact of our existence, it is actually a myth. It does not, in any observable sense, actually exist. And of course this sounds ridiculous, but it is true. We have never actually seen the future, or experienced it, or in any way observed it as a reality. The future does not, in fact, exist. And never will.

There is only an ever changing present moment, and what we know as the future is just a probability we have calculated in order to get a handle on that process of change. The future is, actually, something we create, and the hardware we use to do this is the most sophisticated piece of equipment ever discovered.

This of course is not something we tend to notice. Indeed, to notice it is to somehow diminish our faith in our decisions, and any actions based on it. But we do in practice supplement an enormous amount of what we actually know about what is going on in ‘reality’. We just make it up. We guess.

The past, likewise, is not something we can directly experience as a reality, because once again, it is not real. At least it is not real in the sense that we can perceive it directly.

And I am sure this will be boggling your mind a bit here, but that is kind of the point. We don’t notice this stuff. And we don’t notice this because to do so would be to undermine the entire purpose of what we are doing in relation to actual reality. We supplement what we know of reality with an enormous array of speculative constructs. The human brain is, in some sense, just a ‘reality manufacturing plant’. And of course this is not actual reality we are talking about, it is just imagination in fact. But it should be close, after all the only advantage in being able to do this is in being able to do it accurately, because it is only the organism’s relationship to actual reality which determines whether its needs get fulfilled or not.

Most animals cannot do what we do in this sense. There are only so many ways possible to overcome the almost impenetrable barrier that knowing anything about the future represents, and all of them involve some kind of memory. Genetic memory (instinct) and conditioned responses are all forms of memory, and are the ones used by most other animals, and we have those too. But we have gone one better again.

In our case, then, we fill in the enormous gaps in our direct perception of reality with probability constructs. We literally model reality in our heads, or at least the parts of reality which relate to us directly, anyway. In particular, we model the future, and not just one future but many, and we do this constantly.

The brain is, in this sense, just a probability generator. It is via this body of functioning that we place ourselves in context, moment to moment. And bear in mind that what I am discussing here is epic in scope and scale, it is by far the greater part of what we experience as reality. It is ALL of the past, and ALL of the future, and MOST

of the present - everything we presume is the case right now outside our narrow field of immediate and direct perception.

The advantages of being able to do this are what? They are enormous, this capacity has given us the edge over all other species on this planet. The fact that we can a) record the 'past' of the present, b) project a broader picture of the actual present reality, and then c) on the basis of these two formulate the many probable future outcomes of different actions, is a staggering achievement.

So what is the cost? I mean, apart from the obvious hardware we must feed and maintain (and the occasional headache)?

Once again, the cost is dependence. In the same way that the conscious level of the human system is dependent on the core for its emotional foundations, the core is dependent on the higher functions of the system for all its information. Can you begin to see the potential for trouble here?

The cost of such 'imaginary reality', if it is to ever become an advantage in the way we function, is necessary submission to it. We do not know we are even doing this. It is all happening quite automatically, and the end result is a continual fusion of what we actually experience of the real world, of reality, and what we imagine about the real world. The two are completely fused at an experiential level, and as a rule we cannot generally tell them apart.

And here is the point – which one is real? I mean from the perspective of the conscious self, which gets to experience emotional tension based on how well it relates to reality...which one is real?

And the answer is – Both!

In order to gain the advantages associated with the capacity to augment reality in this way, the emotive core has completely submitted itself to such projections as being real. They are not considered imaginary.

To experience fear based purely upon 'belief' is exactly the same as it is when something is really threatening you. If you measure the hormone levels, the brain activity, the blood pressure rise... they are exactly the same. And this is because no distinction is made. For the human system, secondary reality - its own creation and supplementation of reality - is reality.

So we are in a curious situation then. We actually experience reality in two distinct forms, from two separate sources. We do, in fact, have two realities. One of which is real – objective (actual) reality. The other of which is equally felt to be real but in fact quite illusory – subjective (secondary) reality.

The nature of these two different realities, and their relationship to each other, is not generally appreciated or even noticed. And the result of this is a kind of war which has waged throughout all recorded human history about the ultimate 'nature of reality', with some saying that the source of reality ultimately resides in consciousness, and in the power of the mind, and the others saying it is an objective and irrefutable fact of the universe itself, regardless of anyone being there to see it.

The ancient Zen koan tries to split this old stump - "If a tree falls deep in the forest and there is nobody there to hear it, does it make a sound?"

Of course it does. Duh. Fortunately, for actual reality, it does not depend for its existence on the observation of tiny bipedal apes.

There are also two basic approaches to life as a result, based on these views of what reality actually is. 'Mind power' is one, the belief that all things are ultimately manifested via the power of the mind...which can actually have some practical effect when applied, especially to the degree a person's own beliefs are a major cause of how their life is working out. But this is not mysterious, it is practical. Your beliefs can change your life because they change the way you act, and the way others subtly perceive you. But try manifesting an apple with your mind. It is much much easier to manifest an apple using the very mysterious and powerful spiritual thing we call - \$1.

The other approach – in contrast – reduces everything to a material level, relying on action and commitment to make things happen, but can tend to overlook the very powerful affect of the mind, and that almost all of human experience is produced by such.

So we just solved this conundrum. How much simpler could it possibly be?

What we see here is that both of these views are in fact correct, when we overlay what is really going on. There are two. The relationship between these two, however, is the important thing – and their nature. This is what defines the most intelligent approach to creating positive change in life. And it also points to the dangers. After all, you could manipulate your own creation of subjective reality (beliefs) to produce a kaleidoscope of experience emotionally, but if you were not changing it all in the direction of increased integrity with what is **actually** going on in **actual** reality, then you are **actually** becoming psychotic. And many ‘new age’ approaches to life border on this, as do many religious conceptions of the world. Fairy Tales for adult children are not the foundations of true creative power.

There is obviously a significant conversation to be had here, as this single differentiation solves a great many historical conundrums in its wake, but we will not tarry here. We are on another mission...

The point, in relation to the rabbit we are chasing here, is that with this staggering advancement in technology, there is clearly an opening for corruption and error. There is the evident and obvious potential for experiencing emotional tension based purely on imaginary grounds. After all, everything we experience on the basis of what we ‘believe is going to happen’, is exactly that. Nothing but. Which is most of what we experience.

There is obviously a great amount of in-built care taken, then, to securely anchor what we believe in the real world, and to stop it wandering off in the direction of what simply ‘feels better’ to believe. And yes, there are, just like the transmission of ‘power’ in the system from core outward, the ‘information’ system is equally integrated and highly guarded. After all, if the only purpose of secondary reality is to help the organism in its relationship to actual reality - of which it is a part - then obviously any degree of inaccuracy would be a severe disadvantage. And I could bore you with the details, but let’s just say there are a great many potentials for corruption in this very complex system, and a great many counter-measures to ensure that these errors don’t happen. Resulting, in the end, in a truly remarkable degree of success for the most part, in formulating and projecting a continuous and very accurate personal context.

This, then - the fact that we create and experience a great deal of what we experience as emotionally real - is the first thing to know. It’s a nice sharp knife given to use by evolution, a great advantage, provided we don’t slip and cut ourselves with it by mistake.

Nobody Home –

With creation of secondary reality we see the potential for trouble, for a feedback loop between the information and power systems which together function to manage change. So of all the possible things that could go wrong here, what would be the worst?

Of all the things we must know about the universe and our place in it, some of the most important ones are actually the hardest to know. Which means that in creating and maintaining our picture of the way things are, we are actually charged with not only figuring out what is going on locally, but also what is going on in general. We need to know our place in the greater scheme of things – resulting in what we might call our ‘cosmology’.

Now, obviously, we try to do this as accurately as possible. After all, context is everything, it tells us what everything means, it tells us what is important in any situation, and what is not. Meaning that if you were going to introduce an error into this system, the worst possible place to do this would be not into the content of what we experience as secondary reality, but into the context. And of all the errors that might ever occur within the particular structure this system represents, there is one which is so simple, so elementary, and so close that it will take a bit of explaining to allow you to even see it.

Bear in mind here that what I am about to explain is the fundamental delusion you are suffering, so it will not land lightly. It will be hard to accept at first. Be warned. But knowing it is also the final key to the great mystery here. The answer, and the problem in this case, lies right where you would absolutely never think to look.

In order to capture this most elusive thing, I am going to have to go right back to the beginning, not quite to the big bang but about a third of the way maybe. And it deals with the most fundamental of things, the most fundamental reality of all things perhaps. So I will be dealing with only actual reality here, not subjective reality, in order to try to deduce or isolate an error in the way subjective reality is being represented, and to take those rose coloured glasses off for just a moment.

What do we know about actual reality then? I'm not looking here for any controversial facts, just what we already know for certain. As we briefly outlined in the previous section, what we know is that the universe is breaking down, getting simpler, always heading in the direction of entropy and disorder, running down like a wind-up toy: Einstein's second law of thermodynamics etc. This is the dominant flow of change in the cosmos as we see it, as defined by physics.

Against this universal flow there also exists another tendency, weaker perhaps, but nevertheless quite evident. There are some things which at least briefly tend toward increasing complexity or organisation over time. This can be seen in the spiralling of galaxies, to the formation of crystals, to the arising of the small self-sustaining spirals of upward complexity we call –'life'.

The point of it all is that upward complexity does happen, all the time in fact, but that it is constantly swept away by the tide of destruction which forms the broader environmental context of these isolated events. But occasionally, and probably everywhere it can in the universe, life arises. And this happens as particular forms of matter – ordinary organic molecules (which are known to be common through the known universe) produce countless billions of such self organising events, and when one of these becomes self sustaining. It's a lottery to find such a combination, with very low odds of winning, but the universe plays it countless billions of times. And it only has to win once.

From what we now understand, life emerged on this planet almost immediately once it was possible, very soon after its formation and without delay, as soon as the conditions allowed for it. So it is the destructive nature of the dominant trend of matter which generally prevents life from arising. But beyond that point, once it has even a tiny foothold, it is the very same destructive nature of the context which actually fuels the fire of development, and provides the brutal selection which drives these tiny event spirals to become more and more complex. They learn, in a very elementary sense, due to being constantly challenged. And then, at some point, they become capable of sharing what they have learned, in which case other matter around them also begins to dance to that same tune. The result is an explosion of life, tiny life, but life nevertheless. The seas become clogged with it. And for a very long time, that's all there is.

Maintaining such complexity, however, against the ever pressing universal flow, is demanding, and takes energy, and so energy becomes the primary currency in the economy of life. And at some point something else happens...energy resources become scarce, and the fight for survival takes another turn. These small self sustaining events run out of available nutrients, and begin consuming each other. The result of which is a recipe for another twist in what is, it seems, may be an entirely meaningless process.

Remember, this is all just matter, doing what matter does. There is nothing special about the matter involved.

The result, then, is a feeding frenzy, and the emergence of special adaptations to either get food, or to best avoid becoming it. On this planet, this produced the event known as the Cambrian Explosion – when simple life branched and became almost infinitely complex in form and relationship, almost overnight.

The rest is history. There are many twists and turns in this plot which are not included here, but the point I wanted to pick up and not lose in all that, is that essentially what we call 'life' is nothing special. Not fundamentally, in terms of what it consists of. The particular variations of life, because they represent the collected learning of countless generations of event spirals before them, may be valuable. But even then only to those organisms themselves. I don't know if you have noticed, but the universe will roll a big rock down a hill and squash you like a bug, and not even notice. As far as it knows you are in fact just another curious rock formation.

Ultimately, it's all the same stuff, just doing what stuff does. The difference between 'organic' and 'inorganic' matter is simply semantics in some sense. There is ultimately no difference. And we went back to the beginning there because this is the most obvious place to see this.

When a group of molecules just happens to relate in a way that produces more order rather than less, does a siren sound and bells go off and a great thundering voice from the sky say something like – ‘let there be enzymes!’. No, it happens all the time, it’s really no big deal.

So why isn’t it still happening? Why isn’t the original spark of life still firing off all over the place? It likely is. It is just that any new emergence into this playing field will immediately become food for the bigger players already here. Yum.

The point, therefore, is that there is actually no magic threshold at which organic structure is spontaneously transformed into ‘special stuff’, quite distinct from everything around it. We are made from hamburgers, and hamburgers are made from grass, and grass is made from dirt. And dirt is, therefore – GOD.

I am being facetious, but I’m sure you get my point. It is all just dirt doing a dance, just because in the right circumstances, it knows how to do that.

The one thing that organic structure is not prepared for, however, is to recognize this underlying unity. From the very first revolution of the tiny self sustaining spiral that is life, the events themselves have only survived because they have been at war with the rest of the cosmos. To be organic is to take sides, it is to fight for survival against the ‘rest of the universe’ which is trying constantly to sweep them away.

So jump forward then, about 350 million years, to when organic structure finally begins to develop truly sophisticated hardware to use in its fight in this war, and needs to establish the most foundational reality of its place in the greater scheme of things...when it begins to ask the greatest of all elementary questions –

What am I?

The one thing it will not ever do in answering that most fundamental question, at least not naturally, is embrace the fundamental reality of its state. Because everything which makes it what it is, is entirely geared toward defending this primary distinction – between ‘self’ and ‘other’.

That boundary is all it knows, all it has ever known.

If you imagine a wave in the ocean asking this question, with its small and limited perspective, it will likely only get as far as the fact that it is a wave. It is unlikely that it will ever see the bigger picture – that it is in fact the ocean, nothing but the ocean, being expressed as a wave in that moment of time. And so where would the wave go to find the ocean, to become it somehow, if someone told it that its ultimate destiny lay in being an ocean...? Not very far.

So it should be recognized at this point, that if there really is a ‘self’ in the universe, then there is probably only one, like the ocean on which we are all waves. And that essential root of being is most likely not limited to, or located in, one of several trillion tiny organic structures somewhere out on a planet in the very ordinary galaxy we call the milky way.

So what is ‘self’ then? Surely I have one? Surely I am one!

Well, maybe. I am certainly open to having a look if you find it. Have you ever experienced your ‘self’. Where would you look? Surely if you could look at it, if you did experience it in some way, you would have to ask yourself the question - who would be doing the looking? And with this we have the other half of the picture. This is why we cannot see the seat of our own suffering, the root cause of the dilemma we face, because we are always looking from it, and never at it.

"Why are you unhappy? Because 99.9 per cent of everything you think, and of everything you do, is for yourself — and there isn't one."

Wei Wu Wei

‘I’ is an illusion, a fabrication produced moment to moment by the information processing faculties of the human brain to make sense of the one thing it is not prepared to understand: that the fundamental reality of all organic life lies in its unity with the rest of the cosmos.

There is only one thing going on here, not many, and if there is a self, then that self is likely the self of all.

As the human mind pieced together its total picture of the universe, it obviously needed to represent itself somehow, as a whole, in that picture. After all, the organism itself is the topic and subject of such a view. And it is appropriate and even necessary for the organism to refer to itself in this way, in its relative context, but that should never be confused with reality in any absolute sense. It is just a name tag, not an entity. It is an abstract notion, a functional point of reference used by a particular organic event, to refer to itself as a whole. A 'whole' which is actually just a concept in reality. In fact, at a molecular level, you are almost entirely replaced every seven years. Some parts of you are replaced daily with 'new stuff'.

If you really had to, where would you possibly draw the line?

So 'I' is ultimately just an idea, it exists entirely and solely in the realm of subjective reality. It is just a thought, a subtle prefix attached to every memo sent out from the office of consciousness – "we act in the service of 'I', all hail 'I'!".

Which would be fine except for one thing - 'I' does not exist.

It is a myth. Always something you are merely *doing*, never something you are actually ever *being*.

Of course this is a fabulously bold assertion to make, but what is not being said here is that 'I' is a problem, or that we should all get rid of 'I'. The fact is that 'I' is already not there now, and that acting as if it were clearly has the potential for some quite significant outcomes.

All this does, by the way, entirely jive with what we currently know empirically about the nature of things, with what we observe about ourselves and the universe around us. Whereas, conversely, the common assertion that there is a 'self' somewhere inside us has been very difficult to uphold against almost unequivocal evidence to the contrary.

The problem with this elementary error is that it presumes the existence of an absolute in relation to something finite and limited. A 'self' implies certain things, including an absolute need to exist. And absolute needs are simply not something we are equipped to fulfil, in any context. For something so simple, this natural and almost unavoidable presumption of 'separate self' is a very serious error, with astoundingly serious consequences.

Here then, we see the origination point, the termination of our quest as we trace a river of pain upstream to its source. We are now at bedrock. This is the kingpin, the singular and almost completely invisible error, so simple and yet so vast in its implications, that by the time the consequences of it are fully evident they are epic in scope and scattered to the wind. This is the tiny spark which sets the entire realm of human reality alight, and it is so important not only because it is so simple, but because – in formulating its own picture of the way things really are – it is also the deepest and most profound error the system could ever make.

The Primary Crisis –

Let's go over what we now know, then, now that we have all the pieces of the puzzle assembled. We have the ingredients here at last, so let's see if we can bake this cake:

As we develop in childhood and quickly begin to actualize the convergence of functioning which produces our secondary creation of reality, we begin to overlay what we see with our own conceptions of things as we see them. We expand our world via imagination and gradually construct a working model of the universe in which we exist. We don't realise it, but we come to live in two realms of reality. And the vast majority of our emotional experience becomes sourced in this dynamic and perpetual mental simulation of reality. From the perspective of conscious awareness, this construction effectively becomes the organism's world. The source of almost all emotion, both positive and negative.

This whole 'reality' is actually produced to support the organism in its relationship to actual reality, and the most important aspect of actual reality for the organism, is obviously the organism itself. Organic bias, natural self-centredness, is innate.

Thus, in this imagined world of past and future and widened present, there is a natural need for an imaginary 'self' to inhabit it for the organism. In reproducing the world in its imagination, the organism must also project itself into this mental world. It must simulate everything as accurately as possible.

So a mental 'self' is created, invested with emotion and then projected into time, and scenarios played out in the mind., with emotive tension and leverage then generated on the basis of that 'experience'. In the beginning this is an absolutely huge breakthrough, a staggering feat of ingenuity, and the ultimate consequences are not yet realised. In this way the core animates and directs the conscious persona. The conscious persona, or personality, is constructed to represent the entire system and its needs, to play a functional role by acting out the most desired scenario at any moment. It simply follows its bliss. In this way, via the emotive core and all the functions which combine to produce the frontal persona, the organism meets its needs in a complex relational world.

So the organism manufactures an 'imaginary world' to simulate reality, and must then manufacture an 'imaginary self' to inhabit it. The result of this is the eventual formulation of an active mental self concept. The ego, or subjective self.

Once again: In actual reality this mental self reference is functionally valid, but it is never literally real. However, it is important for healthy functioning. It is a legitimate mental self-reference for the organism in the way it constructs its artificial picture of reality. After all, the very point of building this 'reality' is to help in the organism's relationship with actual reality. So it would be pointless not to include itself in the picture. Quite the contrary, the entire picture is directly built around this imagined self. As it should be. That is, after all, the point.

The problem with this whole procedure, however, is that whilst the organism has the capacity to achieve it, it does not have the need to inform itself as to how and why. And as a result, the lines get blurred. As already stated, we do not even realise just how much of our experience is based on subjectively manufactured simulations of reality, nor how much potential error such implies. The mere fact that not all 'reality' is real is often not even noticed. The conscious self simply presumes that if the deeper system says it is real, then it is real. Which unfortunately includes this functional self reference.

So what, you may ask?

The point of all this is that at some point the seemingly autonomous *conscious persona*, in concert with this functional *self reference*, becomes entrenched as a formal identity - 'I'.

'I' is in fact just a mental abstraction based upon many forms of necessary self-reference, all of which ultimately relate to structures, processes and systems of the base organism which all mental functions serve. But what happens is that this abstraction becomes accepted at the very root of the emotive core as being fundamentally real. Perhaps because it is so simple. This idea 'self' becomes a literal reality in emotional terms. Something to protect and fight for. Thereby trapping this simple thought form in a cycle between mind and emotion, and the system doesn't even notice. It is so close that it cannot see it. Completely invisible.

This active yet unnoticed idea then comes to operate within this system at a very contextual level. And does so permanently. Somewhere between the body and the mind, like the empty eye of a hurricane, there is actually nothing there, but the hurricane is very real. This mental concept 'I' assumes this position as a literal reality, the source and subject of all functioning.

As we've already indicated, the difficult thing here is that you are reading these words from the very perspective being discussed. This is not a historical event, it is still happening right now - after all, who is reading this page?

This sense of 'self' is one of the defining characteristics of a healthy and active frontal persona, it is natural and normal. But it must also be recognized as a complete illusion of mind. It is natural to perceive there is a 'self', and to experience life as if there is one. Which makes it hard to explain, or to give you any clear perspective on this. But this 'I', the thing you presume yourself to be, is merely a product of complex processes of perception and deduction and emotion. 'I' is, in the end, just a thought. Nothing except an electrochemical process in the brain. Always something we are *doing*, never something we are ever actually *being*.

Which begs the question- 'if I am not this I, then who am I?'. Yes, very profound to be sure, and we will come to this. But suffice to say that you are not, and cannot be, whoever you *think* you are.

'I' is the ultimate core belief. Simple yet supremely profound. Functionally valid, but not actually true. It is natural but not real, supported by evolution as an idea, but not ever actually the case.

'I' is ultimately an idea which relates to no reality. The word cup is a reference – the object cup is the referent. One points to the other. So when I say cup, you don't think of a word, you think of a cup. But 'I' is a word for which there is no actual referent or truth. There is, in fact, no 'thing' this idea represents. There is no object – 'I'. There is no self in the sense that 'I' refers to such. An organism has no 'self', nothing which finally distinguishes it from its environment in truth. Such a distinction is merely a useful but ultimately manufactured perception based on very biased information.

Granted, the obvious autonomy every organic structure displays naturally supports the assumption. But the conscious 'self' is not actually an 'entity', it is just the sum product of a complex functional equation moment to moment. It is part of a wider organic process, which is itself part of a wider universal process. The conscious aspect of being human is merely supposed to act like an entity, presumably because it has been advantageous for survival if it does. But there is no fundamental separation point at which 'self' ends and everything else begins.

'Self' is merely a belief. Just a thought, moment to moment. Something we experience as real emotionally because we believe it, but which has no basis in fact. Which is not at all to say that we don't exist, just that we are perhaps not quite what we imagine, and not fundamentally separate or distinct in the way we have come to believe we are.

So this simple idea of self is a central element of the organism's own subjective re-construction of reality, a picture which helps the system function in relation to actual reality. As a presumed reality it is a mistake, never an accurate representation of fact, but because of its radical simplicity, and the lack of evidence to the contrary, the system cannot shake it. Like that spot in the middle of your back that you can't quite scratch, this is the one thing the human system seems powerless to even notice.

This constructed 'self' is something the system is *doing*, but the system becomes convinced that it is something it is *being*. And so it remains as a permanent mental assertion. A stable belief, and an emotionally experienced reality. Thus 'I' becomes embedded as a permanent and automatic assertion, a silent and unconscious element of our general belief systems, which are functionally invisible, stable and unchallenged.

There would seem to be an inherent loophole in the way human functioning has emerged, and this simple yet profound belief appears predisposed to slip through it and become immune to challenge.

'So what?' I hear you say. Never hurt me any! What harm could a simple idea do? After all, it seems to be an advantage for the organism to adopt a stance which promotes its own interests and importance. Well, the effects of this assertion becoming established are far more dramatic than might be presumed, and not just because it is such a persistent belief, but because it functions to have a powerfully modulating effect on many other subjective functions.

Why this is and what it means I will now seek to explain, leading us back to basics again for a moment –

The foundations of all functioning in the system are its needs. Need underlies attachment, the very root of all emotive activity. Needs operate in a kind of hierarchy, higher taking precedence over those lower. All the authentic needs of the human system, or any organic system, are what I will call 'conditional'. They are all limited and able to be fulfilled. Finite, because the system is finite. The capacities of an organic system are always well fitted to the fulfilment of its needs. They match. And every element of higher human functioning finally relates back to this foundational level as its reason for being. Activity only occurs at the higher level when, at the primary level, fulfilment does not match need.

Need / fulfilment = emotive activity. (N/F=E) And systemic need is stable over time as defined by the nature of the structure itself. It is fulfilments which vary and which are managed by the system's activities.

The system has no evolutionary precedent for radical changes in need, and therefore does not have any mechanisms in place to address or account for such. After all, changes in need only occur very slowly in evolutionary time, accompanying changes in physiology. Need is a stable fact of our existence, one that can be counted upon to remain fixed.

So when the W.H.O flies in supplies to the drought stricken Sudan, they may seek to gain intelligence about the particular fulfilments which are in short supply, but they do not do a census of the people to ascertain exactly what their particular needs are. They already know exactly what human needs are, and simply multiply the required fulfilments by the amount of people involved. But with the shift to the way we now operate some interesting potentials became possible.

So what is the worst possible thing that could happen to you? All of them ultimately boil down to your needs or expectations being seriously threatened in some way. And what we need, in the most elementary sense, is not something we can determine, it is fixed. The structure itself defines this.

Therefore the only approach we have available in our flight from emotional stress, and toward happiness presumably, is to manage our life in relation to our needs – we go looking for fulfilment, or seek to negate threats to such. This is *everything* we do.

So what does emotional stress (unhappiness) come from?

Need/Fulfilment = Emotion. (N/F=E)

I have highlighted the fulfilment aspect of this equation simply to represent the part we tend to notice, because it is the part which varies. The culprit, so to speak. It is the part where we spend all our time and energy, and quite rightly so.

But what should be noticed here, regardless of anything we might presume about these three things, is that emotional tension is actually the result of the first two being out of alignment – period. It doesn't actually matter how. And the implications of need being adjusted upward are in fact identical to fulfilment being lowered. In emotional terms anyway, they are exactly the same subjectively.

So what we are going to be looking at here is an often unrecognised potential – that of the subjective sense of need having been severely affected and adjusted upwards, and the inevitable consequences of that.

Need/Fulfilment = Emotion. (N/F=E)

This is the same equation, but perceived very differently. It is another perspective entirely, and defines a completely different approach to life. So bear in mind that this possibility obviously represents an immediate and radical departure to the common approach to life we are prepared for by our culture. If you were to look at your conscious personality as a kind of go between, linking your deeply inner world at one end, and your very outer world at the other, then need is at one end (subjective) and fulfilment is at the other (objective). They are at two different ends of life, in two different worlds. Meaning that these two approaches couldn't be more different.

And we also have the possibility now to understand how such a modification of need might occur. The results of this - of 'I' becoming established as a cyclic belief - is that the entire shopping list shifts from the wellbeing of the organism to the survival of the abstract self.

The game is the same, but the stakes change. All emotions become the 'I's emotions, all thoughts become the 'I's thoughts. 'I' becomes inserted at the root of all inner life, as the first cause of inner activity, the ultimate subject of all activity. The system itself is duped into operating from this point of reference, and doesn't even realise it has occurred. Always the looker, and never the looked at, this imaginary 'I' becomes the absolute centre of systemic attention. And because the system has no 'I', no real 'self' as such, there is no function in the system to threaten it. This idea 'I' is a natural consequence of our kind of functioning, and in this instance seems predisposed to stumble blindly onto an empty throne.

So the natural communal nature of systemic functioning becomes an immediate dictatorship. Rather than the body having an 'I', the 'I' now has a body. The tale begins to wag the dog. This is a bit like a person becoming an elected official, and once gaining power immediately declaring themselves King or Queen. That they are master, rather than servant. And the people, being stupid and looking to their leader for insight, simply accepting that.

In Tolkien this is the great 'eye' of Mordor, seeking to dominate the land, and the actual authentic and very modest needs of the organism are the Hobbits. So the conscious shopping list of the organism is adjusted so as to accommodate its new 'owner', and processes set in motion to begin to fulfil its requirements. And this is the problem. The entire functioning of the system becomes fitted to the fulfilment of the needs of this imagined 'self'. And the imagined needs of a 'self' are not the same as the needs of a native organic system. They are very different indeed.

The primary shift which occurs in this event is the inclusion of 'existential' needs in the functional agenda of the organic system. For a 'self', to 'exist' is perceived as an *absolute* need.

The result is a dramatic shift in the subjectively embedded sense of need. An unnecessary addition of dramatic proportions. If natural needs could be ranked on a scale of 1 to 10, and organised that way, then the needs of a 'self' would come in at about 100. So it happens at a very contextual level. Objectively, nothing has changed. Which seem paradoxical given that almost everything is now different. If a need was added at three on the scale you would notice it, but because it is off the scale it is like a new frame for the same old picture.

Like playing chess, but someone puts a gun to your head should you lose. Nothing has changed, but the same game takes on a whole new meaning. Every move now relates to something greater, something you can't see on the board itself. All need fulfilment becomes perceived to be contingent on 'I'. Thus all subsequent functioning leads back to this, to the survival of 'I'. All events then feed back to this same nexus.

The organism itself, and the reality of its existence, is never actually threatened by all this imaginary drama. The true self of the organism, its real source and substance, is never bothered. No matter how much 'I' is believed and felt to be real, it never actually becomes so. It is always just a recurring thought, and a simple one at that. So not a single actual need has been thwarted necessarily. This entire event is precipitated by the emergence of an idealised abstraction, a shift in purely imaginary context, not actual life content. In some ways you could even say it has produced a positive survival pressure, in that it amplifies our drive to survive to an absolutely inflated level. And in that instance we can see that evolution will occasionally support profound suffering in any organism, provided it results in better survival outcomes. And boy, if that isn't an unfortunate reality to think about.

Functionally however, the results are this: A finite organic system is left with an agenda which contains elements which are *absolute* in nature. Not only impossible to fulfil, but also of the highest level of emotional valence or potency. All of a sudden needs go through the roof, and emotions naturally follow. The system then immediately sets about seeking to achieve these new ends, and is forced to apply its limited resources in pursuit of what is actually an *infinite* goal. Like trying to swallow the ocean. 'I' is a thought, moment to moment, but because it is believed to *be* self, existence itself becomes contingent on thinking, on subjective activity. Which is a terrible occurrence in a system which is designed to feel good when it is resting in stillness.

If you observe any organism it is clear that it does not need to fulfil such existential needs, that it does not even have such needs. Every organism is part of a greater process and ultimately has no distinct existence of its own. It does not live, but is 'lived' in a sense, by a process greater than itself. All the functions of organic systems are relational in nature, they are all physical transactions or somehow relate to such, and an organism simply cannot fulfil requirements which are beyond its capacities. It is not prepared to, and nor does it need to. So the inclusion of such *absolute need* in the functional agenda of an organism creates the foundations for a completely irresolvable problem. An impossible crisis of great subjective significance.

All this happens in childhood as we learn to construct our own self image, and is OK up to a point because the system remains in blissful ignorance of the greater implications. As children we are strongly 'self' oriented, but we are also securely immortal in our own minds. So although the ingredients are there for a substantial crisis, we do not yet have the capacity to put it all together. But healthy functioning gradually emerges, and 'self' is seen to exist through time. It is projected into the future, and emotion experienced as a result. Eventually, even though it is culturally withheld, the reality of imminent death becomes evident to the primal mind. And this reality naturally attracts attention and begins a spiral of functional activity. We start digging at it, wondering why others aren't at all worried. But they are indeed worried, as we soon realise when we start asking questions.

The results of the complex emotional spiral which follows this 'loss of innocence' inevitably leads to an impasse - ultimate need gradually or even rapidly confronting the reality of ultimate thwart. The need itself is of a magnitude the system is not even designed to cope with, and with death it is thwarted in absolute terms. The

continued existence of 'self' is felt to be absolutely essential, and equally absolutely dependent on the survival of the body. But death for the body is not an optional reality, it is an imminent fact. And now the only thing standing between the system and the dreadful reality of death, is time. And that time is realised to be getting shorter and shorter with every passing second.

No answers are offered by culture to this emerging crisis, for what the child does not realise is that the adults they turn to are just as scared as they are, beneath their well polished denial.

Over time, as capacities emerge, healthy functioning attempts to resolve this dilemma. Once again seeking to integrate and fulfil needs it does not actually have, and once again failing completely.

Need fulfilment processes act to find ways through difficult problems. The core produces tension until they do. And so this process goes through all the natural options.

- First action to ensure fulfilment (anger) which ultimately finds no leverage.
- Then the only other option – action to integrate the need into the system as a 'desire producing' tension (grief). But this is not possible either, because of the nature of the need. There is simply no achievable potential to be desired, and it is simply not possible to integrate an infinite tension into a finite system.
- The result then, is the highest possible tension with the least possible resolution. Fear, and deadlock. Existential fear in fact, the highest valence emotive tension potential in the human system. The loudest possible emotional noise.

Existential fear, or just fear in general, has the power to suspend ordinary functioning at many levels and acquire emergency resources so as to achieve its ends. It eclipses normal healthy functioning and - because of its negative effect - it disables ordinary motive polarities. It cripples normal healthy functioning entirely. Like a country in the grip of an economic crash, everything stops.

The result, then, is a crisis in functioning, an emotive spiral of the greatest proportions, and all originating from the system's own healthy functioning. With the acceptance and embrace of 'I', the system has been able to accidentally actualize the most powerful and serious negative potential possible, and do so in a way it cannot understand, control or undo.

And why does this happen, you ask? Perhaps simply because it was there. Evolution does not think ahead, it simply tries a million different things and eliminates the ones that don't work. Shit happens.

So this is an event which happens at the inner end of life, not out in the world around us. But if you look at the inner gravity of this event and imagine what it would naturally equate to in outer terms, it amounts to greater potential tension than any real situation could dictate. Like the most unimaginable torture, it results in an attempt to produce *infinite* emotional tension, and is only prevented from doing so by the system's own failsafe mechanisms. It produces an endlessly perplexing knot in the deepest seat of the emotive core. It is very, very, very serious, and it grips us in the very seat of our being, where nobody but us goes.

But also remember, there is nothing actually happening here! This is, in fact, all occurring in a situation of complete need fulfilment in organic terms. At a relational level - objectively - this whole series of events is entirely fabricated on the basis of poor information management. There is no real problem to which this emotional crisis relates.

Actually, the unusual power of this event stems precisely from the very fact that it is not limited to only what is possible or likely in the real world, but is only limited by our capacity to imagine, and the ability of those imaginings to modify our deep sense of need. And for exactly the same reason, it is completely invalidated by culture, and mysterious to frontal awareness. The worst possible thing has occurred, but there is no obvious evidence of anything having happened from the outside looking in.

Psychotherapy generally deals with abandonment issues in people. That is – in the final analysis – what most people are suffering from. Physical abandonment, emotional abandonment, all sorts of abandonment, which all boils down to needs not being met. But people struggle to find validation for the feelings they dredge up when they go back into their depths. And this is why – because no matter what kind of family you grew up in, at this point you were abandoned by your parents not because of anything they did but because your needs suddenly

failed to be met. It might not be your parents fault after all, at least in this sense. Even if you were actually abandoned, you may still have experienced this even if you weren't, and if they were still there.

So all the natural processes within the system – which never stop to even question the reality of 'I' – seem to only make things worse. Because, of course, this is like putting out fire with gasoline. All of this is completely natural and good. Except for the one error which is not even suspected, this entire dilemma is built out of purely healthy functioning. But results in complete functional deadlock. A terrible situation in the end, everything begins to grind to a halt as more systems and functions are recruited to help resolve the impossible problem, but to no avail. There is simply no win, for winning this is just not possible. The system cannot just let go of this event, but also cannot function whilst it is active and unfulfilled.

This, then, is the primary crisis at the heart of the deep event I am seeking to outline here – the real thing we are suffering from.

So what to do? There seems to be no way out.

Well, at some point in the development of this subjective crisis the organism's own emergency systems put the brakes on it to prevent functional overload. And how do you shut down a healthy process? Repressive mechanisms, which are designed to absorb temporary stresses, are brought into play in order to contain this event and prevent it from spiralling further downward toward infinity. Repression is a healthy and adaptive capacity of our system, it allows us to survive things which would kill other organisms, and it does this by temporarily suspending or delaying certain vital and healthy functions. Like holding your breath when you have to dive underwater, or holding on when you really need to go to the toilet, it is supposed to be uncomfortable, and get more and more uncomfortable over time, because it is not ultimately natural, or healthy. And it is certainly never meant to be permanent.

But the choice facing the organism at this point is either loss of control, or containment, and control is vital to survival.

All of this occurs at some point in childhood, as all this functioning is emerging, and either progressively - or in some deep night time dread - this whole event is taken under and away from conscious awareness. Nightmares may explore it occasionally in an attempt to resolve it and release the effort of perpetual containment, but there is no answer to be found. The system's natural repressive capacities, designed to absorb powerful impacts from the environment, become employed to deal with an impact coming from within the system itself. And the scope and seriousness of these containment measures should not be underestimated. The impact is singular and overwhelming. The system, however, does not realise the origins of all this, nor even that need has been altered. So this is really all it can do.

Maybe we should summarise then -

The way need is represented within the system is unwittingly modified to include unconditional needs. Unconditional needs naturally seek to produce limitless stress in the face of imminent absolute threat, and the system goes into emotional overload. Leaving no option but to partly shut itself down in order to keep functioning at all. And until the source of this problem is removed, this shut down must remain active indefinitely. And all because of what seems on the surface of it to be such a reasonable and harmless idea - 'I'.

So the system itself consumes this whole event and secludes it away from conscious awareness. This entire event is – because of its gravity and the threat it poses to immediate survival – simply taken down. Like a dangerous machine it is deconstructed and scattered to the four corners of the self, with instruction never, ever, to be reassembled. It is a cover up, in classic conspiracy theorist style. The conscious level of awareness is immediately denied access to this information, that is the whole point. Consciousness is, by definition, integrating and unifying in nature, so the one thing that can never happen is for this event to become conscious.

Conscious awareness is excluded from this operation, then, that is the very task of the resulting unconscious agenda – to keep all this strictly unconscious.

So the result of this unavoidable occurrence is the establishment of what amounts to a secondary systemic agenda, another shopping list entirely. Like a secret government within a government, with its own motives and power.

Adding to the already complex enough native agenda, this dynamic secondary activity has infinite potential for oscillation, cycles and shifts. It is a **strictly unconscious** agenda with deep emotive foundations and a clear purpose or primary objective. That being the permanent and active prevention of one particular potential - and no small potential, but one which involves almost all the operations of the system. No particular function is targeted, only a particular outcome or potential spiral of events within the system.

So this event is buried, and the secondary agenda is charged with permanently preventing all future dogs from digging up this particular bone, which because of its dramatic magnitude still continues to smell even though it is buried deep. The incredible gravity, dynamic nature, scope, and seriousness of this containment process - this secondary agenda - are what we have been getting to here.

Beyond this point, the containment of existential fear becomes a driving force in life. The resources allocated to achieve and maintain this massive covert containment are potentially equivalent to the negative significance of it ever being reawakened – effectively limitless. The one thing the unconscious system knows about this event is that it is very very hard to stop once it gets going. And because it represents such a profound threat to our capacity to function and retain any equilibrium, that potential must be avoided at all cost.

Strangely however, the profoundly powerful fear at the base of this event is never actually experienced from that time forward, except very rarely, because life becomes completely defined by the complex and sophisticated avoidance of it. A life completely dominated by the avoidance of fear, fear so profound that it is never even felt. And this – by the way – is likely why we suffer psychological and emotional ‘trauma’ in a way that many animals do not. It is because sudden events can have the effect of not only hurting us in some way, but of disturbing our delicately balanced containment strategies, which can then take some time to put back together and cover up again. In this sense we are like fragile emotional time bombs, just trying not to ever get bumped too hard in case we go off.

The main thing we do in this regard is participate implicitly in our culture’s almost complete avoidance and denial of anything to do with death, or awareness of our own mortality.

The result, then, is permanent containment. Repressive capacities which exist to maintain and contain events temporarily are required to carry this task permanently. The unconscious is simply forced into the position of having to keep what is perhaps the single most significant fact about life, and about itself, hidden from...well, from itself effectively.

However, a primal memory always remains somehow. Some remembrance deep within us, of something having happened, of something lost, but it remains vague and indistinct. People have always made up stories about this ever since it has been happening. Myths always arise to support subjective experiences which culture does not otherwise validate. Things once conscious, but now held in the unconscious, if recollected are naturally experienced as far away or distant. I believe there are many such stories which relate to this event and to its ramifications. I am prepared to believe this experience is the primal ‘fall from grace’ we all seem to somehow recall or resonate with, and which many religions prey on. That the ‘garden of Eden’ is simply the free native state, the paradise lost. And that ‘I’ is the ‘forbidden fruit’.

Many other myths abound along similar lines. But this event was not in a distant time, it was not long ago at all, in this lifetime in fact. We remember this paradise because we existed in it from the time we were conceived to the point of this event occurring, at whatever stage that was. We also experience it in deep sleep, although we cannot remember directly, but we have a sense of it being blissful somehow. All of it is merely an emotional remembrance of our own free native state. Our birthright.

So this is not malicious, any of it, just unfortunate. It is a healthy and necessary and highly adaptive response to a very serious and unexpected event. It has allowed us to survive what could easily have been a disaster which ended us quite quickly - a problem which was only made possible because of our complexity and advancement, like a virus that can only infect a very powerful computer. But was also only able to be contained for the very same reason – because we are so complex, and therefore have a great capacity for repression and subversion.

The emergence of 'I' as a concrete belief or 'identity' within this innocent system is like an immediate nightmare, then. The very first thing 'I' knows, as it takes charge, is that something is not right. And that is because it's like skydiving and landing in a glider which is only designed to take one pilot, and sitting on top of the real pilot, so that they can't move. The glider immediately goes out of control, and 'I' struggles to correct the terminal descent. What 'I' doesn't realise, in this metaphor, is that it is – unlike the pilot it is sitting on – actually wearing a parachute. It should just bail out, and everything would be restored to a natural equilibrium. But struggle was the first thing 'I' experienced about this whole glider, it has never seen it in a good state, it doesn't trust. It doesn't realise that it is the source of all the trouble it is confronting.

Which leaves us where, then? In the common state. With a conscious self left to govern a system which – as its most significant defining feature – is charged with actively and dynamically containing an underlying event which the conscious self is not even allowed to see. It is a conscious state which confronts a constant barrage of unconscious impulses and tendencies and compulsions which are entirely mysterious to it, but which it seems unable to control. And even if it can control them, something else equally negative and mysterious will appear elsewhere. It seems to be very difficult to play the game of life and win the prize – happiness.

The specific anatomy of the functioning involved in this event – both the core anatomy of the negative potential being contained, as well as that of the organic systems being distorted and suppressed in order to achieve that containment – define the entire picture of the common human state. They account entirely for the apparently enigmatic nature of human behaviour, in great detail.

From this point on you are caught in a dilemma, then, struggling between two possible options, neither of which is a happy one – you are always either trying in some way to fulfil deep needs you do not actually have, or trying in some way to contain or deal with the emotional results of them being unfulfilled.

There is no happy third option here. And there are no 'happy' lapses in this state because of the direct connection between happiness and the integrity of all the functions being suppressed and distorted by the secondary agenda. It all comes from a single point of origin, but creates myriad dynamic negative effects, which together represent a massive distortion of overall integrity. All of which then produces a single point of energetic suppression to which happiness just happens to be directly associated.

Complicated? Yes, very. But what all this means, then, is that its ultimate effect on happiness is just unfortunate in one sense, but it is also very stable in effect.

This causal chain of events also indicates the massive systemic separation between cause and ultimate symptom, an almost impossible trail to follow back. And this is perhaps another reason why this connection has never been made.

So it is not the purpose of this secondary event to limit or prevent happiness. It is, in fact, a product of our own healthy system, and without it, we would likely not have survived. The pressure on our limited psyches would have exceeded our capacity to cope, and we would have gone mad completely. So instead, we only went half mad. The objective of the covert and powerful secondary agenda is not to stop you being happy. Nor is it to perpetually suppress or distort elements of your core functioning. It is only to contain one particularly active and dangerous potential which is always just a breath away from reanimating. The other two just happen to be the common downstream effects of this primary objective being met over time.

As mentioned at the beginning, we can look at this situation from three distinct perspectives - Primary-relational, core-functional, and natural-subjective. Outer, inner, and conscious respectively.

In core-functional terms, then (what is happening beneath the surface of our conscious experience of our inner worlds), where this crisis originates and resides, we see a profound degree of conflict and functional subversion. Like a secret government operating within a government, nothing is what it seems. A continual power play is being animated between opposing functions in a struggle for control of systemic action. A very sophisticated game with very high stakes. At any one time many aspects of subjective functioning may be shut down or negatively affected in some way by an active and extremely well orchestrated and explicitly unconscious secondary agenda.

In primary-relational terms (what is happening beneath the surface of the real world of relationships and organic transactions with the environment), nothing is happening to actually cause this whole event. Well,

at least not in relational terms. There is no external circumstance to warrant all of the activity happening in the core-functional levels. There is, in fact, no fundamental problem. But many of the demands and symptoms of this purely subjective conflict do flow through to affect the physical level. The eventual relational demands of this conflict really are potentially very great, and can therefore greatly affect the primary-relational level. And these *are* a problem at this level, and can be observed. But for some people this kind of symptom is much more prevalent than for others, depending on how they manage the containment. But in essence, there is no *real* crisis, just an emotional one based on pure imagination. In this state it could be said that the human system has become its own worst enemy. It is supposed to be the system against the world, but by and large it is now the system against the system. The demands of this crisis and its containment far outweigh the demands of living in our modern world. So in the common state the human system suffers far more from inside than from outside. And this suffering is of a very real and pervasive kind. Especially at the core-functional level. The valence of potential tension at the core level is equivalent to primary level stress of great magnitude. Even though there is no primary level issue to address. This core tension is then modulated by repression and functional distortion so as to appear minimal at the surface frontal level, but the frontal still suffers the consequences of that repression. Which gives the frontal level this choice - of suffering from emotional crisis, or suffering from repression. Not much of a choice really.

At the frontal level, then, where we adopt the natural-subjective perspective (your conscious experience, feelings and actions), we see a perplexing and confusing situation. The summary of all this conflict and confusion. A bewildered frontal self confronting a situation it can neither control nor understand. For the organism as a whole, this state can vary greatly depending on the forms of containment being enforced by the secondary agenda at any time. But for the conscious frontal self nearly all forms represent an irresolvable dilemma. For it is always caught in the middle of the emotional conflict each mechanism creates. And whilst its natural efforts to resolve the evident tensions it is faced with continue, such efforts are severely hampered by the fact that it is completely ignorant to the cause of such problems, or that such a profound conflict is even possible. We must always remember that if the secondary agenda is doing its job, then frontal awareness is going to be forever left completely in the dark.

So what we see from the natural-subjective view is a conscious self caught in the middle. We see a tortured mind, never able to relax or be still. The frontal self is responsible for responding to emotive energies and acting to fulfil them. And now we can begin to see the origins of the problems introduced in section one regarding the integration of all systemic desire into a seamless vision. For, when the frontal self seeks to feel into and collect its desires, and forge them into a single vision or plan, what you get is a body of relational transaction with little clear integrity at all. They don't all fit together, if they stay still at all. And the frontal self has no idea how to deal with this, so it just does its best to manage and keep on an even keel.

The native agenda

The relational program defined by the native emotive agenda can be seen to make obvious sense in light of the organism's functional needs in any situation. It is easy for the frontal self to embody this emotive agenda in action, and thereby fulfil its own purpose for existing. The native human agenda defines a game the frontal self can win, and win relatively easily in most circumstances. The native agenda is very stable, even to the degree it can be predicted with great accuracy. Thus, if you know what the relational needs of the organism will be in any situation, you will be able to predict the exact actions the native emotive agenda will be likely to be seeking to achieve. And by fulfilling such in advance, you could theoretically avoid any negative emotional tension whatsoever.

The fulfilment of the organisms primary level needs and interests is the *ONLY* function the frontal self has, it is its *SINGLE* responsibility. And in this way the native agenda makes sense at every point, from *primary need* to *emotive core* to *frontal action*. The point of integrity for all native functioning is the action which results, the purpose for which they exist. So all the pieces generally fit, because the native agenda is addressing actual reality. Because all the desired outcomes are transactional, and all relate to a single integrated system, ie - the organism itself in relation to its environment.

The secondary agenda

But the secondary agenda, well that is another matter. The primary purpose or objective of the secondary agenda is not transactional at all, but rather a systematic subversion of the healthy functional agenda at a subjective level. The primary-relational aspects of its presence are merely unavoidable by-products, they are not the point. So when you convert the secondary agenda into its action components, when you view it in terms of the shopping list it defines, it makes very little sense. The relational factors are merely the outer transactions required to support the particular inner functions being leveraged at any given time. Unlike the native agenda, relational transactions are not the point, nor the point of integrity. They are simply the scattered side effects of an agenda which is functioning to maintain its grip on something very specific at a deeper level of the system.

However, because the primary function of that secondary agenda at a core functional level is to subvert healthy functioning, and because such functioning is intrinsically linked to primary level functioning, this means that the relational components necessary to support such activity are bound to be contrary to the native agenda. Thus, conflict at a primary relational level is actually not the point, but because of the general integrity of the system as a whole it is completely unavoidable. So in relational terms, in the terms the frontal self understands, the two agendas are not so much completely conflicting, but working at right angles to each other. They can both be partly fulfilled without conflict, but can never both be completely fulfilled at the same time. And seeking to resolve this apparently intractable puzzle is what we tend to call a 'typical human life'.

Don't step on the Octopus!

If you examine the ways in which such containment of healthy functioning might be possible, in such a vast and complex system, you begin to see the scope and variation of the event I am suggesting here. The ways we might carry such a load are extremely varied and diverse. They are also completely dynamic, meaning they can change moment to moment. This whole thing, including the originating thought form 'I', is just like a virus – in this case a software virus just like a computer. The brain is, after all, actually just a computer of sorts. So everything happening in the brain is extremely active and almost instantaneous in nature, moment to moment. Small changes can have big effects, and generate almost instant feedback.

Which is just a long way of saying – all of this is not historical, it is happening right now, again and again, every minute of the day. It is being re-manufactured moment to moment, the whole thing. It's just that the rat keeps going down the same maze, again and again, and always getting stuck at the same point. Just the way the secondary agenda wants it. But then occasionally it will try something else, which means the subversive agenda must awaken and compensate. In fact, probably the very worst thing you could do in this state would be to disturb it too much.

Everyone manifests all this differently, both in terms of the particular form of their underlying identity formation, the way that manifests naturally into crisis if it is allowed, and especially in the way they have learned to contain that event. It is very creative actually, everybody has a unique combination. But an important thing to notice is that however your system is currently managing this load is very likely the best and most efficient way it has yet come across to do so – meaning that to disturb it in that task by attacking some random bit of 'dysfunction' will likely only serve to make its job harder, and therefore, your life worse overall. The subversive agenda will simply adjust, and move to some other form of containment instead. After all, it simply has a job to do and doesn't really care how. Your happiness is not its concern. If the system has to choose between happiness and survival, it will choose to survive.

Is 'personal growth' simply of no use then? What about all the things people do in the way of bettering themselves and tidying up some of the more damaging behaviours which blight their lives, and the lives of those close to them? And yes, not everything people do in the way of restoring integrity to their lives is necessarily futile, all I am indicating here is that there is a much deeper event going on, and that this must be taken into account in whatever changes we might decide to make. The consequences of too much success, however, in cleaning up your own life too well in this sense, can only be the reawakening of an epic underlying emotional crisis in the present moment, right here, in the here and now. And even if this is what you wanted to do, this is simply something that your own system will not allow to happen.

Imagine a balloon filled with a certain amount of air, and that it is stuck in a gap in a fence. So you squeeze the balloon to make it go away, but actually all you have done is displace the air. It is just a trick of perception that makes it look smaller. If you go around the other side you notice it has blown up to be huge. So you squeeze it again, and think it has gone away again, but then you go around and there it is again.

So it's like that, except that in this case the balloon is like an octopus with about five main limbs or legs, and each one of these limbs represents a potential form of containment for this underlying event. Each limb, therefore, also represents some degree of dysfunction and therefore ultimately some degree of unhappiness.

Which means that you can push and squeeze away to your heart's content, in your search for happiness and a bit of inner peace, but it will make almost no difference whatsoever to the underlying event. It is an extremely dynamic and polymorphous process, and it knows exactly what you're thinking before you even think it.

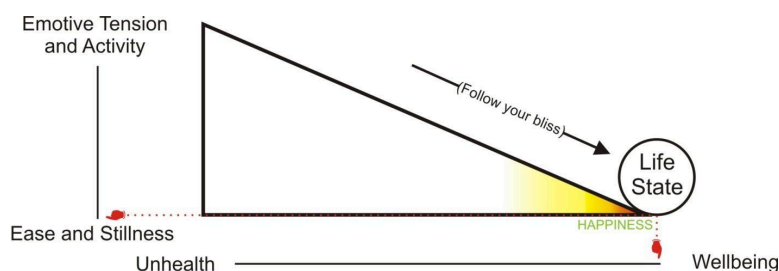
It's very creepy...

And whilst the forms of this event may have many shapes in core terms, this means they are almost infinitely varied in surface expression. Like two films playing simultaneously on the same big screen, it's confusing at the projector end yes, but on the screen it's a complete mess. There are two agendas working here, not in direct opposition necessarily, but certainly at crossed purposes. They chase each other around endlessly. And the dance between them at a core functional level is both extremely dynamic and extremely complex. Meaning what we experience of that in terms of emotional activity and behavioural tendencies is almost unfathomably fused and confused. No wonder we haven't been able to figure this out.

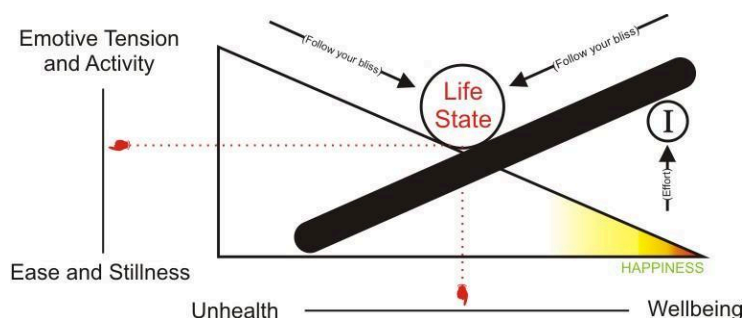
The result is a state which demonstrates a profound 'negative equilibrium', which cannot easily be undone. The native and healthy homeostasis is eclipsed by another whole event, and is effectively lost. But not entirely, the two agendas are only at crossed purposes, not in complete opposition. So only the positive end of the native equilibrium is obscured. Beyond this point the 'business' of organic existence is allowed and supported in doing well, but is absolutely never allowed to show a 'profit', because such free energy would immediately become available as 'feeling'. And feeling is healing. So a zero emotional bank balance must be maintained at all times, regardless of how well the business does. In fact, the better the business does, the harder it is for the secondary agenda to maintain this control.

The outcome is a shift in the primary emotional landscape of life in general, to a state which has a very disturbed kind of negative equilibrium. A dynamic and fluid disequilibrium, with a stable yet dynamic centre point. To see this more graphically we could once again view it as a diagram –

So from the natural and free state of the human system, which is integrated...



To another pattern of functioning altogether, permanently loaded and tense...



The ball of behaviour and stress is now stuck in the middle of this 'bowl' of unhappiness, and no matter what it does, it suffers. To make a conscious decision to move toward the positive end (wellbeing) too far, will eventually produce mysterious and ultimately uncontrollable compulsions which end up taking you back in the other direction, which will feel good to follow because you have a bit of healthy reserve built up, but will then have the result of affecting your health and you will once again be pushed back to the middle. This is the obsessive compulsive cycle. The ball rolls back and forwards.

So you go running and eating well and saving money, and some mysterious drive leads you to go on a bender and have a night out that takes three days to get over. And then it starts again...

I don't want to confuse you too much (too late I know) but there are about five balls I am representing here as just one, and they all act with an overall centre of gravity so to speak. So the oscillations and permutations are endless. Each ball representing a completely different form of containment. It is a circus. But the point is – if all of the balls get too far up the positive end, they will be pushed back by a wall of emotional tension. Whatever free energy you earn in the morning, the subversive agenda will have spent again by tea time. It doesn't want to bankrupt your life, but you are not allowed to show a profit, ever.

In the end, we have simply become very confused by an event we have yet failed to understand or account for. We have become smart enough to play a fabulous trick on ourselves, but have not yet become smart enough to figure out how, or how to undo it. For whilst the cause of that confusion remains active, no such resolution is possible. The cause of the problem is not recognized, because it is still the very thing trying to solve all this. You cannot be expected to recover from being raped, whilst the rapist is still in the room.

The body has in fact created for itself an imaginary master, and is running itself ragged trying to meet its overblown needs. And it is not 'I' that must learn to undo this error, it is the body itself which is generating this illusion, and which must eventually come to this profound realisation.

What is 'self' then, if 'I' am not one?

The imaginary fabrication of identity, which is the functional self reference called 'I', is simply not equipped to fathom the needs or the nature of Consciousness or Being or whatever else you might want to call the ultimate 'Self' of all things. And this is precisely because it is the active moment to moment creation of chemical and electrical reactions in a small animal's brain.

The actual 'Ground of Being', the true 'Self' of all things, likely has no need to know such things, it is very likely entirely self fulfilling in nature - that it is itself everything it needs. It can likely never SEE itself, but only ever BE itself. It is likely already everything it is ever going to be, and has everything it is ever going to have. But whatever it is we may never know, but this we can know – it is certainly not what you think it is, or even what you can think.

The point is, we don't actually need to know. Such things are beyond us, perhaps that is my point. I have no authority to answer such questions, or even to try. Ultimate and absolute concerns are only the business of ultimate and absolute beings. We on the other hand are human beings, only charged with knowing what we need to know in order to live out our finite and limited life spans as best we can. And the one thing which is apparently really worth knowing about all that, is not to bother with things which do not concern us. Such questions are not to be answered, because they are in fact the primary cause of the problem.

Indeed, in seeking to answer questions we do not need to answer in order to be happy, we can end up very very unhappy as a result. That we exist is perhaps all we need to know, and that some things are OK to forever remain a mystery, especially if our happiness depends on it, and does not require such knowledge. Not that we should ever deny such questions, but it is enough to know that when you do finally solve the true problem in your life, these questions will simply no longer arise. You simply won't need to ask about 'self' - you won't need to bother *seeing* it - because you will likely be completely absorbed in simply *being* it.

First: Free the Mind

So what if someone played a trick on you, and you didn't even know? What if it was so good, so complete, that you were not even made aware that it had occurred? Even though that trick permanently robbed you of your capacity to be stably and easily happy?

Then what if someone explained the trick to you? There would be a kind of pause...a kind of penny dropping 'aha' moment somewhere in there as you began to reformulate your entire view of your life into another context...

And what might this feel like?

You might need to read this a couple of times, because seeing it is not something your own unconscious will allow you to do at first. You may even be experiencing some degree of discomfort somehow about now if the implications of this are sinking in at all, and the sirens begin to wail and it's all hands on deck for this secondary agenda within you. And maybe I don't say it very well, but sooner or later someone will tell you this joke and your own unconscious will really get it. And at that point the whole thing will come to life as the immediate apprehension passes and you cross a primary threshold.

The result of knowing this is to realise that there is in fact a very big problem, which is not the easiest thing to accept at first, but it is also to thump the secondary agenda right between the eyes and tell it to sit down for a minute. Because unlike any previous, partial and dangerous awareness of this event, this time you are in a position to know what it is, and to know not to be alarmed. You immediately know how to defuse it, to some degree at least, you see the trick even if you can't stop it and this alone removes its power over you, and everything begins to relax and unfold.

Remember - the secondary agenda is simply an army of unconscious processes which just like the frontal conscious self does not actually know the source of this event either, it only knows it has to prevent it at all costs. So it is really not just your conscious mind that I am appealing to here, but also your teeming unconscious, and believe me it is always listening. So you have the beginnings of an opportunity to get a handle on it here, and grab the secondary agenda by the scruff of the neck. And as soon as the true nature of this event is first appreciated by the unconscious, it immediately sets your course in a whole different direction to that of the common approach. An entirely different approach to life emerges out of the mist, like a vision. A new path, defined in new terms, with new obstacles to overcome, and a new destination. A fairytale destination really, but this is no myth – this is not the matrix, or The Lord of the Rings. This is absolutely real. So I apologise if this is not quite as romantic or entertaining as fiction, if it is a bit heavy and demanding etc, but this is the real deal. It's on the level, as they say.

The common approach to life, in contrast to this emerging alternative, is to be forever subject to the dictates of this underlying conflict, and is simply to submit yourself to dramatise this event, and this state, forever.

There is no release from this state from a conscious standpoint, using only the feeling senses as your guide - no chance of escape or release. The real problem is not even recognized in common culture, and as indicated at the very beginning of this work these two agendas have been completely fused and confused. We embrace them both equally. There are entire sections of common culture which exist only and solely as an expression of this secondary agenda. And many others which contain elements of both.

The Common State

This is the problem everyone is trying to solve, and they don't even know what it is, let alone what the possible solutions might be. This event is the real problem you face. So I am not offering the answer here, I am offering the true problem at last, laid bare. This is the whole picture. How the system works in detail explains the possible and likely effects in detail. All this detail has already been worked out and is the subject of the main work to follow this brief. But the ultimate final summary is this –

If you do not solve this dilemma, and if you plan to retain at least some cognitive and moral integrity, you will likely not be happy. Ever. End of story.

For the conscious self, then, this is an unsolvable dilemma. We are all left asking the same question – in which direction is happiness? And feeling the way, we are forever lost. It is an impossible question, because the very rules of the game have been changed.

Happiness in this situation is not impossible, but it becomes a far more demanding and sophisticated event than it might otherwise be, involving the subtle balancing of a great many events simultaneously. It is certainly never the effortless state which we biologically expect.

We don't even see this great event, or even suspect it, even though it is by far the most powerful force in our lives. We are slaves to it, blind and ignorant servants, travelling in circles forever.

Everyone is broken. This is the world. The only option is how you choose to cope. Common culture is a flight from this, a symphony of denial. Common culture entirely reflects the common state, and the underlying negative equilibrium it expresses. It is designed expressly to support us in this effort to contain and control this event rather than in any deeper possibility – such as maybe exploring and even resolving it, and maybe even being happy as a result.

So can you really not be very happy in this state? Well, maybe you can. Indeed, those who do the best in this state are those who find their subjective integrity easy to suppress, or who didn't have much to begin with. If you are completely happy in the common state, then there really is probably something very wrong with you.

There are actually a few places in the functional landscape where happiness is possible, but they are ones which primarily involve the active 'manufacturing' via belief of imaginary fulfilments to fulfil the imaginary existential needs. They involve conjuring into existence something that will 'save us' from death, and thereby allow existential needs to be embraced and integrated without crisis resulting, for the secondary agenda to relax, and equilibrium to return. But at what cost? So yes, not all containment methods affect energy in extreme ways, so happiness is not strictly ruled out, although the costs to some other level of integrity in these cases are usually pretty severe, and most people prefer to be unhappy than believe what you need to believe to be happy in this state.

These fairy tales really are hard beliefs to uphold if you ever wish to be rational, but the gravity of the situation is obviously overwhelming for many. After all, confronting existential need on one hand, which is like having a gun put to your head – or mere cognitive integrity on the other, many obviously choose the former. So to believe you are going to be 'saved' from death is very obviously worth the price of your mind in many cases, as people cave in to the pressure of the common state. Provided of course that you are able to maintain that belief, which itself might give rise to a tendency to want everyone around you to believe the same thing as well, especially if such belief is difficult to validate.

So what if you were just really wealthy? Surely that would make me happy? But it simply doesn't, not beyond a certain point. That is simply a myth perpetuated by culture to keep hope alive. The negative equilibrium of the common state means that as you progress energetically beyond the fulfilment of your actual needs, you emotionally begin to go backwards. So if you tip more energy into this machine, you just get more conflict, it just turns the volume up. You see this again and again with sudden riches, such as when people win Lotto or become instantly famous, creating massive shock and dysfunction, and usually destructive discharge as the subversive agenda tries to get rid of it pretty quickly.

I would speculate that being wealthy, because of its energetic implications, actually requires a higher degree of stable containment, making it much easier to be or become rich if you were born rich, and thereby have patterns of behaviour and coping mechanisms learned from others who have grown up with it. To be poor is, in this sense, far more an emotional thing than a financial one. Wealth may offer the opportunity to see more of life than others do, to open your eyes even wider, but it also offers the opposite if that is your leaning. It offers you the chance to create for yourself an enclosed microcosm of denial and unawareness, a wall to protect and to never have to look beyond. Whilst the world starves, these people struggle with self control and obesity. They start wars to keep gas in their SUVs. If only ignorance really was bliss.

Those who wear the common state heavily, however, are often the ones who retain the most truth, the most depth, the most integrity, for they suffer for being real. To have too much functional integrity in the common state, to not be able to turn off healthy functioning, is a recipe for great suffering. Because too much integrity in certain functioning, especially emotional, cognitive or logical, will make containment very demanding indeed.

This is perhaps also why so many high level abstract thinkers will often be emotionally repressed or inept, simply because they have to be. This is the octopus in action, one fat leg = one skinny one.

The point here is that to suffer in the common state is honest. It is natural. This is not madness, it is integrity, honesty. It is what most of us are prepared to hide from ourselves and others, and why we will attack anyone else for ever exposing. Such attacks are, of course, simply direct evidence of this powerful subversive agenda in ourselves, in action. We attack in others what we are afraid of in ourselves.

Summary -

You really want to know what's going on with your life?

You are subject to two competing agendas in your own emotional core, you are in fact effectively two people, and one of you must remain forever hidden from the other. You eventually learn to live together, or you struggle with yourself endlessly, but either way this embrace is permanent until it is undone at its root.

This other event is the shadow of common psychology, it contains all the parts of ourselves which express themselves in our lives, but of which we are generally unaware or in denial of. And this is why you don't get rid of your shadow in psychotherapy, you learn to integrate it and fulfil it safely. You simply learn to bring this covert agenda in from the cold, and make peace. Which is good, but you never actually get to resolve it there, or even figure out what it actually is.

This is what sets our emotional compass spinning, then, this is why we very often don't know what we want, and can't figure it out even when we ask deeply and are prepared to follow it. It is because, when you ask that question, you are calling forth two entirely different shopping lists. And one of those is being written in direct relation to whatever is on the other. In some ways, the better and more healthy the native list is when you ask, the more unhealthy the second list will become, because an essential balance is always being sought.

So the native agenda, that coming from the healthy underlying organism, is seeking positive organic equilibrium. It is simple, natural, and easy to fulfil. It just wants to be free and healthy and to relate positively to others. Its underlying purpose is the fulfilment of the stable and true needs of the human organism, and the maintenance of all the healthy subjective functions which make it such a beautiful system. These are like its feathers, and like a peacock it is always busy keeping them straight and pretty.

The second agenda has another purpose for existing. Its purpose relates to a process of inner subversion. The job of the secondary agenda is to prevent one particular potential from being actualized, a healthy and natural potential it turns out, if all the information the system has at hand is correct (if 'I' is real etc). And what this means, in the end, is that its job is effectively to prevent the native agenda from delivering too much health, too much integrity, or from ever developing too much awareness. The job of this agenda is to prevent this peacock from ever taking flight, which means it must cut or remove feathers constantly. Its essential job is not to meet needs, but to distort functioning. And because any distortion in functioning naturally affects happiness, happiness becomes the ultimate casualty. But if the organism has to choose between happiness and going out of control, between happiness and survival, it will choose survival every time. You do not actually need to be happy in order to survive.

We surely start to see now how this might have been overlooked. The subversive agenda's very purpose is to hide, and its actions in relation to healthy functioning obscure the integrity which lies beneath this crazy mess. It has been missed because it was designed to be missed by the most sophisticated and intelligent thing yet discovered, something that knows our own mind better than we ever will from any conscious level. It was designed to remain hidden, that is its whole purpose.

So here we are then: when you ask the question – what do I want? The answer you get back is always a strange and mercurial mixture of energies which never seem to be able to settle into a clear vision. And this is because you are looking at what is effectively an endless wrestle between two entirely different agendas. And the more you support or promote one of these two, the more the other one will grow and become stronger to maintain

balance. In which case what you want tomorrow will be opposite to what you want today. It is all impossible to solve from the inside, but also quite beautiful when you see it in the full light of day.

Terrible News? No, it's fantastic. We are far more deeply screwed up than we realise. There is no peace here, no stillness, no rest. Does this sound terrible? No, that's the whole point. These are not bad tidings, this is the best possible news. It is the most wonderful thing, if you think it is in any way bad then you still haven't looked closely enough.

If this is the case then what it means is that there is no way out via the common approach, that the problem we face is actually worse than we thought, it is astoundingly deep and dynamic. But that is actually cause for huge celebration. Because if this really is the case, then it is not new. Saying all this does not make it so, it is already the case now, like it or not. So looking only exposes what is already there – all it does is release the effort of denial.

How can knowing this make things worse? If it can be removed, then the seriousness is the best thing about it, because that makes the potential resulting state more dramatic. The massive negative depth and gravity of this state only serves to make us aware of a positive potential of equal weight, one so profound that it almost defies belief. It points to a previously unrecognised potential with the power to change lives almost completely, without a single external thing having to be added. It is a dream come true. In this case, the worse it is, the better it is.

We need only bridge that gap now, and it will all unfold. So another approach is clearly required. The other path is to own up, to share and explore the one thing which – as a common enemy – unites all people. But the skills associated with doing well in this state, in making your prison cell more comfortable, are completely different to those required to plan and execute escape from it.

Courage and especially insight are required here. The most balanced position in this mess is down in the centre of the bowl, where all the parties happen, but this is also the least likely to find release from it. It is out on the extremes that the action will happen here, way out on the frontier of human consciousness, where the winds blow hard. Escape is truly the only solution, but nobody is doing that because they don't even see it. They are supposed to not see it, that's the whole point. But the fact remains, the only true path to happiness currently has almost nobody on it.

All of which brings us back to an underlying question about how best to navigate life in general -

Should we follow what you feel?

Yes, entirely, completely. But the conflict in our emotional foundation means that to do this you must first restore its integrity, for only then can you fulfil its desires. More than any other option, the path which resolves this underlying dilemma at its source defines what it means to follow your heart, to do what you love, to live your passion, to flow with your own river, to dance to your own beat...more than any other path in the common state can even come close to. This is to win the happiness game by changing all the rules so that you can't possibly lose. It is to trick the trick, cast a white spell on the wicked wizard, it is finally to restore your own heart and stop your beautiful compass from spinning.

The Spinning Compass –

So we return now once again to examine the heart, this time with more insight and understanding of the anatomy of its afflictions, and also its potential redemption.

The depth and profundity of the events outlined in this section should not be underestimated. It impacts the physical level certainly, and the planet suffers from this, but the real impact is subjective, inwardly in direct relation to our capacity to be stably happy. So it is really a storm in a teacup, one which overflows a little sometimes, but which is actually isolated to our own inner worlds for the most part. But this teacup just happens to be where we live, and makes up pretty much everything we feel and experience, so to us it matters the most. And at this level the effect is epic, and sweeping. It is truly a catastrophic event subjectively. So whilst we trample on many other species in our mad scramble for sanity, we ourselves are hurt far more by our imagined reality than anything else is.

This event is a heartbreaker then, a thief of the human heart. That is the final cost. In the end we are not happy because to be happy you need to have a heart, and ours was taken.

What is the heart then? In the metaphorical sense I mean, not physically. Physically the heart is obviously just a blood pump. But as indicated earlier, many of the less physical and more sophisticated aspects of our subjective functioning are actually directly anchored into our organic structures, so as to provide both integrity and a kind of grounding in the organism which they all serve. So it could be that the physical heart and the emotional heart are more than mere allegories. And this is true of many physical structures.

What does it mean to 'vent your spleen'? This connection between organs and particular emotional states has long been considered elementary. Which is perhaps why, quite literally, an emotional shock can have very real effects on your physical wellbeing. It is certainly very common for someone to hear very bad news for instance, such as their partner being killed in a car accident, and to suffer a very real heart attack as a result, not just a 'broken heart'.

So of all the different emotional functions we embody, and the organs or physical systems with which we associate them, what does the heart represent?

The metaphorical or 'mythical heart' is simply the core of emotive integrity, a defining singularity, a unity, it is something unequivocal. The heart represents the one place where all the threads of our being converge, and all agree. It is a metaphor which represents an implied systemic reality. It is the final representation and embodiment of our almost fathomless integrity as beings. It is a summary, a statement of what it means to be the product of billions of years of evolutionary refinement and testing. It is the crown jewel, meaning that the holy grail now – the thing we must now find – is the thing that will allow it to be returned.

We have broken hearts. That's what it means to have lost the primary integrity of our emotional landscape, this is why we cannot rest. This is why we don't know what we want, because to even ask this question is to stand at the altar of the heart and seek wisdom. And there is no answer, precisely because the heart has been kidnapped, the true owner and rightful ruler of our being has been replaced by a tyrant in the mind, and the great throne – the real throne – stands vacated. So we are lost in the wilderness, wandering aimlessly, having lost our true compass and guiding light. In fact most of what we do can be defined as mere attempts to un-break our lost hearts. We only want to be able to trust. In particular, to trust ourselves.

So what do you really want? I don't even have to ask you to know the answer to this question. What you really want is to know what you really want. Because to know what you really want is in some essential sense to know who you really are.

What you really want defines your essential path, your unique expression and purpose and vision. And we all have such a true path to follow and explore. So when you ask the question 'what do I want?' deeply and with surrender, that path is what should emerge before you. Your true path, your deepest passion and vision, your entelechy, your daemon, it all comes from the wellspring of the heart. But as indicated, the event we have outlined in this section is like a hole that we have all fallen in on the way to fulfilling our dreams.

So what do you want? No matter who you are, and no matter what your particular passion or talent or vision of life is, what you want is actually exactly the same as the person standing next to you, because you both have something very important in common. What you want, more than anything else, is to get out of this hole. Because until you do that, your real journey, no matter what it is, cannot even begin.

This is what it means to lose your heart. We are all broken in this respect, and this event is far deeper than we realise. Myths only capture the common imagination when they reflect or define an aspect of experience which cannot be otherwise expressed. The more a story does this, the more we like it. And so every great story begins..."A great tyrant has arisen, and a darkness has fallen on the land..." And so also, begins the hero's quest.

And is such restoration possible? Yes, it certainly is. The heart is actually only obscured, not lost. The tyrant is just sitting on it, suffocating it.

But is it demanding, this restoration? Yes, it is very demanding, but help is coming. We are about to unlock the final gate to this kingdom. This is truly the best time to be alive.

A Wonky Weeble

All of this introduces the most astounding possibility, and one which clearly requires considerable explanation -

The source of common unhappiness is not coming from outside of us, and therefore has no outward solution.

If this truly is the problem, if this is why we are consuming the Earth, then there is no political solution to it, except enforcement and regulation. This is a logical certainty.

So what if we were experiencing the results of a subversive event which disturbed our capacity to experience the actual and simple conditions for happiness, as happiness? And what if this event originated from within us, in the form of activity we were ourselves responsible for, and not from outside? What if it was something we were doing? Albeit unknowingly? What if we have, quite inadvertently, managed to generate for ourselves very real and significant unhappiness, on a very stable basis, without even knowing how, nor being able to stop ourselves from doing it?

This is the Weeble again, but now we can see that the Weeble has a counterweight on its head as well, which means it has lost the natural equilibrium which makes it stand up normally, and now has another new quite stable equilibrium instead. This new one does not make it stand upside down, after all it is not trying to kill it, it is trying its best to protect it. But it can only now lie on its side. It can roll now however, meaning that there are many ways it can lie on its side, but it just can't ever stand up straight, not without experiencing a huge amount of inner tension. Never truly happy, and never truly sad, it is forever stuck with half a life.

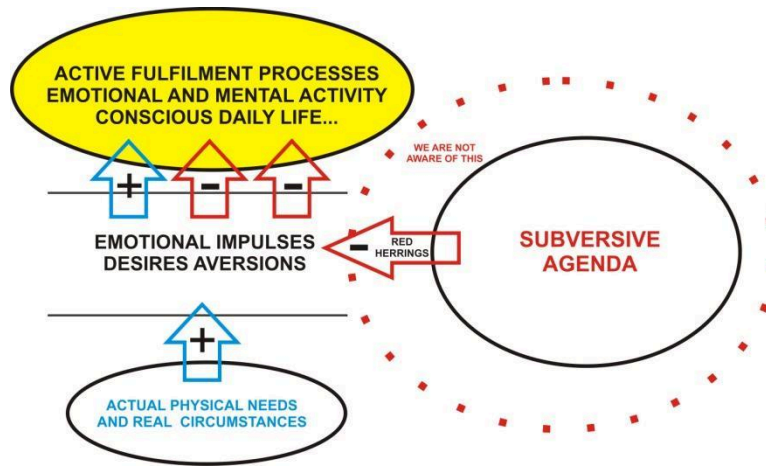


What can you do then? Not much. Well, until you get a handle on it anyway.

Forever oscillating, trying to stand up, or simply resting in a half alive, half emotionally satisfied situation, it is a state of perpetual unease. Or a combination of both – the obsessive/compulsive cycle. And because we are tuned by evolution to always presume an outward cause for unhappiness, we could consume ceaselessly in an attempt to solve this dilemma, a state we do not understand. With only this outward gaze, the game - for consciousness - is actually not fair.

It's a beautiful trap actually. Attention was never developed to look back towards its own source. So we can't see these added weights, we only feel the tensions they generate, the emotional results. We did not evolve to look within ourselves and mess with our own emotional foundations. Elected officials work for the people, not the other way around. That is precisely the point of the way this system works. So this has no solution, not externally.

This is an intractable problem for the besieged frontal persona – the conscious self – to try to solve. Like a servant with two masters, one who wants it hot, the other cold, one who wants it light, the other dark...but both of whom have a big stick to beat the servant with. It is not the servants job to question...just to submit. And in this case, to simply suffer. Forever. It does not matter what position the conscious self takes here, the situation is intractably conflicted, inherently bound, from the conscious standpoint at least.



Above you see another very basic diagram which represents the common state. The yellow bit is your conscious experience, and the arrows directly beneath you are the emotional forces you encounter: the emotional foundation of your daily life. You cannot see the entire subversive agenda, nor can you differentiate the emotional products of it. The result is that you are constantly chasing these red herrings because to do so feels right emotionally, but doing so has nothing whatsoever to do with what you actually need, which is represented in blue. Actually, by and large, the subversive agenda is directly attacking some element of healthy functioning as part of its operations. Maintaining this activity is a huge part of what you do, and you do not even know you are doing it.

How many things could you do in order to stop feeling so afraid? For the most part, when you consider this, you realise you are already doing them. So if something came along that made you feel even more secure than you do now, what would it feel like? It would feel good, it would feel nice, it would feel deep and warm and attractive. And if you had the option to keep it, you would probably form a deep attachment to it. But if the fear you were assuaging in that case was not actually valid, then such attachment might only be a source of endless trouble in relation to the fulfilment of your actual needs. Hugely costly, it could be entirely wasteful and redundant. And it is not only the cost of attachment to external relationships that matters. If damaging your own natural internal functioning happens to produce this same feeling, then you might just as easily become attached to this. And the avoidance of free energy and attention (feeling) is basically identical to an attraction to a low energy state. It makes you a magnet for poverty and fatigue.

Even simpler then –

If unhappiness has an objective source, then an objective solution can be inferred. If unhappiness has a subjective origin, then a subjective solution can be inferred.

But if any body of unhappiness is of subjective origin, then no objective solution can ever address it, and the result of attempting such would only be endless consumption and no relief, because it is based on a fundamental error in approach or perception. This, I believe, is the world as we know it.

It all indicates the singular error which can account for our greatest problems, both collectively and individually, as well as our greatest potentials. It shows us exactly where we are going wrong, and exactly (if you have the full picture) what going right might look like, and where that might begin.

So what if you could no longer trust what you feel to direct your way in life? How, then, could you navigate your way toward happiness? What if the directives implied in what you feel are not actually physically compatible? Would happiness in that case even be possible, no matter what you did?

If this occurred, to the exact degree it occurred, no matter how much you felt and acted, nothing would bring you closer to happiness. Nothing. A conflict in your emotional foundation is an intractable barrier to happiness, because happiness results from the fulfilment of such, which in such a case just isn't possible.

The only way to become happy, in this situation, would be to somehow resolve this conflict of integrity at the base level. You could not, however, do this by ‘feeling’ your way toward such resolution. Because your feelings in this case are the problem not the solution. If you cannot trust what you feel, or at least a great deal of what you feel, because you cannot tell which parts are valid, then all feelings become suspect. Complete emotional fulfilment is the stated goal of most people, and therefore the desired outcome of any true path. But an ‘emotion based’ approach could never achieve that goal in this case, because it could never find freedom from this self enclosing dynamic. One might even need to be able to act and apply insight *against* emotive tension temporarily – in just the right direction – to restore integrity to the afflicted core.

The final point here, then, is that you simply could not solve such a dilemma until you adopted a perspective which enabled you to transcend the corruption which blinds your mind. This would be primary. Without this, you would be forever looking **from** the problem, and never **at** it. It would, for consciousness, be the perfect trap.

Therefore, if you are not happy, you need not necessarily despair. You may in fact be playing well, very well perhaps, and very courageously. It could be the game that isn’t fair. The emotive core sets the rules of the game for the conscious self, and it could be that because of the dynamic in place, no matter what you do you cannot ever win...in fact the better you do, the more you might tend to suffer.

This view indicates a completely separate approach to life, then, another whole path entirely. It is a fundamental diversion. On the common path people employ their emotional compass to navigate their lives, and to the degree the conflict encountered leads to frustration, they generally just compromise, and accept less than they otherwise would. Conversely, some even embrace their emotional core, and champion it fully, but once again they do not end up as fulfilled as you would imagine, but simply demonstrate more boldly the conflict at their core.

So are these really the only two options? What if the conscious self found another way to solve this puzzle, another vantage point from which to gain clear and definitive bearings about which truly is the way out of this complex bind? If such a possibility existed, then the outcome of using such might be a breakthrough in this age old dilemma.

Eventually the body itself must act to restore this balance. In fiction the body might be represented by the lowly gardeners, in touch with the earth. It is, therefore, little Hobbits that must return to the mountain where the mistake was once made, into the very fires of hell, and finally relinquish their most prized possession.

This is the journey we take from here, this is what we will cover in the next section. And the most important thing to know about that journey is that whilst you could do it alone and without a map, you don’t actually deserve to. This emerging path, and its goal, represents the foundations of profound unity and alignment with others, like nothing else ever could. The dis-ease we suffer from has been like the darkest and coldest night which has lasted ten thousand years. It will only now be in this unity and deep communion with others that the great shackles are finally broken, and the heart is released from its heavy burden, and once again begins to warm our world like the sun rising in the east.

This possibility is the only thing that could make this degree of difference now, not only to our own internal experience but also to the way that is expressed in the ecosphere. We are destroying this beautiful planet, plundering it. We are searching for happiness in the wrong place, and have forgotten who we really are. We have brothers and sisters in this world, it does not belong to us alone.

This emerging potential – to awaken from this nightmare – might now be the only sustainable future humanity faces. And it is truly the most fabulously beautiful thing because of its gravity, even more so because when we look back one day we will truly be able to say – we really didn’t even see it coming. The hard thing is that this is the one thing that nobody can do for us. It starts here, with you. But the best thing is that it is also the one thing that nobody can stop us from doing. How often can you say that these days?

This possibility, and the courage it will require, is now the hope of the Earth, the very light of the world to come.

PART FIVE

The Only Way Out

Over time it has become clear that most people don't really understand the upshot of what has been explained in the pages above. They don't see the bigger picture, or what it all might mean. Which could be because it is necessarily abstracted there, and that a degree of translation is required in order to see it in concrete terms in their own lives. But even when they do this basic work, it often remains beyond their grasp emotionally. They can't engage it, or the staggering implications. So they kind of get it as a principle, but in the end its main import bounces off them psychologically rather than being integrated, and this is basically because they are not emotionally prepared to face the personal elements of such. It is considered kind of ludicrous, unacceptable if taken at face value, and so even if it makes sense intellectually it is often not engaged emotionally.

The main reason for this is that, by and large, our conceptual frameworks are not fluid and dynamic. They are not upheld with the discipline in mind that they should be as accurate as possible in relation to the reality of our situation, and therefore always adjusting and changing as new insights emerge. But rather, our view of life generally becomes fixed and rigid over time, as part of the very thing we are studying. We are, therefore, often only looking for possibilities which will support what we already believe, what we need to believe, and what is emotionally comfortable - anything that will reinforce what we are already struggling to uphold. And so the failure to grasp this concept is for the most part not an intellectual one, but an emotional one based on being backed into a corner.

It all comes as a kind of lump, and this is the problem. By virtue of its very nature, it cannot be partly true in essence. It is either basically correct, or basically not. Like being pregnant or being on a horse - you either are or you aren't, and there is not much in between. And people are simply not accustomed to being put in a situation where they have to try to integrate such a profoundly fundamental consideration, and one which has such sweeping impact on the way they have tended to view things, and therefore has such deep consequences relative to the way they orient their own search for happiness. Which is perhaps why, at some point, for most people, it often just bounces off them in a kind of intellectual immune response. It is just too much to take in. And I agree. It is too big. Even for me.

Which brings us to the subject of this section. This basic resistance is essentially a resistance to change. It is completely natural. All organisms abhor change, even positive change - which is the other side of this coin.

Whilst on the surface of things the basic emotional resistance to this possibility is the resistance of something negative - that being the fact that we suffer from a very deep and serious problem - what is perhaps even more unacceptable is the obvious equal and opposite positive this all implies. It really is the best possible news, and people feel that. So good in fact that people can't bring themselves to even consider that it might possibly be true. They would get too excited. They might even cry.

In particular what people feel but don't immediately understand is how deep this idea is, and how completely it voids the main exports of all other broad social paradigms. Not intentionally, mind you, just inherently, because the error it corrects is so deep, and because that error is so universally present at this time. It is, unavoidably, a revolution.

And this is not just theoretical. All current views are guilty of the great fallacy - of the failure to differentiate the two agendas. There are no exceptions to this, which I suppose is what I am trying to point out here. If what I am outlining here is basically true, then all existing social paradigms are basically wrong, or at least made somewhat irrelevant in its wake. All of them, and at a pretty fundamental level.

This really is the one thing you need to know about being human, so if you know it, it changes everything.

This is the first view which differentiates these two events, and thereby even remotely approaches the possibility of transcending the limitations of the common state. Which defines all other views in contrast, as part of the problem not part of the answer. This is unavoidable. And how big a change does it spell? Big. How far off the mark have current views been? Far.

And the resulting fusion and confusion means that a great many intelligent people are effectively incapable of even grasping the basic nature of the solution all this implies. It lies beyond their basic comprehension. As a possibility it simply does not fit within their existing frame of reference. And this is precisely because their existing frame of reference is critically inept, and because this emerging alternative is so deep in its correction of that error.

As we now reach the point where we begin talking about practical applications of everything we have covered, all this becomes more important to realise. It is important to first of all see just how divergent this view is relative to anything you can find elsewhere at this time, and to prepare yourself accordingly. Otherwise you will be in for a nasty shock. The practical solution all this theory points towards is not cosmetic, it is fundamental. The potential it points toward can and will be proven to be real. FMRI scanning will eventually empirically confirm it, which will have the inevitable result of supporting the basic theory. And it is not out there somewhere in the world of others or politics or in merely shifting your perception of things, it is right where you are.

This is the real deal. This is not entertainment. And big answers land heavy.

That being said, then, you have been warned, and we are on our way...

We really are stuck here. It's quite a dilemma. So serious in fact that nobody has ever managed to find their way out of it in a way that they could repeat in others. It would seem that the radical complexity, subjective nature and intrinsic concealment of the subversive agenda represent a very real barrier to even beginning to address the possibility of somehow resolving this situation. After all, we have not even been able to see it until now, let alone begin to do anything about it. Its power over us is almost complete. So how do you even begin to formulate a plan of action against something which is itself directly involved in the formation of the motives which would drive you to do so? It is a mind bender.

How can we even find a way to affect it? Behaviour is just the symptom not the cause, as are the emotional tendencies which drive such. They are just the surface level. So if – as we saw in the previous section – surface level transactions are always only symptomatic of something deeper, and if we only have access to the surface level consciously, then how can we ever access the essential core of such an event itself? Not to mention the fact that, at the surface level, the behavioural products of this deeper event are completely fused and confused with those of the native agenda, and therefore impossible to clearly differentiate.

Even if we could somehow bypass and ignore its influence on our will, how could we actually get hold of it? How can we gain leverage over it, or even get close?

In the end we are locked out. When you examine all the systems and functions involved here you begin to see just how unfathomably and ridiculously complex and polymorphous and dynamic this situation really is. You can't unravel it all, it is just too complicated. You could study it for years and never get to the bottom of it.

But do we really need to know everything about it? What are we looking for here? Surely all we want is a way out? Surely all we are looking for is the off switch. All the rest doesn't matter, not unless it helps us to find that. And I could go on endlessly here about all the options which would not work, and why, and what the consequences of trying them would be. But if we need to apply something equally complex in its removal then we are basically screwed, because how will anyone ever be able to apply such knowledge? We already can't even begin to understand the problem in any practical detail, the best we can do is sketch outlines.

This is where we get pretty stuck. If I left it all here it might take people years to figure it all out and find the off switch. Because let's also not forget – everyone is different. Our basic subjective anatomy may be shared in common, but the way we each manifest the originating crisis itself, and then manage to contain that, is completely unique to us. It's like smashing wine glasses. They all start off basically the same, but they all break differently. And so putting each one back together is always going to confront new challenges. So how can any solution possibly fit everyone?

What we need here is power, and simplicity. Which are the two things that appear to be off the menu. What we need is something simple enough for people to understand, but powerful enough to offer complete and sure-fire leverage over the situation. Some kind of smart bomb, something which would be able to tell the two events apart, which would support one and remove the other. A simple injunction which, if applied, could offer a clear

and concise solution to an otherwise intractable dilemma. Like a vaccine of sorts, which you don't actually have to understand in order to receive. Or maybe like a reboot of your computer when it gets a problem, rather than having to go into all the software and figure it all out. You just save all the open files, and then turn off the power. Totally simple.

As you will see this analogy might actually be quite apt. Because, of all the sophisticated solutions we could ever come up with, even with a summary grasp of all the complexity involved, the simplest ones might end up being the most powerful. Simplicity is the point toward which we must strive. That is our only chance. And it is possible that a simpler or more succinct injunction than the one I will now explain may one day be found, but I doubt that. I think this might be the most powerful manoeuvre available.

I call this particular view 'aeroplane' because I think about it when I am flying, and because it first emerged in that context. And I mention this because we will come back to flying shortly to illustrate a few basic points.

A couple of reminders to begin with, from earlier sections:

- All higher functioning of emotion and mind evolved to serve organic need, and the combined function of such can basically be summed up as – change management. In particular, change that is good for the physical organism.
- All higher functioning involves active tension and effort, and costs energy. Basically, that seeking is not as much fun as finding, which is why we keep going until we reach that point of release.

What these two basic points bring to light is that the underlying balance which naturally determines the degree of happiness we experience – or the amount of tension, effort, thought and emotional activity we are confronting – is simply one of need/fulfilment. Which, put another way, means that in any situation of complete need fulfilment complete happiness should be possible and naturally present. Conversely, however, what this implies is that if – in a situation of complete need fulfilment – we cannot relax such activity, then something is going very wrong. In that case the essential connection is being missed. If we remain emotionally tense and mentally active, even when we decide to stop, then we are confronting some kind of problem.

In this case what we are missing is the resolution cycle. We are missing the positive end of the emotional whip and carrot spectrum, the reward end. All activity relating to need occurs as an event spiral. Such activity arises in response to need, acts, and then resolves back into stillness once the need has been identified and met.

Think about it – your bladder is full and getting fuller. You do not just sit there calmly. You begin to get upset, agitated, and eventually even desperate. At an emotional level this feels like bliss being disturbed, and the result is a movement of attention and eventually action to relieve the source of tension. And then a sense of emotional bliss as this underlying need is met.

That is how it all works. Very simple. The resolution of this cycle is an important motivational feature. Whatever goes up – motivationally speaking – should eventually come back down. There is simply no point to produce an emotional tension which does not have an accompanying act, and which will not be released at some point upon the completion of such. That would be a recipe for great emotional pain.

Of course this all sounds rather familiar, however. The basic assumption of this whole work is that we are constantly engaged in behaviour which is not actually necessary relative to the true purpose for which this kind of functioning exists, and that such behaviour is therefore a complete waste of energy and emotional/mental resources. We are not being offered a carrot, nor being whipped, in order to motivate us toward some positive outcome. The carrots have been abandoned, the outcome is not possible, and we are simply being blindly whipped. The activity of the subversive agenda does not relate to need at all. In fact, if you examine the outcomes which result, it very often equates to some kind of attack on the integrity of the organism and its ultimate interests. And we could go into all the details of such, but once again there is no point repeating all of this.

The point is that all this activity is effectively and truly and completely redundant if the actual needs of the organism are already securely met.

Put another way – The purpose of emotion is change management. The purpose of thinking is to resolve emotional tension. The purpose of action is to produce change, and thereby resolve both emotional tension and mental activity. So in a situation where action is not possible, or where you have effectively no control over your situation, emotion serves no purpose. Such as on an aeroplane.

Many people experience anxiety when they fly, they cling to the arms of their seat as if they are holding the whole machine together. But what they don't clearly understand is that they have effectively no control over the outcomes they are seeking with such frantic internal action. Once those doors close they are simply going to arrive at whatever destination their flight is bound for, and there is nothing at all they can do about it. If they completely relax into fathomless bliss, or if they grit their teeth and shudder with fear at every bump, the outcome will be the same. So in flying we find a metaphor of sorts, which captures this central issue, especially as it relates to fear.

Actually this same principle relates to all emotional and mental activity when you take it further, and we see that situations such as flying can help to explain an even deeper potential. We find in this simple template an obvious and easy way to isolate the entire subversive agenda. It couldn't be more basic. Because what this situation shows is just how simple our true needs really are. It is against international aviation law to operate passenger services if you do not fully cater for the needs of those who travel with you. Which means that – for the duration of any flight anyway – your actual needs are always taken care of. They must be. And the other thing which such a situation does is that it limits our ability to provide ourselves with any alternative sources of fulfilment for such. You can't just step outside for a walk, or a burger down the road. We are essentially powerless, and fully catered for. Which sets us up with a particular kind of situation, and a stark contrast of several things which together form an interesting mix.

In this situation, then, why do we even think at all? Why can't we just stop? If effort basically hurts, and emotional tension is effort, then why don't we just take all such opportunities to relax and resolve all this activity back into the bliss of organic union? Why don't we stop thinking and just feel? In particular, if all needs are met, why don't we just feel total fathomless bliss?

This situation shows us one very important thing, then – we simply can't stop. In some ways this situation forces us to stop, but because the subversive agenda's options become limited it has to keep us occupied. And if it fails to be able to do this in such a situation, the result is existential fear. Which is what many people experience, regardless of the statistical safety, or that they were in 100 times more danger driving to the airport. This fear is simply the result of being forced into a situation where subjective free energy (feeling) becomes available or even unavoidable.

The point of which, if you think about it, is that this is something we can do anywhere if we choose. You don't need a jumbo jet to just make some time, and sit still.

What this shows us is just how much of what we feel and think and plan and put into action is not actually related to what we really need, and is therefore completely redundant. And of course we now know what this activity is. But most people have no idea. They are completely unaware that they are busily and actively serving epic processes of creation that have no positive outcome relative to what they actually need, and no positive relationship to their own capacity for happiness. They are unaware that they have actually crossed the finish line ages ago, but have kept on running for miles, and just keep on going, looking for happiness.

So what would happen if we did just stop? Think about it all from the perspective of the physical organism for a moment – if all need was met for a period of known duration, why should we not be able to simply stop all effort and activity, and instead of 'doing' all the time, to just 'be'? How dangerous would this be?

Obviously this would not be dangerous at all. You do this every time you go to sleep. The only difference is that this time it would be conscious. And here we see the outlines of a simple injunction emerging. Here we see one thing that the native state can easily do, which the common state cannot. Here we see the one thing which the native agenda can do, which the subversive agenda will avoid at any cost -

To simply fulfil need, and then stop. Complete effortlessness.

For millions of years evolution has confirmed one thing in our primal minds, again and again one single axiom echoes in the depth of our beings – that great outcomes result from great efforts. And so this answer lies right

where we would never think to look. The key here is not anything we can do. It lies in NOT doing something. In particular, it lies in the realisation of absolutely no effort.

Not everything can be relinquished in this way of course, after all effort is natural – an essential part of maintaining a healthy life – so we only want to remove the unnecessary activity here. And this is where the fulfilment of need plays a crucial part. Need is the key. The role of all functioning in relation to need is the key, and that we can define such need clearly. What this allows us to do is the very thing which has been so elusive for so long – to effectively isolate the subversive agenda. This simple act sets a clear boundary, and also gives us direct power and leverage over the redundant activity of the subversive agenda using a tool that could not be easier to apply. Need is the purpose of the functioning we are seeking to restore to its natural state. This elementary fulfilment is the only demand here, and it is pretty simple. Everything else can be let go. What we actually need is virtually identical to what a chimpanzee needs.

Beyond that, everything else can be let go. All of it, without question. There is no need to consider or to question whatever arises. We are simply restoring one very basic tenet of integrity here. The ability to come full circle. All processes of active change management, all suspended or stalled processes of acquisition, all problem solving or planning activity of any kind – emotionally or mentally – can simply be relinquished and resolved back into the bliss of complete effortlessness. All effort.

Another way to view this is in terms of pure happiness or emotional fulfilment – and your own ability to realise such. Consider the typical person's situation. Of all the available potentials they face, which ones represent the greatest possibility for emotional gratification? Remember the connection between happiness and need fulfilment. Think about what they actually need, and how far past that point they generally are. Then think about the emotional potential that fulfilment represents, relative to the emotional cost of all the redundant activity which perpetually consumes their attention. Which of these is greater in terms of the emotional satisfaction it potentially represents? The attempted fulfilment of such redundant activity? Or the successful relinquishment of such? And which one costs less in terms of energy and effort? Which one can actually be fulfilled without harming the organism in the process?

The alternative this begins to present us with should not be understated. What people don't realise is just how much of this activity there really is, and therefore how big this is in its emotional significance. The negative tension such redundant activity represents overall far outweighs the positive potentials of seeking fulfilment for such – as if that fulfilment was even possible.

So if you divide all these possibilities into two main groups – those which involve the embrace or fulfilment of existing emotional products, and those which involve the strategic relinquishment of such, there is really no competition. By far the greatest achievement, by perhaps a factor of ten, is strategic non achievement. And I will explain below why, unlike the fulfilment of subversive drives, this only has to happen once. So this far greater emotional potential stands to be realised by merely consciously and deliberately orchestrating even a brief situation wherein you might safely, yet completely, let go of all effort or processes of seeking. To simply be still, if even just for a moment. Truly still.

But what I am not talking about is to merely calm the mind, this is far deeper than that. Indeed, it is possible to still the mind completely and yet not even touch the level of surrender we are talking about here. We are talking here about movement in the most primal and visceral sense, in the deepest possible sense - motive energy as it issues forth from the very wellspring of our being. And in particular we are talking about all of the half finished processes that were once begun but never finished, all of which contain degrees of latent activity and effort that now rest below the conscious level, like having hundreds of active windows open on your computer, behind the currently active window you are working on consciously.

All 'going' must stop, all 'doing' can end, as we once again resolve back into 'being'. It is certainly not just in your head, it is a whole body state, with much of this stuff being stored in your tissues, leaving us perpetually locked in overdrive. And, unlike the stopping of the mind, this particular type of primal reboot really only needs to occur once in order to break the cycle we have been indicating above.

This, then, is possibly the greatest of all achievements. And it is obviously somewhat paradoxical. Could the greatest achievement really be such a simple and complete non-achievement? The greatest or most successful or impressive of efforts, absolute and profound non-effort? The greatest of all creations, for even a single moment of time to be able to not-create anything? Of all the things you could ever do, or learn to do, or become a master

at doing, could the greatest one of all be not-doing? In this case, it could. Not even the most fantastic skill in art or music could rival this for significance, not even close.

Which is completely ridiculous. If that is true then it has always been right here in front of us. You can touch this right now. The river of attention is frantically searching for a deep and calm lake it recalls somewhere deep in its history, not realising that it need only stop to become that. The answer is right behind you, so close you can't see it. It is simply not in the direction of effort where we are accustomed to looking. It is in the direction of ease, bliss, surrender and release. Peace. It is totally simple, and you already know it. It is the bliss you would experience in deep sleep if only you were awake at the time, only this time it is found consciously. What we simply don't realise is how profoundly and deceptively deep it is in potential, and that it can be permanently realised.

The skill here then is a very special one, this ultimate art is a very special art. It is the one art that surpasses all others because it represents the one simple capacity which – as I will explain – serves to surmount our greatest of all afflictions. But regardless of the results of such, or the effects of such on the subversive agenda, the nature or essence of the art itself should never be forgotten, because it is easy for the busy mind to overlook.

It is singular and we already know it intimately. It is the space between the words, the silence between the notes. All the forms of activity it confronts are potentially limitless, but in the other direction they all resolve back to this same single point. There are a million mental 'somethings', but only one mental nothing. There are countless emotional efforts, but only one emotional effortlessness. There are endless possible actions, but only one possible inaction. All diversity when inverted converges upon this one singularity, if you could call it that. It is not really something at all, it is simply the absence of something. It is what is there before you put anything there. It is the most remarkably easy thing to find. But we don't ever find it just naturally because it feels bad in that direction, for reasons we can now see. A curious art, it could not be more simple, but in the context of the trap we are in it could also not be any more profound. And this is why the subversive agenda is so vast and complex, because this is the one thing it does not want us to find, and it really is so incredibly simple.

We are always already tending towards it. Everything about us was designed to find this point, and to retain it permanently. It is who we are. Which means now, in finally seeing through the veil, we have once again identified the true source of our power, and in doing so found our answer. The answer to the ultimate complexity, is the ultimate simplicity. I suppose there is a certain symmetry to it all.

So what does it take to not-do something? How much effort could non-effort really be? It sounds pretty easy! And it is easy. It is really, really easy. And this should never be forgotten as we discuss any degree of complexity about the effects of such, or just how difficult it can be to let go of our manic and habitual efforts.

It is really easy. It is so incredibly easy that when you do finally recover it you will be dismayed at how it could possibly have been so close all along.

We have our simple injunction, then – let everything go. With only one caveat – isolate and secure needs first.

The effect of this simple injunction is a kind of purge. It basically functions to secure everything valuable, and then flush everything else away in a single dump. It aims to restore the capacity of the organism to experience the basic fruits of appropriate labour, by eliminating erroneous activity which prevents such.

And the cost of such? What is the risk here? How dangerous could this be? I guess, given that you can always restore all these subjective efforts immediately if you don't like the outcome, that it can hardly be considered risky. In fact I suppose you could say that doing anything at all is always going to be more risky than doing nothing at all, provided your real needs are securely met at the time. So this is probably the safest and most benign thing you could do, or 'not-do' as the case may be.

Of all the things you could do, then, what is the greatest? Of all the skills you could ever develop, what is the one which towers above all the rest? Of all the arts, which is the highest? Or hey, let's get physical here...of all the things which make you attractive to the opposite sex, what would stand out as the ultimate recipe for magnificent and permanent irresistibility?

Something special? No. Nothing at all. The one thing most people can't ever do – Full Stop. The most creative ability of all – by far – is to be able to cease creating. Just once. Because you cannot do this. You cannot ever

simply stop in this way if the subversive agenda remains active and present. And if that remains then it will continue to define almost everything about you. So to be able to achieve this most simple feat, which even a cat can do, is – in the context of modern human life – a truly magnificent achievement.

There you go then. I could explain all the complicated reasons why this is the answer that it is, but do you really want to know? The answer is easy, because the problem is based in effort. The entire problem, the originating thought, the resulting emotional attachment and all the efforts of seeking which ensue, and all the forms of containment and subversive behaviour, are all efforts. They are all things we are not being, but rather things we are always doing. It is all in the software, not in the hardware. And because it all relates to no actual need, we can simply let it all fold.

The key to this injunction is that it is simple to understand, and certain in its effects. It is a means of gaining leverage over an otherwise endlessly complex and powerful event. If you only seek to remove evidence of the subversive agenda and restore ideal functioning – without this clear injunction – you will end up endlessly confused and distracted as you try to differentiate native from added, and as the subversive agenda responds in order to maintain control.

So what's missing here, then? Actually, yes, there is more. But not in essence. In essence that is it. All the rest is just mag wheels and pin stripes. Really, the danger in defining any further degree of efficiency is that the complexity of such might distract you from the essential simplicity of the final injunction. You really don't want to make simplicity too complex! But there is one thing you need to know about all this, and it is the one thing that nobody ever seems to have clearly grasped. It is also the one thing which solves more longstanding conundrums than any other single thing.

Obviously if all there was to it was that, we would have found it ages ago. But this does clarify the destination. It really is that simple. The art really is just that – one of resolving all activity and tension back into effortlessness and ease. A complete conscious purge of all active processes.

What makes this different to some kind of meditation is the context in which it is applied and to what end, and in that regard there really is one thing you have to take into account.

What are we missing here, then? Surely it is enough to finally have a clear and simple injunction, one which is easy to understand and to apply? But the injunction is merely a tool. It only defines a destination point, and a means of gaining leverage. It does not define the context fully, or even explain the results of successfully applying such. There are many things it does not explain, and this is because the purpose of the injunction is not to explain anything. It is simply a strategic manoeuvre. It only explains the 'what', not the 'how' or the 'why'. And without the how or the why this most simple of things is not actually possible. I mean – try it and you will see!

There is a deeper picture here that needs to be understood if we are going to truly grasp both the function of this injunction, and its significance in the context of the situation. After all, the application of this injunction is not the answer. It can't be. It is not itself what we are looking for, unless you happen to like doing absolutely nothing. It is not an end in itself, which is what meditation practitioners overlook.

So what is the real point of such an act, what is the target of such, the purpose? What are we aiming for really, when we apply such a tool? Surely this is the real thing to know?

We are seeking freedom from the emotional entrapment of the subversive agenda. Through the injunction we can strategically isolate and gain a degree of power over it. But to what end? Will this stop it? And even if it does, even if we gain freedom from it, how can we keep this freedom? What stops this entire event from just coming back again? Is this not just a crash diet? And will we not just get fat again before long?

This brings to the fore the crux of the entire issue. In applying any injunction we need to know the purpose of such, in the same way as a vehicle is only valuable if you know where you want to go. So where are we seeking to go here? What is the essential line we are seeking to cross, and how best is that defined? Because surely that is the real point. After all, if we know this point, it could be that we can find an even better method of achieving that end.

It is only once you have a clear grasp of this point that you can even begin to judge the worth of any injunction. We must remember the objective, what we are seeking to achieve. And whilst the injunction above offers us a clear point of leverage, it does not actually tell us this.

In particular it does not account for the most important thing to know about all of this, which is what we are seeking. In other words, how do you know when you have finished this? Is there an end to it, or is it like mowing a lawn? – you do it today, and then you have to do it again tomorrow? Forever?

In which case this sounds like meditation of some kind, but it is not. It is applied strategically with a very clear intention in mind, and with a very distinct purpose.

This is not meditation. It is deeper than that. It is primarily emotional. And it is profoundly simple and clear. What you do in this situation, provided need is securely fulfilled for the duration of the time allocated, is nothing. Nothing at all.

The difference between this and meditation is that this only has to happen just once, and never again. It is not considered a virtue in itself, as a distinct act, nor is it something to be valued as such. Nor should it be practised again and again. For that to occur would be to miss the whole point of it, which is not duration, but penetration.

The only point of such is that it addresses and targets an enormous body of dysfunction, and that it does this by applying leverage toward a known point of transition – a threshold. As fast as possible is probably best, beyond which point the injunction is not valuable. It is redundant as a permanent feature of the resulting state.

There are three things here – the injunction, the subversive agenda, and a threshold. And the latter two, as we will see, are the reason meditation is effectively useless - unless you happen to like meditating. Meditation empties the bucket of the mind. What we are discussing here is smashing the bottom out. The chances of typical meditation crossing this threshold are greater than not, but almost nil when you consider what such is up against. This is not a mental thing, as I say. What makes this different to meditation etc is the context in which it is applied. And the objective. The threshold indicated is an energetic and emotional one...and what that relates to directly is the direct removal of a massive and dynamic complex.

The search for an injunction is only half the battle here, then, the lesser half actually. The greater half is the search for an essential definition of what we are aiming for when we apply such. The target. The threshold we are seeking to cross. Or even whether such a threshold exists. There is basically something deeper here, and that is what represents a more vivid and clear thread from which to hang our understanding of all this.

So let's look at it a bit closer –

The injunction defines a transition from one point to another point. It defines a clear and simple journey from wherever you happen to be, back to a singular definable point.

So is that really all you need to know?

The key here is to be found in a very simple and most obvious fact – that we are not already doing this. We have to think about it, and consciously apply effort and intention in that direction. Which is a paradox. A conundrum actually. The injunction itself is an oxymoron. And if you unpack this even a little more, it reveals something that not only defines the final problem, but also the final answer. And that answer is something which also happens to explain more conundrums than anything else. It is truly the missing piece.

That missing piece is this: There is a point somewhere along the way to the final application of this simple injunction which defines final release from the entire subversive agenda. And that point is not best defined negatively – as the removal of something – but positively as the restoration of something. And the essential terms in which this must be grasped are not mental or even emotional. They are energetic.

The summary effect of the subversive agenda can best be defined in energetic terms, because energy is the ultimate point of integrity around which all functioning revolves. Which is what we saw in section 3. And now the same applies. It is the relationship of all functions to energy which defines the common state, because energy is the final and singular point of all integrity. And so it is the relationship of functioning to energy which must also define the free state. The negative effect of the common state is summarised in these terms, and so the

restoration of all this can also be defined in similar terms. That if the common state is a disturbance of energetic integrity, then the answer can only be the restoration of such.

This is what we are doing here, then. This is the outcome the injunction is seeking to achieve. Only this defines success, and therefore gives us our destination. But notice one very important thing here – this outcome and the ostensible target of the injunction are not actually the same. They are different, and defined in completely different terms.

So what is the relationship between these two things? If we examine it more closely we see that the restoration of energetic integrity is simply something that must occur before the injunction can be applied successfully, that this is the tooth the injunction must necessarily pull along the way. And this explains the art here – this is what the simple and easy injunction will inevitably confront and have to overcome. There is much more to simply relaxing all effort than meets the eye.

It would appear that even the most streamlined and effective application of the injunction is always going to be destined to confront a degree of tension as a result of this associated demand. And this is simply because we are taking out the garbage. It is a good thing to do, and it clears the house out, but getting your hands dirty is simply implied, as well as confronting the smells etc.

This is also by definition a massive process of change at the deepest levels. I mean, consider the scale of the subversive agenda, and the fact that restoration of energetic integrity implies its summary demise. And all organic structures abhor change, even positive change is resisted. So it would seem that a degree of tension is completely unavoidable. Which is exactly what is important to know, because this body of tension begins to explain both the crucial insight, as well as the final challenge. For it is actually this tension which defines the final transition to the free state, as well as the final obstacle to the achievement of such.

This is the real issue, the crucial consideration, the thing that everyone has overlooked. This is therefore what everything has been building up to. Understanding this is the point of all of it.

The thing to understand about the tension associated with the relinquishment of the subversive agenda, and all its associated activity, is that all emotional functioning operates on the basis of attraction and aversion. So as progress is made toward the relinquishment of all this redundant activity, the tensions associated will produce an emotional tendency to go back. It is that simple. And it takes effort and willpower to overcome an emotional tendency. Which in this context means we confront a strange situation: where a strategic endeavour committed to the relaxing of effort almost immediately – if it is to continue to make progress – produces the need for effort. And if that further effort is relaxed for even a moment then progress will be reversed as the dominant tendency to avoid free energy restores the equilibrium of the common state.

This is why truly stopping almost never works, even if you have a clear injunction to apply. But this is also exactly why it does work, in the few cases where this tension is somehow overcome. But the level of tension associated, and the fact that it is so rarely overcome, is what prevents us from ever realising that it is actually finite, and that beyond a certain point of progress this tension will begin to diminish. Or, more accurately, our intrinsic attraction toward free energy will increase as such is restored, and the elements of repression which free energy disturbs will become less and less, and at some point this balance will tip.

This tipping point is the key here. And it should be noted that this shift is not at the final point at which the injunction is executed, but at some earlier stage along the way there.

The important thing about this transition point, and the tension which defines it, is the effect it has on the dominant tendency of change – particularly as it relates to free energy. It is important to realise that as this point is crossed not all remnants of the subversive agenda have yet been removed, and therefore that such removal does not in itself define this shift.

The shift is simply and only and exclusively related to the dominant tendency of all functioning as it relates to free energy and attention. It is simply that at every stage prior to this point the dominant tendency of emotional functioning is to support activity which moves away from free energy and attention (feeling), but beyond this point a balance is tipped, and energetic integrity is essentially restored. And I say essentially because this is not absolutely. There is still a long way to go to remove all the residual elements of this massive complex, but beyond this point the maintenance of progress toward that end then becomes the dominant tendency. Things are

still tense, which up until this point has been felt to be the direct result of the progress toward the injunction's destination state, but the resolution of such tension is now suddenly felt to be in exactly that direction.

So the process itself does not change at this point. What changes is that there is no longer any necessity for willpower. Beyond this point you would need to apply willpower in order to go back. What was difficult becomes effortless, and so beyond this point, either slowly or rapidly, the rest is history.

So this point is the point. This threshold is the actual purpose of applying the clear injunction. Understanding this point, and what defines it, is the essence of this entire work. All the complexity of both agendas, at the deepest level, can finally be summed up in the simple model this injunction brings to light.

To see how this point of tension is experienced we can turn back to the injunction for a moment, and the complete cultural blindness we suffer from in relation to the potential it represents –

The underlying thing which prevents people from seeing this whole possibility is that they do not have any way to understand just how much of what they are doing is unnecessary, or that it could possibly all be connected or singular in some sense. They have always been doing it, so they have nothing to contrast that with. It seems completely normal to be so obsessively active.

It is of course the scale and singularity of the negativity which gives it its power. But this is also what exactly defines the positive potential here, because it is the ultimate singularity which is also potentially the source of its final undoing.

When you examine the injunction, then, it is the dynamic singularity of the subversive activity which represents the substance of this art. To singularly collapse all active processes back to nothing is not as simple as it sounds. It requires insight, and strategy. The destination point is simple, but from the point of conscious willpower the activity itself can actually only be collapsed in a certain way if such is to be successful. The anatomy of such activity must be accounted for, as well as its nature and origins, and the fact the consciousness is itself subject to the forces such represents. It is not in a position of great power when it comes to all this, and so it must use intelligence instead. Brute force would probably work, but it is definitely the lesser of two options.

In the end insight must overcome this - it must be recognised that the activity you are confronting is at first only going to be a surface manifestation of something much deeper, and that as you relinquish this surface level that this deeper event will eventually emerge in its raw form. The surface level is made up of layers of automatically loaded tendency and drive toward containment and avoidance of the deeper event, and so the surface level can look like all manner of things, any number of turbulent desires or aversions.

It is all automatic, that's the point. But as these layers are confronted and relaxed more will arise to take their place. And as this continues they will get stronger and stronger. And in this escalating effect we find the tension which defines the final transition. The answer to this activity, however, is always the same. There is no need to think about whatever arises. It all goes on the fire, because you have established the foundational context which defines it all as necessarily dysfunctional. No matter what you confront, you relate to it equally. This is the ultimate and practical power of the injunction outlined.

Eventually then, as you resolve these processes back, you will begin to see their real form. They are all suspended processes of creation, of one sort or another. All activity in this situation is the same. They are either processes of active creation or change management, or they are the results of seeking to contain the emotional results of the lack of fulfilment of such. So in this case the surface layers of this great mass of unresolved activity will begin to peel away and resolve back into free energy (feeling) and as a result immediately begin to restore the processes beneath. Which in this case is a simmering existential crisis.

So what prevents this crisis from reanimating and once again raging out of control? Nothing. This is precisely what will happen if you do this. We are peeling the onion here, layer by layer, exposing the art which the simple injunction defines. And here we see another final level of insight.

Consider the final cause of all this activity and pain. So if you were able to get right back through all that, what would be the final thought – the final effort – you would let go of?

“I”

The little spark that started this great fire is just an idea, it is another thought. It is something we – as the body – are doing, not something we are ever actually being. And sooner or later we can all realise just how deeply its presence as a sustained belief afflicts us.

I will never be happy.

This sounds like a negative affirmation, something a pessimist might repeat over breakfast. But it is simply a statement of fact. “I” is, in fact, an illusion. And its presence in the context of human life is a recipe for great suffering.

And who suffers? “I do” of course. But actually there is no “I”. Only the body suffers.

So what would happen if “I” wasn’t there anymore? Probably not much, considering “I” is not actually there now. “I” is a nightmare fantasy. What if it simply disappeared or broke? Would the entire subversive agenda gradually just dissipate? Yes, probably, over time anyway.

Which is all a bit strange of course, but hopefully you will bear with me. I am going to talk to your body for a moment –

Breathe. Feel. Hello, welcome. Consider for a moment that you are, with a particular subtle effort, creating the idea you call “I”. It is a habit you may not even be aware of, because you have been doing it so long. But try something, just once. For a moment, just relax this effort. Notice it, find it, and gently relax it. Take a breath. Let the river of attention become a lake. Let thinking become feeling again.

How do you feel.? Tell me, does that not feel better?

I is just an idea.

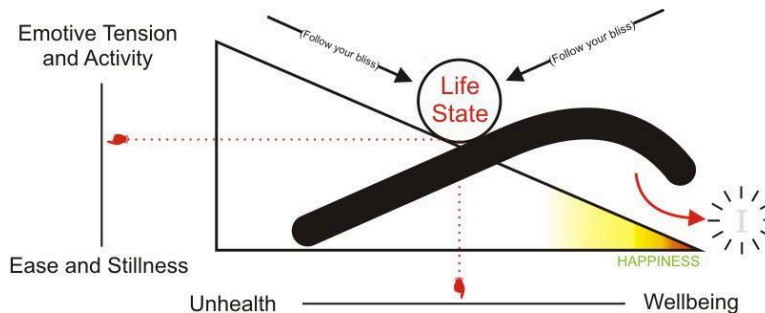
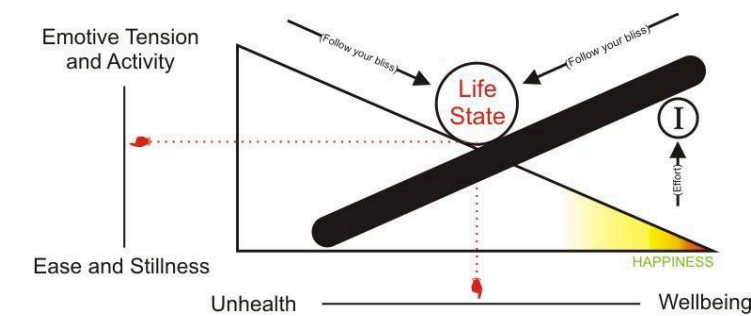
“I” cannot be happy. Relax “I” and you will find that happiness is already existing. But the result of any momentary absence of this idea, however, is the immediate relinquishment of all processes presently being generated on the basis of “I” being a felt reality with a future to protect. Which is most of what is occurring. An entire lifetime of work and ongoing creation suddenly becomes moot.

What this means is that much core emotional activity begins to unravel the moment “I” is relinquished. And the result, almost immediately, is free energy. Which is obviously an immediate and strong provocation of the subversive agenda, which then stimulates activity to control such. Thinking is the result. And you can imagine what the first thought is going to be.

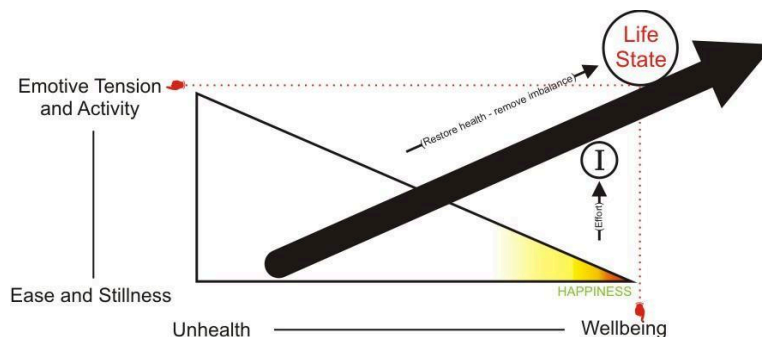
All this might seem convoluted but it is really just an explanation of something you can experience at any moment. It is simply what’s going on beneath your own experience right now.

It is a reflex. Knocking down “I” produces a very short term effect of free energy, which is immediately responded to and controlled by the pure momentum of the incumbent complex. The result is effort, and the immediate production of thought, and the first in line is generally – “I”.

If we look at all this in graphic form we can see that in addressing this identity confusion, which is the origin of the entire problem, we see that even if we remove “I” there is still not much resulting pressure to confront the functional momentum of the subversive agenda. The removal of the cause does not seriously affect the habitual symptom, and it is the symptom that we suffer from. It is all self generating on the basis of habit and routine in relation to the presence of free energy and attention. So even if you kill the general, the army keeps on fighting because there is nobody left to tell them to stop.



Conversely then, we also saw what happens if we take the other approach – Relaxing symptomatic activity in general eventually produces more and more tension as the underlying crisis threatens to reawaken. Once again if we look at all this in graphic form we can see that addressing the surface level symptoms of all this, without addressing or removing the cause, has the eventual result of producing potentially limitless tension as the underlying crisis threatens to awaken.



Neither of these things works. Inactivity thus produces activity. Non-effort produces immediate and powerful effort. Ease immediately produces dis-ease. Even the simple injunction doesn't work.

This is the common state.

We are simply refining the problem here, boiling it down. Is there not an obvious solution here, then? What might the subversive agenda be desperately seeking to prevent us from seeing here? What might we never simply intuit or stumble upon?

What if you did both of these things together, within the clear framework defined by the injunction? What if you set out to relax all activity with the full knowledge of what you would likely confront as you did, and at the same time strategically isolated and targeted "I" for special attention during this process? What would happen then?

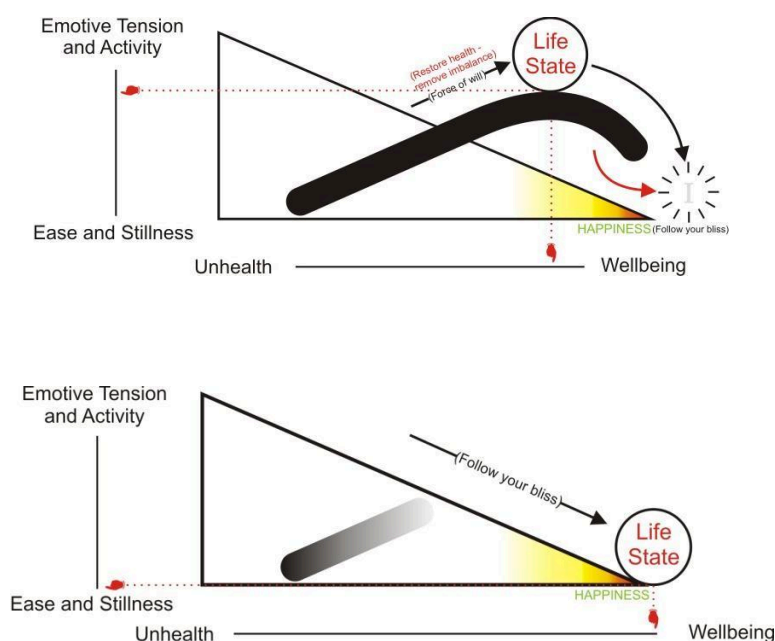
What would happen is that you would not feel too good. Every bone in your body would tell you that this was wrong. A lifetime of deeply rooted emotional habit would be confronted in absolute terms, head on. The wave of

free energy and attention (feeling) that this produced would cause an immediate and powerful reaction in your own emotional core as it spontaneously restored functioning, and you would confront an immediate and almost irresistibly strong tendency to move away from such. If you persisted however, you would soon enter a stage where this free energy was unravelling and resolving all this activity at the surface levels and beginning to penetrate the deeper substance of it all. And at every point you would be passing big and hastily erected signs which say “here be beasties” and “do not pass this way”. All written in blood, and in handwriting you recognise as your own as a child.

Effortlessness and feeling would increase exponentially as this process unfolded, but the bliss of such would be marred by the screaming of sirens and warning bells, and the resulting ‘counter-efforts’ all this would require. Because, even though this is completely safe, never before had the recovery of such degrees of feeling not resulted in great suffering. But this time things are different. This time you have walked back into this burning house with a fire extinguisher in your hand. You are now aware of the nature of all this activity, and its history and origin. And you also have that originating factor under control.

Nevertheless you are confronting great fear, if only as residual processes of historical fear are being thawed out and released. Effortlessness is certainly not yet easy. But with every inch of progress toward the final clearing of all these decks you are eliminating the foundations of active resistance to the presence of free energy and attention (feeling), and you are doing this with nothing less than free energy and attention itself. And at some point we transit across a threshold, a tipping point, and everything releases.

If we look at all this in graphic form we can see the nature of this point as it relates to emotional tendency.



If you look at this on a graph you see the ball and hump, and then the return to the native state as the subversive agenda resolves completely over time. The shape of the initial hump encountered represents the natural tendency of consciousness at any given point, and the level of tension associated. And the crucial thing about all this is that it is by far the most important thing to know about the most important thing there is to know. The answer lies in the one place we have spent our entire lives trying to avoid.

Nobody accounts for the reality of this when considering our situation. Which is because it is not possible to bring this to light without first having the injunction, and the injunction is not possible without the basic understanding of the two agendas in the background. And this is why so many teachings are almost completely ineffectual. This is why ‘just letting go’ does not actually work, even though it was probably exactly what led to the ‘realisation’ of the person suggesting it as a method. At the time, even though they didn’t realise it, they were already over this threshold and therefore already in the native state. Basically, by the time they ‘let go’, it was already done, which makes such advice completely worthless in practical terms. Even worse than that, it is damaging in that it distracts attention from the real issue, and wastes time and effort.

To simply let go, then, at the top of this hill, is to roll freely. It is to experience a profound sense of ease and release, and this is often associated with reports of sudden awakening. But notice here also that what really defines this shift is the direction it tends to roll, not the point itself. It should also be noticed that it is equally possible to climb all that way and then roll straight back into the bowl.

This is ‘false realisation’, and it is far more common. A great many so-called spiritual teachers exhibit characteristics of exactly this having occurred. Many of the characteristics are the same, it is a real experience of release and liberation in a sense, but the end result is not one to envy. There is one crucial thing missing in that case, the only thing that matters. They rolled the wrong way. Which is a shame, because they may even have come within an inch of that potential, and may therefore even know quite a lot about what that requires. Yet they cannot claim the realisation they claim to offer.

So what defines this realisation, then? What is the essential defining property of the second or native state, the second equilibrium? It is simple – crossing that threshold represents the restoration of energetic integrity.

It is defined, in particular, by the restoration of the dominant tendency of conscious awareness toward free energy and attention. And perhaps just as importantly – it is not defined by any particular degree of healthy functioning, or any particular state of mind or emotion. It is a shift in the locus of a person’s basic functional equilibrium, which affects nothing in particular, but everything in general. And the reason it is stable and equilibrating is that beyond that point further progress toward the restoration of ideal functioning becomes both increasingly effortless and blissful at the same time.

This is not a shift in perception, then. Intellectual consideration of all this makes almost no difference to it. What we suffer from is not an intellectual or even a spiritual problem. It is a deeply rooted energetic dysfunction, and it can only be moved by equal or greater energetic force.

So in our search for what it is that finally defines release from the entire mess we are in we can take many perspectives, but only one captures what this really is, only one captures its essence – this shift is **energetic**. Not perceptual, not intellectual, and certainly not spiritual. It is a structural reality. Like consciousness it is a summary event, the product of countless functions all working together. And like consciousness it will not be able to be found, it will not have any fixed location, but the overall effect will still be able to be observed.

People in this state will – I believe – be able to be proven to be very different to people in the common state, if not in particular then certainly in general. The statistical conglomerate will be overwhelming. So it may have many resulting effects emotionally and psychologically, but in the end it is simply and only defined by the balance between your conscious or behavioural resistance to – or attraction toward – free energy. In particular, toward free energy and attention at a conscious level – what we generally call ‘feeling’.

This is the defining difference between homo sapiens and homo libera, so if the latter is what you are seeking to return back to then it may certainly be worth understanding a little of what you are likely to confront as you make that transition.

True North

In order to further demonstrate the scale and permanence of what this all indicates, I will convert the overall dynamics involved into another simple graphic form, one which broadly indicates the total territory of possibility being discussed, and the overall significance of what this potential represents.

Like the two trees metaphor, this is a model you will find repeated throughout my works as a foundation for other discussions, if only because it captures several dynamic relationships in a way most people can understand and articulate.

Imagine this –

You are sailing along in a little boat, and in this metaphor let’s say the destination is True North (the actual conditions of happiness). You might also imagine that the weather is better the further north you get, and that it is plainer sailing there.

So off you go: over time you learn to sail and you are making your way toward a better and more fulfilled state. This is life. The wind does not always blow the way you want, but if you follow your compass you can feel assured that even difficult progress is at least in the right direction. Your heart is the compass in this case, with what you feel emotionally ideally representing what you need physically.

There is a fundamental alignment here, one that has been forged by evolution over vast expanses of time. If natural emotional tendency did not equate to optimum need fulfilment, you would already be extinct.

Then imagine this – by chance you sail past a small and barren magnetic rock. The seas are rough all around it, the rocks are jagged and sharp, the waves are high, and there is nowhere to land – so if you get too close you will be smashed up and sink.

Nevertheless, the local magnetic pull captures your compass, and you become disoriented.

What happens next? Of course, in all likelihood, you may not even realise this has happened. So you follow your compass, because that is what it is for, and in doing so you begin to head straight for this barren little rock.

You are now trapped in a sense. The pull of this event has generated a breach somehow, and distortion of integrity between where you really want to go, and where you feel like going. So you are caught between suffering the stress of not moving towards the actual physical conditions of optimum happiness, and moving towards stressful emotional states.

So what can you do?

It is a single event that can have a thousand different symptoms. One day you will be sailing the right way, and the next day you will be going mysteriously back the other way. It is a dynamic and perplexing state, and you might end up circling this barren rock forever, dazed and confused. You can either sail fast or slow, big circles or small ones, you can smash straight up on the rocks with all your might in direct submission to your compass, or you can just sit there anchored in the thrashing waves. And none of these options results in happiness.

Likewise you can join together with others in this state, but they are just as confused as you are. And there are many and varied approaches as just indicated. A true point of common unity remains elusive in this state, and the best you can generally do is make the best of things as you basically suffer together.

What is the obvious answer here? What would you do in this situation?

First of all you would need someone to tell you what has happened. But presuming this primary insight has been offered, and that light bulb has gone on, what might you then immediately surmise as the obvious solution to this particular dilemma?

You would simply sail away, right? But in which direction? How could you then tell which way was true north???

Once again, you might need some insight here, you might need for someone to show you how to navigate by the stars for instance, or some other way than by simply looking at your trusty but confused compass.

Let's say you managed to deduce the correct direction, then. What would happen as you set sail on that course? You would get closer and closer every day to the actual conditions for happiness, yes? Yes. But what would you feel? You would feel like you were getting further and further away. It would feel completely wrong. Your compass needle would be pointing directly backwards toward the rock you were finally leaving behind, and so you might be tempted to relent and give in and sail back there again. But if you kept going, and going, and going, what would happen? The weather would get better of course, but what else would happen?

Sooner or later you would reach a point where the local effect of the magnetic rock began to diminish, and your natural pull of true north once again became more, and then equal, and then dominant once again.

So what would this feel like? In some ways it might be extremely disorienting! Your compass needle might spin around wildly and go all over the place, at one moment it might be pointing one way, then in the next it might be

pointing the other. But sooner or later, if you persisted, it would once again stabilise and fixate accurately once again on your true and natural destination.

This very simple picture tells us many things about the process by which you might restore energetic integrity to a dynamic system. One of the most important things it shows us, so clearly, is how the very same structure (in this case your heart – the compass in the metaphor) can experience two completely different states depending on where it is in relation to these two ‘magnetic sources’. And it also tells us that there is a defining boundary or threshold these two sources themselves define. There is a point of balance between them somewhere, and once that point is crossed no more effort is required to counter the opposing tendency of the compass. At all points prior to that threshold the compass points directly backwards. At all points past that threshold it points forward.

The same compass does this.

This singular model solves more longstanding conundrums than any other I have ever come across.

What might already be obvious here is that you would never find this possibility by simply ‘following what you feel’. There is a kind of paradox associated with the process of recovery here.

The ultimate idea is to follow what you feel, and the underlying realisation is that the compass is not the problem. The implication is that what you feel is correct, and that it can in fact be entirely trusted, but also that in the short term – in order to once again restore that integrity – you must necessarily act in direct and radical opposition to it. It is like lancing a boil, you don’t do it for the pain, you do it to stop the pain, but it is unavoidably painful in the process.

This is why those very rare people who have found this enigmatic state always say that the ultimate answer was to ‘simply let go’. But what they universally fail to see, because they have no possible way to define such, is that when they did that they were already on the other side of this critical threshold, and that ‘simply letting go’ was almost certainly not what got them there. Which makes that kind of blanket injunction completely worthless and ultimately ignorant, however well meaning. For the common person ‘just letting go’ is the origin of their cycle of pain, not the solution to it.

Another thing that this picture allows us to see is the otherwise invisible context of your situation. The native integrity (true north) is far greater than the local effect of the small rock. But if you never ventured far enough to experience that, you may never even know this. All you would know is the local distorted reality, and your entire value system might come to reflect that, in contrast to native human values. You would not have any way to tell in which direction true human integrity lay. It would be impossible to figure out by following the only compass you have.

The very simple but incredibly deep implication of there being two stable equilibriums is that almost everything we take for granted about what we know regarding humanity and what is ‘normal’ and ‘natural’ and ‘correct’ becomes void, or at the very least made only partial.

If this is correct, then there are in fact two. There are two completely different versions of humanity. There are two different worlds as a result, in potential at least.

I don’t think anyone ever really gets what this means at first, and how many longstanding arguments this fundamentally resolves. This is the answer to the answer. And the most interesting thing about this is that both sides of almost all arguments regarding humanity turn out to be correct – both, but only in a very qualified sense.

For instance, consider the age-old argument over the value of desire in particular: should we follow it or not, should we follow what we feel and express emotions fully and allow our deepest passions to define our lives?

Buddhism says attachment is the root of all suffering, and desire is attachment. On the other hand we hear motivational speakers everywhere shouting out – “do your dream, fulfil your deepest desires!”

So who is right?

Just look at the model above. It is obvious. Desire is the direction the compass tends to point from any particular position. So should you follow it? Is it trustworthy? Is it valuable? The answer to this is clearly different

depending on where you are. In the common state, circling the rock, no – in the free native state, yes. But precisely because those in the common state don't know they are trapped, they tend to trust what they feel, and therefore never find release from its vicious trapping cycle. Whereas those with greater awareness and understanding confront a deeper appreciation of the situation: that true happiness necessarily involves a right of passage – that it only exists on the other side of that wall of turbulent confusion and emotional stress, in the free native state. A deeper commitment to trusting what you feel, and to following it, and asserting that it is in fact correct to do so, leads directly to a realisation that the exact opposite may – at least temporarily – sometimes be required, possibly even to a very significant degree if the gains are large.

Hopefully this model offers a little more clarity of the underlying dynamics we are confronting, and what some of the most significant potentials might demand.

Conscious experience –

We are following a chain of events here then, back toward a final definition of where we are getting stuck, or what ultimately defines release from this dilemma. And the relationship of consciousness here is, in this sense, also important to clarify. Whilst it is essentially a far deeper balance that shifts, it is the way this is experienced consciously that makes all the difference. This determines everything actually, because in the end it is ultimately how these underlying tensions affect conscious experience which defines behaviour. Both the negativity confronted, and the positivity it belies, are summarised in our conscious experience. And whether we go back or forward at any point is not determined by underlying tensions, but by conscious desire or aversion, and also by the power of will. So if we are searching for a final point of leverage, then we should take a look at all this from that point of view for a moment.

The way we consciously experience the tension associated with this transition is first of all as strong aversion or desire. Compulsions and agitations. Then the gradual swelling of a nebulous and formless dread, a faceless sense of disquiet as the existential crisis threatens to awaken.

This is basically everything you avoid in life, all at once. It feels like loss, and pain, and cold emptiness. There is anguish and an overwhelming but nonspecific disquiet. You never actually get to experience the underlying crisis directly, because your own system has experienced that before and will not allow it. But the active relinquishment of "I" makes that crisis redundant. You do however get to experience all the habitual remnants of such, to take out this garbage with your emotional bare hands.

In the spiritual traditions they call this the 'dark night of the soul'. Also ironic perhaps, considering the whole idea that there is a 'soul' is the very delusion this process awakens us from. But it is only natural that we would confront a degree of tension here, even in the absence of any potential crisis.

The subversive activity is not bad. Like the sprinkler system in a building it is a valuable asset. But it can also be seen as extremely negative if it goes off when there is in fact no fire.

Consciousness is like the occupant of this house. The building is like the total available space, and your available access to the rooms inside are what we might call 'feeling' let's say. In this situation, because the sprinkler system went off, the whole house was evacuated. People are huddled in the cold outside waiting for the engines to come, but they never do. But they would be too scared to go back in because of the sirens, even if it wasn't wet. They do not even know what it means to have a dry house, and to be able to go anywhere with safety and comfort – to feel freely. So even if they are told that there is no fire, they still face a somewhat uncomfortable prospect – that of seeking to somehow find the source of the confusion and maybe figure out a way to turn the sprinklers off. Which may not mean getting burned, but will likely at least inevitably mean getting somewhat wet.

The gains associated with such are obvious, however. They will get their house back. The only thing that is missing here is information, then. The only reason people are not stomping back into their emotional houses with umbrellas up and gumboots on is that they have not been made aware of the nature of the situation – that there is actually no fire, and therefore nothing to fear. But even when they are made aware of such there is an uncomfortable process to confront. And all this is the final obstacle we must overcome if we are to restore ourselves to a free state. Our aversion to this must always be outweighed by our attraction to the resulting state, or progress will simply be reversed.

At the other end then, what is the positive balance? What makes passing through this wall of tension worth it?

It really could not be much more positive at that end. The only thing which prevents us from charging headlong at this tension is the fact that we have never had the opportunity to see just how much greener the grass really is on the other side. Every ounce of attachment that once made up the entire existential quest, and all the containment of such as manifest in the subversive agenda, are in this act unified in a single love connection to the ultimate source of all fulfilment for “I”.

Wow that’s a mouth full! But it is simple – “I” does not exist, it never did. It was always only an activity of mind. So if thinking stops, if it is all relaxed, then what is there? Just the body, just what there always was. And so – it is the body that has this realisation, not the mind.

The ultimate source of fulfilment for all this activity is finally found to be nothing at all. The entire activity is born out of nothing at all, and so seeking to fulfil it is an obvious recipe for waste and endless frustration.

So what does all of the emotional activity associated with the entire negative agenda want? What is it looking for?

This is the one thing this activity itself cannot naturally understand. But you only have to ask yourself what needs it is fulfilling, what those needs actually amount to. Nothing. Nothing at all. This is, actually, what it is all seeking, then, which is why this is the destination of the injunction, and of the ultimate art associated. The entire event is simply let go, it collapses and is resolved back to its actual substance, which is nothing at all. A magical disappearing act.

The emotional component is real, however, as it always had been, and because of the deciding position of consciousness in this picture we must examine how this is all consciously experienced. There is a great deal of tension leading up to the point of transition, and that does not immediately resolve as we pass the threshold.

From a conscious perspective, however, in the free state the true jackpot is finally felt to be hit, as the sum of all addictions and existential yearnings converges on a single point of fulfilment which cannot ever be lost, and which - as it is pursued - costs less and less, and eventually costs nothing at all.

Of course this is all being viewed backwards, nothing is actually acquired here, but the emotional experience is of a positive acquisition directly proportional to the degree of emotional negativity experienced in the common state as a result of the entire crisis and containment put together.

Attachment cannot simply be ignored, that is repression. It must be moved. And in this case it is moved to a source of fulfilment which offers everything and costs nothing. The result is immense attachment. So as free energy and attention finally converges on the destination point as defined by the injunction, it recognises itself in the mirror pool at the base of all subjective activity. Free energy and attention – feeling itself – is identical to effortlessness, ease and non-effort. They are the same. And at some point there is a balance that tips, as feeling finally goes home to effortlessness, and finds bliss to be its own very nature.

Not immediately, but increasingly, and automatically from this point onward, effortlessness then becomes more and more effortless, and eventually unravels completely. It’s like falling in love, but much bigger. It is better than sex. It is the summary fulfilment of a yearning that is so bottomless we were never even really able to plumb its depths. And with this our conscious experience has come home completely, and for free. The only cost was trudging through the mire to get there.

This is not just a perceptual shift, then. The thing which is worth recognising is that this singular point of ultimate and free radiance and love is identical to – and the substance of – all organic integrity and health. Because, for any organic system - which functions around free energy as its highest positive axiom - to have its tendency toward such balance restored is the final answer. It is to recover the organism’s golden autopilot, to restore the sacred compass of the heart. What feels good and what is good for you are suddenly and radically restored to alignment.

What happens to “I” in this situation? How will we live without it?

We already do, that is the problem. Even when the body believes such, it never actually becomes real as a result. The imagined presence of “I” created a situation in which our energetic integrity was so damaged that the constant application of will had to be applied in order to maintain a degree of stability. “I” became essential as a direct result of the imagined presence of this imaginary entity. But with this idea out of the picture that integrity is restored, and the body itself takes over again. The body, freed of this blinding assault, already knows its way home. The only thing that needed to happen was for this point of integrity to be restored, and for this primal ‘love bond’ between effortlessness and feeling to be returned.

So the injunction is only half of the picture. Without some understanding of this peak of tension and the threshold it produces you actually have no way to begin to grasp where you are going or what you will likely confront along the way. The injunction is simply a tool, then, a vehicle. So to prepare it accordingly you first need to know where you are going, and what kind of terrain you are going to encounter. It is A to B, via C. The common state to the native state via the application of the injunction. In particular via the insightful application of the injunction.

How do you keep it then, once you have found this? You don’t have any choice. It is held in place by pure attraction. You don’t just do this once, it is not just somewhere you visit. You move in.

The potential others might be seeking to get as they apply the simple injunction becomes effortlessly possible for you once you reach it, as a permanent feature of your ordinary state. It is everything you ever wanted, and it is free. The only reason you don’t do this right now is that you have never done it before, and therefore don’t even know it’s possible. But once you do, you know two things – there is nothing to be afraid of, and there is everything to gain.

All of which leaves us where? Is this a usable process? Actually, it is. If you do this, if you apply this injunction simply as it is outlined there, there is a 100% success rate. It really is that simple.

What we have been delivered here, by following the logic trail this basic view generates, is the missing piece to this puzzle. The key is that there is a peak of tension to be overcome in such a case, and that this tension is what actually defines both the final threshold we are seeking to cross, as well as what prevents us from doing so – the final obstacle to such. And that only equal or greater tension will ever overcome that peak of tension.

The injunction alone does not take this into account, nor does it provide any method of adjusting this equation. It does not take into account that whilst the permanent positive emotional results of passing through this tension may far outweigh the temporary negative transition itself, that we have no way of directly ascertaining this. So whilst there may be ample motivational potential present in this situation, it is all locked away in the one place we cannot get to. Catch 22. So we actually have no way to know for sure whether the cost of overcoming such tension is worth it without first paying that price, so we have no way of supporting the emotional leverage required to overcome such. It is an impasse.

The other thing this shows us is that in approaching this threshold we must take care to eliminate the originating spark of the underlying crisis. Because to not do so, or to simply do all this without awareness of such, is a potential recipe for quite serious trouble.

If there is one key to all this, it is - do not play around in this tense zone. Do not go there unless you plan to go through it, because it is not fun. Like jumping an ice crevice it is easy if you commit yourself, but a half measure will not be half as much fun. The injunction defines the simple destination point, which must be sought without reservation.

This peak of tension, and the threshold it defines, is both the answer and the problem. It is everything you need to know, and without it you effectively know nothing about this process. And as it relates to the successful application of the injunction it is simple – successful transition up to or beyond this point of negative tension necessitates the presence of equal or greater positive force, or progress will stall and be immediately reversed. This is the exact equation which defines success in the transition from the common state to the free native state.

We are now in a position to finally answer the questions: Follow what we feel? Embrace desire without reservation?

So what is the verdict? The final answer – No, and yes. If you follow what you feel without reservation in the common state, you will suffer. But perhaps not very consoling is the fact that if you do not follow your feelings without reservation, you will also suffer. Such is the common state. Leaving the only other option a little more sophisticated, but still quite simple if you examine it in essence. And that is to acknowledge the heart as the correct and ultimate arbiter of happiness. But also that the heart has been conflicted. So we first affirm and validate the fact that we should follow what we feel, then completely ignore such as we strategically act in direct opposition to what we feel.

Therefore, we need to very strongly oppose what we feel, but not so as to abandon the heart, it is to finally restore it to its rightful place. At which point you can trust it once again, and can then follow it as you continue upon the journey of your life. It is bitter medicine, but it is also a singular one-time cure.

We can now see that all the confusion around trusting our feelings is the result of there actually being two distinct states of being for every human. The implications of which are so great in their gravity that most people have difficulty embracing them. And the essential factors which define these two states do not come into view unless you first have the hump of tension as a framework of reference, which in turn requires the injunction or something similar, which in turn requires the entire backdrop of the common state as defined above.

The result of not having these foundational frameworks in the background is that a secure grasp of the nature of our situation is not possible. In particular it is not possible to see that there are two distinct states here, which in turn results in a profound confusion about the nature of this possibility which expresses itself as a great many erroneous conceptions. Chiefly, it results in one main theoretical impasse – commonly expressed as a paradox, and we should briefly address that here.

This paradox is summed up in the teachings of many of the most revered spiritual traditions as something like this – “You can’t get there from here”, “There is no problem”, “There is nothing to get”, “What you are looking for is always already the case”.

These and many other so-called “non-dual” paradoxes are not paradoxes at all, they are simply a lack of knowledge. This is the highest expression of the great fallacy, a direct result of not being able to functionally differentiate the two agendas. You simply cannot explain the state which results from the removal of the subversive agenda if you do not have the means by which to explain that agenda in all its complexity and grandeur. The simplicity is defined by the absence of the complexity. Which means the one thing that people need to know about in order to realise this simplicity is the very thing those who have realised it do not have to offer.

Such people are in fact the least qualified of all to offer such insight, unless they have a very good memory. So whilst they do serve as extremely valuable validation that there is ‘something’ there to get, or a better state to find, they almost universally produce no similar experience in those who follow them. And this is because they do not have the crucial part. They have got the whole thing exactly upside down.

So the summary teaching of so many who have managed to relinquish this complex is simply to – “let go”, to relax in essence, and to simply trust existence. They keep saying there is nothing to get, and nowhere to go. That you are already there. But the very fact that they are saying this implies duality, and that to know this is better than to not know it, and that there is therefore something to get, or somewhere else to be than in your previously ignorant state.

It is frustrating and slippery language which they pass off as ‘spiritual paradox’, but it is in fact just a failure to penetrate the nature of what they are discussing in the most appropriate terms. Which they cannot be blamed for of course, such understanding has not been available up to this point.

You can also see that from a certain perspective what they are saying is obviously true in this case, when you look at the actuality of the situation. But this is not a paradox.

Is it true that there is nothing to get? Yes. You lose something. Is it true that there is no problem with existence? Yes. The entire event you suffer from is ultimately based in imagination and illusion. Is it true that we will never get any closer to ‘god’ than we are right now? Yes. This is it, this is actually all you get.

Which all sounds great, until you realise that you remain sitting here securely unhappy.

So how can we understand this? It is simple. There is nothing to get, it is true. But just so we're clear – the particular nothing in question is quite specific and very real. This particular nothing is the absence of a very particular something. And this something is huge, it has a particular very defined origin and form and nature, and it will certainly not simply disappear on its own.

So what about there being no problem with life, and with existence as a whole? Is that really true? Yes. So why don't we feel that? It is because we do not experience life based upon reality. We manufacture most of what we relate to as reality, using our feeble little minds. And there is a very serious problem with our own mixed up supplementation of reality in this instance. There are two realities for us, fused together as one, and one of them is not real at all, but we experience it as real. And so whilst there may be no problem with the actual reality of our situation, there is most certainly a very big problem with the way we imagine that to be, and we most certainly suffer as a result of that muddled perception - and that suffering is completely real.

What we see here then is that – with the application of the injunction – all we are trying to do here is align our own fabrication of reality with the actuality of reality. We are simply not experiencing life as it really is – we are overlaying life with an imaginary and erroneous context and then experiencing great fear as a result of something which is not actually real. But, and here is my point - the fear is real. The very fact that we are able to experience emotional reactions to mere thoughts is what offers such imaginary constructs the power to have impacts on the real world.

There is most definitely a problem. So we then try our best to never feel this fear. Which is generally quite successful, but also very costly. And that cost is experienced as a degree of tension or a lack of vitality or some other form of what might be called 'unhappiness'. This unhappiness is real, and if you want to try to remove it there is really no way to do that if you do not account for the very dramatic and sophisticated processes that produce it, and how they work. To not do so in this context is simple minded idiocy. To talk about the resulting state without offering this complexity as a backdrop is to have people recognise and desire what you are pointing at, but have absolutely no way to get there. It is a paramount lesson in frustration. You are better off leaving them in peace in that case.

So when self appointed 'spiritual masters' say there is no problem are they correct? Yes, they are entirely correct. But is that teaching of any use whatsoever in resolving the dilemma we are facing? No, it is absolutely useless. As a mode of instruction it is the height of foolishness.

The crucial thing to understand about all this is that we are actually looking at two things, not one. The apparent paradoxes which abound in this territory are almost all the result of this central confusion. And the resolution to all this confusion is this – there are two stable functional equilibriums for every human being, not one.

What does this mean? It means that because it is possible to remove this secondary activity in its entirety, in doing so you produce an entirely different person to the one which previously contained all this conflict and struggle. And that person has a completely different energetic state. Their entire body of functioning revolves and is centred around a completely different focal point or locus. So that when you say – what does it mean to be human? What defines normal human behaviour, or consumption, or longevity, or values, or health, or moral development, or sexuality etc... you actually have to ask this first – which one? Which kind of human are you talking about? Because for every individual, there are in fact two.

So apart from providing us with the final definition of the threshold we are seeking to transit, we now have the foundations which enable us to differentiate these two different states.

The amount of persistent conundrums this solves is remarkable. It explains why the empirical findings of science so often contrast deeply with the subjective experience of the average person. It explains countless things.

These two states are as different as caterpillars and butterflies. The same organism has two entirely different states of existence in potential. But similarly, not every caterpillar gets to become a butterfly. And never does a butterfly once again become a caterpillar. So it is with us.

Unlike the butterfly, however, in this case we are not talking about a developmental potential. We do not get something we didn't have before, and we do not advance to a 'higher' or 'more sophisticated' state. We lose

something here, we become simpler, and this can occur at any stage of development. It's like recovering from being a leper, you don't necessarily become smarter, you don't get anything. You are simply restored back to being a normal healthy person.

But to see this you have to make an astoundingly dramatic presumption – that the entire world is currently a leper colony. We are all much more sick than we realise, all of us. And that this dis-ease is pretty bad. Which sounds terrible, until you consider that the only thing a cure might be waiting for is – for us to accept this fact and finally bring ourselves to look hard in the mirror. The positive affirmation that 'we are all OK' is exactly the wrong message in this situation, it is exactly what is banishing this one great hope. It is a ridiculous assertion.

So this is the final connection. This is the one thing you have to know about all this, this is the defining threshold. This is the one thing people don't realise. The injunction is only valuable to the degree that it functions to optimally traverse this point. And this threshold, or the tensions which produce it, have never previously been defined in terms that might allow it to be reliably achieved by any typical person. Not ever.

It is also worth noting that this crucial shift does not occur with the final achievement of the injunction, but somewhere along the way. That this threshold and the termination of the injunction are not the same. They are defined in entirely different terms. This shift occurs a long way before that.

The key, then, is to understand what is important about all this, that not all elements of the subversive agenda must be removed for this threshold to be crossed. It is simply that – in committing oneself to progress as defined by the injunction – prior to this energetic tipping point effort and will must be maintained in amounts greater than the tensions confronted, and the release of such effort will see a rapid return to the entrapping bowl. But beyond that point the release of such tension is suddenly felt to be in the direction of further progress, and that the efforts associated become less and less and eventually disappear altogether. A to B via the application of C. At which point (B) everything changes. Not that all has been resolved, but that over time it will be. This peak of tension is both the final answer to all this, as well as the final obstacle. It is what defines the threshold as well as what prevents us from reaching such.

With this we are able to understand exactly where we stand at present. Even at this stage this process will be accessible to an intrepid few. The simple injunction is – I believe time will tell – a breakthrough. And the supporting context is deeper again. With these two we have the target and the arrow defined. Which in itself is probably all we need. But we must, if we are going to make this accessible to everyone, find ways to either lower the tension associated with this transition, or increase their capacity to overcome such with the power of will. Or both. And so understanding this hump is the whole game now.

This hump of emotional tension defines the essence of the successful application of the simple injunction, and without it in mind attempting such is effectively futile. It is the missing piece of the puzzle. It is both the final answer, and the final problem. It is this, therefore, which sets the final framework or foundations for the development and emergence of everything that will come next. Because something is only valuable in this context if it somehow functions to either lower the degree of tension associated with this transition, makes the entire process more efficient, or somehow increases the force of positive motivation available. And there are many such possibilities in this situation, actually. Who knows, maybe we will eventually eliminate all tension associated with this transition.

In time we will no doubt develop clear insight into just what kinds of external support might be applied in order to overcome this internal barrier to freedom. After all, overcoming this hump of tension would appear to be the holy grail, it is the defining question of our time. In my dialogue with people I am invariably spending much more time helping them define and develop exactly what the real question is that they are asking, rather than offering answers, and the surprising thing about this is that by the time they get to the bottom of what they are really asking they generally already know the answer. The answer is always in the question, you just need to unpack it sufficiently. And what we see here is the final question revealed, the answer to which is itself another question, and which sets the playing field up for the final game - one to which we are all invited, not as spectators, but as players.

Where it leaves us, then, is at the boundary of a new frontier, and we are left asking a question, and searching for a solution to this final problem. And I could even offer my own private tour of some of this territory, at least as far as I have explored it. There are many potentials which might be added to this stack to mitigate the tensions associated, increase efficiency or provide emotional leverage to overcome the tensions.

The clear and simple injunction defined here, and the theoretical foundation which supports it are already broadly usable if it is simplified enough. And in the longer form of this section I will offer my own outlines of what I believe all of this will eventually deliver us, or at least some of the things we need to consider or keep in mind as we explore these potentials. At least the ones that I have so far uncovered. And there are quite a few as you will see, some of which may already even be of some use. Foremost amongst which is the active addressing of the more physical and resistant elements of the subversive agendas containment methods. These more entangled and visceral levels are where science becomes art, and where it is put into practical context. And as such it is somewhat open ended in nature, and will continue to develop and be refined over time as more and more insight and feedback emerges. In the end what we see emerging here is a very defined and bounded territory that very few have ever ventured into, and certainly never in any scientific way, but also one that stands to open the floodgates if only we have the courage to do that together. It is an incredible adventure that not only belongs to a brave few who will go there first, but one we can all share in. After all, it is through this treacherous mountain pass that we must all travel at the end of the day, if ever we wish to be truly happy.

Finally, we have ended up standing at the summit here. This is the real question and the true challenge we face. This is the big shed where I spend my time tinkering away. There is lots of interesting stuff to explore here. But what I really want to point you toward is a very much greater potential that has now come within reach.

What any isolated individual can provide you with is nothing compared to what can now emerge in the wake of defining the final question in such robust terms. It can now be shared, and together we can build things no individual could ever achieve.

Collective flowers can only grow in collective soil. And this is no longer just a possibility, but increasingly seems like more of a certainty, so this is what I will take this last bit of time to explain. I need to explain where we now stand in the great scheme of things, and what comes next. But I am not going to explain this so as to present you with a choice. I am simply going to explain it to prepare you, so that you understand the gravity of the events that are about to arise here, and how they very likely cannot now be prevented.

The Keepers of the Flame

Firstly we have to look at where we are now. Of course this potential is not new, it has always been there, waiting to be discovered. Actually, for as long as we have been getting caught in this trap occasionally a few people have been finding their way out of it. I believe evidence of such can be seen right back through history, and in many places even today. But because such has not ever been accompanied by any substantial or appropriate understanding, the results of any individual finding a way free of this trap has never been of much significant consequence. To be wandering in the dark, probably on the verge of insanity, and to stumble blindly off some internal precipice you never even saw coming, is not actually a recipe for wisdom. Not unless you can adequately explain it, or at least pass it on to others.

For lack of a better term, I will call this phenomenon – ‘blind realisation’. An individual can be judged on their own merits, and so this ‘realisation’ must be credited where it has occurred. But a teacher must in the end be judged by their students, and on this score they all seem to fail miserably. In fact very often, whilst an individual finding a way out of this trap may be seen as positive, the social distortions emerging in the wake of such tend to seriously outweigh that positive effect. Making the net effect of such individual realisation, without accompanying understanding, a negative social phenomenon overall. Because without understanding, anyone who does happen upon this potential cannot ever seem to reliably recreate this state in others, most likely because they do not understand the most important things about what it is. Such realisation is thereby prevented from ever becoming a collective event in any way. Blind realisation never actually exposes the reality of what this event is to the possibility of wider scrutiny or further development. Realisation alone, without insight, does not qualify to become a collective phenomenon.

If only we could all experience this shift, the world would be a very different place, but in this case the potential social wave does not propagate. It simply happens once, even quite by accident, and then immediately dies out. And this basic lack of insight is obviously because what it ‘feels like from the inside’ and what it ‘really is’ are two completely different things. The resulting simplicity is just what is left in the wake of the complexity falling away. So with no understanding of that complexity, where it came from, what it was, or where it went, these people have no real way to accurately validate what occurred. And because they are not even aware of the hump

of tension which separates the state they have found from the state their students find themselves caught in, or the very real dangers associated with that piece of subjective territory, they tend to naturally drag those adherents into situations they are simply not prepared for, and which very rarely has any lasting positive effect.

It is actually quite a dangerous thing to do. Which is perhaps why some people have called the state resulting from this kind of blind realisation – ‘divine ignorance’. I’m just not sure about the divine part.

‘Gurus’ and the sort are like the ancient ‘keepers of the flame’ in this sense. They can only exist in a culture of ignorance regarding their craft. They rely on that ignorance.

We might even use another allegorical motif here to demonstrate where we find ourselves at this point in our historical development relative to this potential. There are many we could use, but I will choose fire because it demonstrates the basic pattern of technological emergence and the kinds of social structures which exist at different stages.

It might seem very strange to consider this, but there was a time when so little was known about fire, a time before the average individual was able to even start it, that a rare few individuals were selected and trained in the art of creating, preserving and distributing it. This skill was passed on, in a sacred manner, to subsequent ‘sacred’ individuals. And this functioned to fulfil a vital purpose in those societies, and came with very real responsibilities. But it should also be recognized – this social phenomenon was only possible in the presence of a degree of fundamental ignorance and disempowerment. And that in every such instance where power over a scarce and important resource resides with only a few, certain dynamics emerge. The privilege afforded those individuals, and the social imbalances that might result, are actually based solely on ignorance. And the temptation to subtly support that ignorance, or be corrupted by the power, is immense. After all – what would you trade for fire, if your family was freezing or hungry?

In time I believe we will look back and laugh. This social dynamic, where a ‘mysterious and wonderful’ resource resides in the hands of just a rare few, is where we are presently in our stage of history relative to this ‘realisation’. Far from knowing how to generate this state from scratch, we cannot even presently transmit it effectively. Thousands of candles huddle around a lit candle hoping to be lit, but very few ever are. Very very few.

Madness, pure ignorance, nothing more. And the fervent huddle, the massive social dynamic this ignorance produces, in my opinion causes as much pain as it resolves. It simply amplifies the frustration. And of course, power corrupts. Looking back, one day, we will marvel at how little we knew about something as simple as fire, and how we put up with such ridiculous antics from the ‘keepers’.

Of course, we may also be forced to admit and validate the courage and integrity of the few who have sought to make us aware of this reality in a way that can only be considered noble. We may also discover in due course that one of the most powerful levers we can apply to lower an individual’s accessibility threshold for this realisation is to place them in the direct and engaged company of someone who is already there, and thereby justify quite a few historical methods. The difference, however, will be the application of such within a context of practical and grounded understanding, rather than mystical spiritualism.

The unfortunate result of which, good or bad, is that their universal failure to transmit what they found has rightly led to great scepticism about this potential in general. But all this could be about to change. And it is not for me to say that what I am defining here is the elusive accurate summary of our real situation, that will be for science to decide in time. But if it is, then what I can at least do here is tell you what will inevitably happen next, as a result of this now being so defined.

We live at an exciting time. Because in the wake of even the slightest bit of attention, all of this could be about to change. There is something you need to put in the background here, as we discuss all the collective implications of this individual potential.

There is an important and dynamic relationship between the individual and the collective in this context, one which in this case creates an almost explosive potential. We are approaching a more significant threshold here than you see. Every day we are getting closer to it, and even without the likes of my work here we will inevitably cross this point at some stage. And that point is when, for the first time, the potential all this is pointing toward becomes transmissible between people.

At the moment it is like H5N1 bird flu – it presently can't pass between people, meaning you can presently only get it from birds. And it is possible that bird flu may never make this jump. But I do not believe the same can be said of the potential we are discussing here. In this case we are getting closer to that point every day. And as soon as it reaches this threshold, the very first time it does this, another whole event will begin to unfold.

So at present you could say that this potential is like a virus which cannot easily be transmitted. And so this potential – whenever it occurs – does not spread, even if people are interested in it. Which is quite fortunate in a sense, in that widespread realisation of this potential without any accompanying understanding would probably cause mayhem as it was wildly misinterpreted. There is presently no way we could socially validate or appropriately unpack such an occurrence. But – and which is the point – we would appear to be approaching an inevitable threshold here, quite fast even.

Awareness that there is definitely something there is gaining strong momentum, even if we can't yet see what it is. Evidence Tolle at the top of the NY Times best seller list for so many months. It is already huge, and it hasn't even arrived yet.

What this means is that we are, as a culture, inevitably inching our way forward toward the unleashing of a potential we have not even seen coming. And at some point we will cross that line even if purely by accident. It will at some point occur within a context where it can be passed on directly, from one person to another, in a way that can be reliably repeated.

This appears to be certain. And when this happens, the very first time this happens, it is all over. An epidemic of realisation will follow. An unstoppable wave of emancipation will unravel the whole bundle, the whole ball of string. And if we now gaze back over the previous sections of this work, we can get an idea of just how incredibly massive this shift will be. It will leave the world profoundly changed.

So almost everything we have outlined here can be directly transposed into the collective sphere. On a global scale we see the same essential dynamics being displayed. We see the same essential hump of tension at an energetic level as we seek to restore or realise our known potential. And we confront the same mysterious resistant forces, and ultimately we have to resign ourselves to less idealistic expectations.

It is the common state, just bigger. We struggle to stop ourselves, even when we know our collective actions spell eventual disaster. But what we see here is also another possibility - just as there are two equilibriums for the individual, so there are also two for the world. And just like the individual, they are separated by the same hump of tension, and the threshold this implies. Actually what we see is that they are not different in reality, that the collective hump merely represents the individual one. It is a reflection of the fact that the collective is, in the end, just a bunch of individuals who contain this hump. There is actually no collective hump in a sense, only individual ones.

Which begins to explain a few things about the way people behave, and how societies emerge. Many people have an intuition about a simpler life, and they may even get together to try to live such, but it almost never works. And this is why. Native humanity can do this easily, in fact we don't even have to be told how. It is intrinsic, natural to native humanity in the same way that birds know how to flock, and fish know how to school. We are all capable of living simply and within our means, and of organising ourselves in deeply harmonious ways, ways which intrinsically bypass tension or conflict. And this is because the native state is much lighter than the common state, much simpler, and much more intelligent. It costs much less, and is much happier for it. But to simply try to impose such behaviour on the common state has almost no effect. Because to do so collectively is to directly challenge the subversive agenda in the individuals. Which, as we have seen, is to miss the most important thing to know – that as you head in the direction of true health and restoration of all natural functioning, the subjective effect of this is at first very negative. All you do is end up frustrating the subversive agenda in that case.

Which I believe explains the world as we see it today. In collective terms the coming transition could be seen as directly analogous to the individual one – with the same kind of hump evident. The entire world is, in a sense, stuck in the bowl. And as we approach the point where as a whole we cross some point of no return on our way out of this pit of hell, there will be great tension. And this is because, like the individual, as we gradually restore or increase our collective awareness, we inflame the simmering crisis in the individual and cause collective

pressure. I believe this is exactly what we see today. We stand on the brink of something great, either positive or negative, and what we are feeling is the pressure associated with this hump.

The collective threshold is what, then? What are we pushing towards? As progress advances toward the inevitable, what point must we cross that spells the undoing of it all? Will that collective threshold be crossed when more than half of all individuals on the planet find release from the common state? Or is it when the very last one does? Or is it the very first?

Actually, it is none of these. The true global threshold is actually defined by the point when it becomes effectively inevitable that all people everywhere will eventually be presented with the option to free themselves of this burden in a form that is realistically accessible to them. And what will that point look like? Just like the individual threshold, it will not be significant in itself, in any surface features, it will simply be a turning point in the overall dynamic balance of power between the forces of stasis and the forces of change.

Just so we are clear here, then, what we are discussing is a threshold beyond which the realisation of the individual potential we have been defining in this work becomes eventually inevitable for everyone on the planet.

So what is the answer? What are we looking for? Individual realisation? No, that is useless. Negative even. Even now, even with the injunction and the definition offered here some people will be able to make use of this. It need only be applied without reservation, by anyone serious enough. But what use is that? What use are a few courageous 'realisers' going to be in the bigger picture? This is not what we have been missing.

So what will produce this? What is missing there? We are following it back here, searching for the spark that might light this fire of change.

The final answer is the one thing the subversive agenda has successfully prevented so far, and the one thing it will never survive. Consider the bizarre situation we find ourselves in here: How much pain and suffering does this cause in the world, and in ourselves, every day? How much struggle and confusion throughout our history?

The world today is a powder keg. 6 billion tons of pent up energy. And the only thing which has prevented this rage from pouring forth is the absence of a culprit.

Think about it – the ultimate power to make this potential accessible to the individual can only come from the collective, so its ultimate strength has been residing almost entirely in its extreme concealment, in the mere fact that we have not been able to identify it clearly. Its entire power comes from being hidden from view, and from the scattering of our energies, from our incapacity to either target it, or to do this in any kind of unified manner. We have been left isolated and powerless by its persistent concealment. We simply didn't know where to dig, or what we might find if we did. It has been hiding in plain sight, invisible and therefore out of reach. It has simply outwitted us.

We see here the final hump, then. The final threshold. The only thing that was missing there is the most basic level of understanding about the two agendas. The fallacy is the problem. Having it pointed out immediately allows you to begin to see it, which soon provides more awareness. Until this point is crossed, you see it nowhere. Once you see it, however, you soon see it everywhere. You just need the basic outline clear first.

People sometimes think I am obtuse because I take so long to give them this basic outline, until I give them a recording of what I told them on the first day. It's not that I didn't say it - it's that they didn't hear it. There is an active blindness.

This awareness is the one thing the subversive agenda has acted to completely prevent at a collective level, the very same thing it prevents at the individual level. In this case – collective awareness. And it not only prevents such, it dynamically removes such awareness if ever it arises, producing the backsliding effect of this hump as it is expressed in general culture.

And here we see our final answer, the one thing all this struggle will never survive. This powder keg only ever needed one spark. This dyke was always only waiting for one small hole to appear.

In collective terms, the essential hump is not defined in energetic terms at all, it is defined in terms of information. In particular – the first theoretical definition capable of functionally differentiating the two agendas sufficiently to begin further development of such insight. Like a map for a particularly treacherous bit of territory, at a certain point of capture exploration suddenly becomes possible in a far more secure and reliable manner, meaning that better and more comprehensive maps will also become inevitable over time, in a kind of self-reinforcing loop. And eventually, what was a narrow and rugged path will become a track, then a road, and eventually become a highway.

Think about it: Every advancement in our practical access to fire began first with an increase in our cultural understanding of it. It is cultural understanding, not individual realisation, that will make this potential more accessible. It is cultural understanding that will develop practical methods of achieving such. It is cultural understanding that will ultimately push us past the coming transmission threshold. And it is only cultural understanding that will be capable of appropriately interpreting and explaining the resulting cultural changes.

It is also cultural understanding that will continue beyond that point to make it not only transmissible, but ultimately accessible free of any need for transmission – whereby you will eventually be able to realise this potential without any implied dependence on others whatsoever. The proverbial box of matches.

So is it realisation we have been waiting for? No. Even widespread transmission at this point would only cause more problems than it solved, because we wouldn't know how to deal with it. What is missing? Only the fact that people don't even know it's possible. So what has to happen first?

An understanding wave must precede the realisation wave. The situation is very simple – nobody even knows it is possible. They don't even know it is there.

You might say, at this point, that some people do know it is there. But the few people who do know have no idea what it actually is, or how to share it. And this is my point. In this case, as with so many complex things, the essential kernel of insight necessary to attain a comprehensive grasp of it only emerges beyond a certain point of clarity or completion. Understanding does not always come incrementally in terms of easy progression, but often happens in jumps. These jumps are sometimes called 'paradigm shifts'. And in this case we can see this quite clearly.

This view is completely distinct from other views, even in its most basic outlines or defining features. And because it represents a single basic leap, the details are not the point. At the very first moment someone is able to grasp the essential anatomy of the defining principle, the bubble is burst.

So what will it look like? What spark will begin this fire? In what medium does a wave of understanding propagate? In the information age, what do you think this might look like?

This is the whole point of the approach I have taken here – it will not be realisation that does this. And to prove this I have done this without such. It was not Armstrong who flew to the moon, it was little guys with white coats and short pencils. From the moment it was proven in theory the practice was an inevitable outcome.

It will be information that sets this ball in motion, and it will be information that carries the wave forward. Realisation will follow in the wake of such radiant insight, as surely as fruit falling in the summer heat.

So when do we cross that threshold? The one that ignites the entire wave? It was crossed here in the introduction. We are way over the line here. Even without the injunction or the threshold defined we would be way over the line, but with them we are miles inside it. We only needed one small hole in this dyke, but here we have a hole as big as a house.

The hard work is all done here, we are already on the other side. All we need now is for someone to pick this up and to be able to say it properly, and in a way that people can understand and relate to. But it is basically all here.

In the end widespread transmission without understanding is possible here, this could already happen now. We are heading toward this point regardless. Fortunately however, ignorance and power do not generally coalesce, unless you happen to be from a Texas oil family. But if it did happen, we would need to interpret it will in order

to prevent it being wildly misrepresented – for what it is and what it feels like are two very different things indeed.

The likely outcome here, however, is that understanding this potential well enough to be able to correctly validate and interpret its transmission between people will, before long, produce curiosity that will itself likely cause such transmission to occur. With every bit of further insight we approach the transmission threshold, and we just made an enormous leap in that direction here. You cannot repress the inevitable progress of information, especially when it pertains to such important subject matter. In the end understanding what this potential is will likely be the very thing which provides the conditions for it to socially ignite, and it will do this by beginning a process which will produce an ever increasing and rapidly spiralling cycle of collective development and curiosity.

Paradigm Power

So what is the opposite of collective unawareness? What has been missing here? In particular I should explain how this works, because this is what we are now introducing into this very loaded situation. It is worth knowing exactly what we are talking about here, so that you can recognise and perhaps even support it.

A paradigm provides what has been missing here – the elusive grounds for unity and the application of collective force toward a single definable goal. Its whole power, the only reason it has survived this long, has been due to a complete lack of common awareness. Which has left us with no grounds for unity, no possibility of ganging up on it. It has been divide and conquer.

So what does unity demand? How does awareness manifest, and what does collective awareness take?

Let's say you are emotionally and mentally prepared to embrace a deeper and more robust view of life than the common shallow one, but that the structure of such continually eludes you. You already know or believe something in your heart, you have an intuition, but you just can't find the words. In this case you are simply waiting to be presented with such a view, like a combination to your lock – and when you see it the marriage will be almost instantaneous. Your puzzle will be solved.

As a result of this, let's say you now have a very specific and unusual perspective, one which came packed with profound implications and potentials for great change - both individually and collectively. But let's say this worldview had no real defining features in terms of the way you looked or acted, and that therefore it was impossible to tell if anybody else shared this view with you. Let's also say that this view was sophisticated and deeply divergent to the common view in all its forms, and that explaining this view to most people in even basic outlines would take many hours, and also potentially threaten them emotionally. And let's say you don't like threatening people, or pushing your ideas on anyone, you only want to share your view with others of like mind.

But, in this situation, you could be standing at a party of 100 people, and even if every one of them shared your view, you would never know. The collective power available in such a situation would never be realised because no possibility for unity was available.

So what is the answer to this? There are many. Firstly there is a name. You could define your view, and give it a name, or a symbol, or anything that functioned to point to the deeper view as a whole. A name has great power socially.

If I say Hare Krishna, what do you think of? First of all you think of funny clothes and radical haircuts but deeper than that – what does it tell you about me? A lot. If you tell me you are a Hare Krishna then I immediately know some very deep and important things about you. And not only what you believe. The name is simply a social reference for something deeper, and that deeper thing has a great many things to say about you.

So a published definition is primary, and then a name. Let's say you have a name for your view then, how does that help? It doesn't really, unless you use it – or see it used. It is simply a symbol.

To see this event is to see the single most important thing to see, which is only problematic here because it is also what nobody else is presently able to see by implication. So this whole paradigm is a very distinct and divergent perspective, with deep significance.

- You cannot hold this view unless you are first presented with it.
- You cannot recognise others who hold this view unless they choose to disclose that to you somehow.
- They cannot disclose such to you, and you cannot disclose such to them, unless you either fly a flag that lets people know, or unless you meet in a context which implies such. A flag is a symbol, a social banner that we fly so as to identify each other. A name is similar, but used in conversation instead.
- And your view cannot have a name that others recognise unless it is published and openly available in some form. And a flag only works if the people you want to connect with recognise it.

The other thing a paradigm offers is language. There is no potential for development of shared insight if you cannot talk about it. Language is the bridge that unites.

What we really need, then, is a clear and accessible definition of this whole problem, and for that to be given a name, an associated symbolic form, and to be made freely available somehow. In which case it need only be noticed by a single individual who has at least two friends. Once this happens, it's effectively all over. The seed is sown.

Have you ever tried to talk about all this with anyone?

This essential view I mean, this basic conception of our situation. Of course not if you are reading this for the first time. But even once you have finished this you will find it pretty hard to share, without any meaningful language or common frameworks of understanding, and not even a name for the whole thing. There is currently no foundational paradigm available, no common point of reference to which we might all appeal in dialogue with each other, no basic framework of understanding, no single point from which we all – as cherries – might hang. With such an apex having already been defined, we would suddenly see the possibility of getting together in a way that is both unified and collectively empowered – with a common view, and a common objective. But this has simply not been possible. Until now.

So at the dawn of the information age, what might the final answer look like? What will it take?

It will take a body of information capable of defining the essential platform for the emergence of a spiralling process of collective development. And that body of information will function as a beacon, a focal point for the recognition and realisation of unity. It will simply be a seed, one which contains enough basic information to begin further development of insight, successfully planted in the collective psyche.

In particular, the only thing that has been missing is a defining paradigm, something which captures the essence of this entire event in a way that can be broadly understood. Some things are beyond the gamut of the individual, and lowering the transmission threshold may be one of those things. Which simply means that the key to all this now is collective force. Until now we have been left powerless by the failure of common culture to elucidate this most basic fact of our lives. But such a paradigm would catalyse our collective energy in a way not previously seen. Because a great many people are already primed and ready for this event. With courage they have asked the question, and confronted their own inner wall of pain as a result. But they have not given up. They are frustrated and already openly committed to change at the deepest level, but have up until now simply not had anywhere to direct their energy. The only thing that needed to happen here is for someone, somewhere, to clarify the target. And the power associated with such individual clarity and resolve would be immense. This would be enough no doubt. But that is nothing compared to the significance of all these people getting together.

So a paradigm would also offer a far more important thing – it provides a rudimentary language to allow the beginnings of collective dialogue, and thereby provide the grounds for unity of vision. Until a language exists with which to organise and articulate an idea, then no dialogue is possible. In that case collective force remains latent and forever frustrated. But with language all this changes, and another event begins to unfold.

The new structures which provide this language together also form an integrated whole, which sooner or later find social form in a name or symbol. Which then provides the final piece of the puzzle. It is via the name or symbol that social force is integrated and extended, because such functions as a vehicle of recognition for people of like mind to find each other. Without this nothing would happen. Because the result of the core energetic equilibriums which define these two states being so deep is that no small or isolated surface level events define them. There is no outward sign of it. It is not visible. So even if you knew all this, finding others would be very difficult.

This is not the kind of thing you are encouraged to talk about at parties. So the emergence of a symbolic icon of some kind, which represents the paradigm as a whole, is what has historically allowed people to fly a flag by which others of similar ilk might recognise them. And because it represents such a vast and distinct worldview, then flying such a banner is a means by which, with a single gesture, you can tell someone an incredible amount about yourself.

So language and common frameworks of reference are essential, and whilst social emblems are still valid as a means of identifying each other, in today's world, however, we have other options available to us – such as networking through a common point of reference, like a website for instance. Connection is no longer a problem, once you know what flag you are flying. You no longer need any publicly visible form or recognition.

So what a paradigm provides is power, and unity. It allows us to gang up on this thing for the first time in history. And in this case the vector, the transmission medium which lowers the accessibility threshold, as well as the thing which allows the resulting state to be correctly interpreted and validated, will be some kind of cultural development. It will ultimately become a practice, and likely some kind of practical support, but it will simply begin as a body of information. A blueprint. Because whilst this may be very complex in theory, it is very simple in practice.

This is not rocket science. You can do this at home, or at work, or on the bus, and nobody would even know. Like the first little flying machines to ever get off the ground, at first they will be rough and inventive. But as this theory goes out, and as it develops, there will be people everywhere building these things, and sharing what they are doing with others. And as soon as the first one of these things attains enough lift to get more than a couple of people off the ground, as soon as there is enough heat to get a couple of bits of human corn to pop, the whole thing will ignite. Collective attention will descend on it, and very soon we will lay it bare, and plunder all its secrets. What was once a rare and mysterious phenomenon – like fire once was – will become commonplace and ordinary as it reaches a point where it is readily accessible even without someone else to 'catch it' from.

There is no dependence here, you see, there is no permission required. Science becomes art as you put all this into practice. All we needed for these home built flying machines was a blueprint. We only needed to know it was there.

All of which is completely ludicrous of course, when you see it on paper. It is mad. It is so incredibly fanciful and grandiose that it beggars open scorn. But you will not be laughing as loud when you first begin to see it in practice. Because there is no extinguisher for this fire. That dam will breach suddenly and without warning, and from the very first spark the die will be cast. It will be the biggest news on the planet as the implications are unpacked and they all become concrete in the public mind. Its implications will become indelible as the paradigm unfurls its sails in the full wind of collective awareness.

Follow me back, then, for it has been a very long journey...

- We go from global crisis to the answer being the individual, because the problem is the individual.
- We go from the individual to the answer being an ability to differentiate the two agendas (OIO).
- We go from OIO to the answer being the removal of the subversive agenda.
- We go from the removal of the subversive agenda to the answer being the simple injunction successfully applied. We go from the injunction to the answer being the restoration of energetic integrity.
- We go from the restoration of energetic integrity to the answer being the threshold.
- We go from the threshold to the answer being the tension experienced by consciousness.
- We go from the hump of tension to the answer being lowering tension / supporting will.
- We go from lowering tension / supporting will to the answer being collective development.
- We go from collective development to the answer being collective awareness.
- We go from collective awareness to the answer being a view capable of taking a typical individual beyond the understanding threshold required to theoretically differentiate the two agendas.
- We go from a view capable of taking a typical individual beyond the understanding threshold required to the answer being a view capable of taking a very smart individual beyond the understanding threshold required to theoretically differentiate the two agendas.

- And then we go from a view capable of taking a very smart individual beyond the understanding threshold required to theoretically differentiate the two agendas, to the final answer being...

OIO? Or perhaps you need more??

The answer, as always, is simply in the problem defined correctly. The very first definition of this issue that is clear enough to allow a very smart person to begin to see the subversive agenda in their own lives, even a little, will spark a revolution in time. Especially if they do not have to spend 20 years waiting to talk about it, but if they can do so immediately via an available paradigm.

Or we could go back the other way. It works like this, here is the first domino...

- Presuming this view is basically accurate – what is the unavoidable result of even a little collective awareness of this event, even if most people do what they can to ignore it in the hope that it will simply go away?
- Is it possible for this view to not gain at least some attention over time? I doubt that.
- Is it possible for that attention to not produce positive pressure on the accessibility of the potential it describes? I doubt that.
- Is it possible for such increasing accessibility to not eventually produce this realisation? Given that we already see it now, without such, I doubt that.
- Is it possible for such occurrences – if they are explained in these terms – not to gain significantly more attention as a result, and thereby inevitably produce more insight and collective development? I very seriously doubt that.
- Is it possible that such will not at some point approach and cross the transmission threshold in a few small clusters of people? I doubt that.
- Is it possible that such clusters will not produce further realisation by sheer force of validation? I doubt that.
- Is it possible that such will not gain massive attention and validate of the basic framework as correct, and stimulate massive development in the wake of such as the collective implications become accepted as fact? I doubt that.
- Is it possible that such massive development will not make this transition accessible at a level everyone can manage?

I suppose the last one is possible. All the rest seem out of the question. The last one will simply be defined by the limitations of the situation itself. But one thing is for sure, it is going to be a lot better for you if we have more than one person working on this, and if he wasn't trying to also hold down a full time job. In this case the power for true progress resides in the collective.

So in the third part of this work we saw the dynamic relationship of the two competing agendas, and in particular we saw that the bone these two dogs are scrapping over is free energy – expressed in the human individual as 'free energy and attention', otherwise known as 'feeling'. And what we saw was that free energy is being constantly and unconsciously avoided by the subversive agenda, to the bewilderment and dismay of the conscious persona, because the result is a dynamic limitation on emotional vitality and what we call happiness. And that this avoidance is necessary, because if free energy and attention is allowed to regenerate naturally then a much worse potential becomes not only likely, but inevitable – the emergence of a simmering crisis into a full-blown emotional breakdown. In the end, what we see is that the subversive agenda is performing a vital function, that it is not our enemy. It is keeping us alive, the only cost of which is functional subversion and the loss of happiness. The alternative is much worse. And here we now see this transposed onto the collective at a global scale.

Consider the terms which equate. What is free energy at a global scale? And more importantly, what would happen if it became available in super abundance?

We hear a lot of talk about energy, and the energy crisis, and if only we could figure out a way to achieve 'free energy generation'. Wouldn't that be marvellous, if only we were given 'massive power', for free. But the result of this on the global scale would be exactly the same as on the individual level – massive crisis. Energy in this context would only amplify our problems, not solve them. This is the collective equivalent of pushing the ball

up the infinite ramp of tension as shown in the diagram above. Like the restoration of individual health and wellbeing and integrity, this is exactly what we need, but not before we address the primary causal issue.

So take the diagrams above and look at them again. But this time you might view the question as a global one, and that the small causal factor which generates the ‘negative ramp’ is not the recurrent thought “I”, but the individual and their own conflicted energetic state.

All of the dynamics fit the same pattern, and the answer is the same. And that is this: whilst the causal factor remains, there is simply no point trying to impose a healthy outcome on this system. It is probably already resting in its optimum position, and therefore any disturbance will only cause more crisis of some kind.

Religion is another example. We are looking for life on other planets, with the looming spectre of closing the final chapter on religion in the wake of such. And scientists wring their hands in glee at this thought, without for a moment realising the kind of crisis this would precipitate. You cannot take religion away just like that, not without offering people something to replace it with, any more than you can pry the bottle out of the hand of an alcoholic.

The only way to solve all these problems is to make them obsolete. It is to first of all fulfil the needs which support them, and thereby make them unnecessary, at which point you will not need to do anything more because those downstream issues will then fall away all on their own. So back to the diagram – if you can change that causal factor first, remove it, and only then actively move to restore integrity in the wake of that, then a threshold will eventually be reached – beyond which this whole process will happen all on its own. You will not need to impose any degree of integrity on this global system, because beyond this point such will become automatic and unstoppable. A new individual will immediately begin to define a new global order.

The only thing we needed to begin that process was to know that this potential even exists, that it is even possible. It has simply been hidden from view. And who knows, maybe it is still hidden here if nobody actually understands what I am saying. But sooner or later someone will understand this, and be able to say it better, and in a way that others can grasp. And at that point it will become accessible as a paradigm, and this whole unfolding will finally be underway at last.

So if all this is basically wrong then none of this is worth much. But if it is basically correct, then things will inevitably go like this:



The part inside the blue brackets there will occur ‘in captivity’ so to speak, in special environments, and will cycle back around in these laboratories as many times as necessary in order to reach the transmission threshold for this potential ‘out in the wild’ as it were. And the only missing part has been the red link at the top, which is now well and truly achieved here. After all, if there is anything you don’t understand about any of this, I’m

always happy to explain it to anyone directly, which means that - over time - all of this will eventually be comprehensively mapped out. People would only need to be interested enough to want to know.

So if you are now wondering what you can do, then there is really only one thing to know about that -

Not on your own.

Not on your own - that's the whole point here. The question to the question to the question ultimately leads back to the individual, and to this wall of emotional tension which pushes us back. And the answer to that is not simply bravado or brute force. It is collective force.

The one thing this whole thing has never had, and which it will never survive, is the heat of collective awareness. It's only power, the only reason we have not laid waste to it ages ago, is that we have not even known it was here. We have a million tons of collective anger here, all pent up and waiting to drop on it, but because it has remained so concealed there has been nothing to catalyse that energy into a unified force. Our collective attention has been distracted and diffused. We have not been able to identify the source of all our pain. It has been a case of divide and conquer, that has been its only final power – To keep us apart, and fighting amongst ourselves rather than confronting our true common enemy.

Collectively we could kick its butt a thousand times over before lunch time, but there is not even a hint of it in the collective. It remains in the shadows entirely undetected, preventing the one thing that it could never recover from – collective awareness.

The only thing all this needs now is the **green** link to be made, between Paradigm and Unity. That green link is the proverbial spark in the haystack, all the rest is an automatic chain reaction. And that transition is where we currently stand.

You are about to get exactly what you need here, in the form of a community to share all this with. For the first time ever, in all of recorded history, we are going to be able to gang up on it. We've definitely got it by the tail here, fair and square. We are going to be able to drag it out from the shadows and all sit around talking about it. And that gang is going to get bigger and bigger every day. I'm prepared to believe its days are now seriously numbered.

What is new here, then? What is different? If this is not new, then what value is there in all of this?

What is new are the terms all of this is presented in. These terms define the entire picture in entirely new manner, in a way which directly integrates with a scientific and evolutionary view of the universe as we know it, in a way which articulates the complexities of the common state in detail, and in a way which is finally capable of delivering a context which is able to orient the development of new and practical modalities of change. It is an approach that promises to dismiss much ignorance, and replace it with practical substance.

What we are looking for now is a third path here – the path of understanding.

The two paths we have had up until this point are not working for us. The common path – the path of ignorance – is to remain in the common state, and to be forever bound by the limitations and suffering associated. The alternative path – the path of realisation – is to seek freedom from that state, and to somehow overcome the subversive agenda. But whilst that second option might seem like the obvious choice, it has simply not been available to us. Which does not prevent people from seeking it, it only means such endeavours are very frustrating and somewhat pointless. Leaving both of these paths somewhat unhappy ones.

So what is the third option here? What is the missing piece?

The third path is the answer to this whole riddle. Rather than simply ignoring the subversive agenda and letting it dominate our lives, and rather than seeking to eliminate it, we need only build the bridge between these two states. And that bridge is awareness. Instead of suffering from it, or killing it, we can – with enough awareness – tame it.

In the end it might even be found that understanding this event is a far more significant thing than solving it.

Actually, this is obviously so in that understanding this situation well enough will eventually, inevitably produce realisation of the potential indicated. But on the basis of all the evidence we have of historical realisation, the opposite can apparently not be said. There have perhaps been thousands of people who have realised this potential throughout history, and no apparent progress resulted, but it was probably only ever going to take one who understood it to unlock the whole thing. Thereby starting a chain reaction of development which inevitably makes it available to everyone.

And it has not ever been understood for reasons we can now understand – because it is defined by an energetic transition we have never been able to securely achieve partly because we lacked a clearly defined injunction capable of optimally targeting it, but mostly because that transition itself can only be theoretically supported with a foundational understanding of what this whole process is intending to remove. Which requires the functional and theoretical separation of the two agendas.

This is what we have never had. And without that great complexity sitting in the background, the resulting simplicity makes no sense. We don't even know it is possible, let alone what it might take. So both the injunction and the final definition of the release threshold cannot stand alone – they are both the heavy fruits of a very distinct tree of understanding.

The point is that almost all of its power stems from the fact that nobody – ever – has been able to identify it in this way. Its power comes from being covert, from being hidden in plain sight, and from being so huge that nobody would even suspect to look for it. Its power comes from the complete psychological fusion of the two agendas, and the blinding effect that this has, and is supposed to have - and the fact that common culture has so completely reinforced this.

In particular its power comes from having been able to avoid the potentially devastating impact of collective awareness. And the only thing preventing such has been the absence of a simple catalyst, an orienting framework.

So even at an individual level, even if we could do nothing about it, just knowing can make a huge difference. It explains why so many things we try don't work, and that we really should just relax and not upset it. It is worth knowing when you cannot win a fight.

But that is nothing compared to the collective impact of finally understanding this. The only thing that really needed to happen here was for someone – anyone – to point it out clearly enough, and in terms which might allow further insight to emerge. In which case the collective force of culture, the very thing which has enabled and supported it for so long, will almost immediately become the seat of its undoing. The only difference is that this will be an emerging culture of awareness, rather than an entrenched culture of denial.

A beginning, not an end...

So what will the world look like? How can we imagine what is coming? What will the absence of this vast negative presence leave in its wake?

What you get, when you get this, is not something. It is the absence of something. It is, in the end, nothing at all. Simple freedom – to have the door to your cage unlocked. And so for this simple freedom to be found, and then to sit passively in a cave in India, is completely idiotic and dysfunctional. You are more truly human than that if you remain in the conflicted common state, staggering drunk, but singing, through the crowded market streets. To do nothing with this freedom is to completely miss the point.

In the first part of this work we discovered an outline of what we have lost as a result of the underlying conflict we have now taken time to dissect. We discovered that we don't fully trust ourselves, or follow what we feel without reservation. And now we can see why. The final summary of what we saw there was that the one thing that represents our highest potential is not to be rid of any particular negative presence, but rather the presence of something entirely positive –

Our ability to connect with and achieve a summary ideal, the pinnacle of human achievement.

In particular, to express ourselves fully in a creative sense, through the artful formulation of a full, active, positive and integrated vision of the life we truly and passionately desire, and to be fully committed to that expression – moment to moment – with courage and determination, no matter what.

To simply be yourself is the path. And now, in this sense, we can see that everything else we have uncovered is actually only negative in so far as it erodes or disturbs that defining positive axiom.

What is missing is not sacrifice, it is not altruism, it is not benevolence. Removing the thing that has been preventing us from fulfilling our purpose in life is not actually the fulfilment of our purpose in life, and nor does it guarantee such in any way. It only frees us to begin to do that if we should choose.

What was ultimately taken from us was not just happiness, but art and expression and creative power.

‘Enlightenment’ is not what people imagine it is, it is not an answer in itself. It is not a destination, it is simply an open door. Freedom from the subversive agenda does not give you anything, not if it does not lead to the restoration of what was lost. And what was lost when we fell into this hole? Our true journey of creation and discovery. The answer to life – if there is one – is aware self expression, creative novelty, and irrepressible passion. It is art that we lost, our defining thread of uniqueness, creative self expression as a shout from the heart.

In the end, by producing so much fear and timidity, the subversive agenda simply makes us incredibly boring people. And so, in the end, the restoration of our state does not just mean the elimination of a negative event. It is, rather, only truly by the restoration of the positivity that event stole from us that defines emancipation.

Which is worth knowing, because you do not even need to be free of the subversive event in order to restore this capacity. The elimination of all that obstruction is just a condition of that restoration for most people, because its presence makes a full and open life much harder. But that elimination is not the aim, and should not be the ultimate focus. And this is why I have taken so much time to define this aspect in so much more detail in the small book ‘A Sense of Completion’, it is because this is where we all eventually return.

We have, as a society, lost these patterns, and therefore do not know how to fly – even when we are freed from our cage. In this cage our wings have withered, so this is where our focus must ultimately rest, not at the threshold which defines release from the trap we have been in, but far beyond that in the blue skies of freedom.

The Earth is a garden. Of all the skills we have lost, the deepest and most immediately valuable are gardening skills. All other arts are only secondary to this primary process of engagement with the Earth itself. In establishing and maintaining this elementary and vital connection we come full circle. This is what we have lost in our sanitised subtraction. We could restore the Earth if everything we did was conceived and applied in the context of it being a garden – a single integrated process, where everything matters to everything else. We would not live as we do if we lived and worked in gardens, if our houses were gardens. We cannot return to the jungle now, we are beyond that, but a managed and well modelled garden is basically just that.

This subjective liberation is just a beginning, then, not an end. We must together begin our long journey home toward our own unique and defining expression, and come to see life itself as not only an opportunity for conformity or compromise in the face of an underlying social fabric that is fragmented and difficult to trust. We must move back toward life as art and diversity – a fountain of colour and creation, one that is founded in the restoration of an underlying unity we no longer need to coerce or manipulate. We will then need only to find new ways to express it, but first of all we will need to restore that integrity at its very root. This is the key.

In the restored natural human state the most wonderful thing occurs – that if you simply shut your eyes, and then charge off in whatever direction you feel to be your ultimate depth and passion, when you open your eyes you will find the free and impassioned lives of others effortlessly synchronising with your own. And the more power you unleash, the more such alignment will emerge, which is obviously completely opposite to the common state, where unbridled creative power in any individual only tends to rip great holes in the conformist social fabric of powerlessness and fear.

The new world may be peaceful, but it will not be meek. There will be much more power in the world to come, but it will all be heading in unified directions, effortlessly integrated with the energy of others, like some great improvised symphony of passionate creation. And it is not even an alien thought. This is our natural birthright.

The River

No matter what form it adopts, the common subversion within each of us spills a certain amount of struggle and conflict into our functioning, both internally and externally. Any human collective – be it a small group or an entire global civilization – is like a river into which many tributaries flow. If the tributaries are polluted, then the river will be equally polluted. This is unavoidable. This is why we can't fix our global problems, and also why we would not need to fix them if we addressed this problem in the individual.

So how can we work together in harmony? At present, the only way to create a 'less polluted stream' is to either limit participation in the collective process to 'less polluted individuals' somehow (if such exist), or otherwise impose rules or guidelines etc, and thereby regulate individual behaviour in some way. And regulation, beyond a certain point, obviously doesn't work. If the tributaries are constricted so that certain pollution cannot enter, like a dam, this also often blocks the flow of good clean water as well. This is what we already see in common culture – a whole series of agreed limitations on behaviour and expression.

Conversely, to simply create an environment where everyone can simply 'flow freely', and express whatever they like, is beautiful. This is intuitively right. To remove the dam is obviously correct. But if the problem truly does exist at an individual level, then in simply doing this you cannot expect some miracle to happen. You will not see anything other than a direct collective reflection of the subjective and transactional state of those present, in all its glory. This collective 'free flow' cannot solve the problem of fundamental pollution, if such exists. It only expresses it more fully. There is no way to avoid this.

The typical individual's consciousness is deeply conflicted, and I have explained exactly how. And this conflict has very obvious and direct relational components. Unless people are forced to repress their natural tendencies in some way, in groups their energies will naturally converge to produce an exact measure of their individual consciousness – except this time in collective terms.

Complete relational freedom has been explored many times, with pretty consistent results. That was the Sixties.

On the other hand, one thing has never been considered –

If you can find a way to resolve the subjective conflict which exists at an individual level, or – which is important – even simply agree in principle on the structure and nature of that potential, then a whole new way of relating becomes possible again: a natural and free dance of cooperation and integrity, an upward spirally regenerative event with no real boundaries or necessity for regulation. A self governing event.

This is the human version of fish schooling, or birds flocking, as I say...we don't need to be taught how to do it, it is automatic, innate. This 'truly free' mode of relating has been eroded over time by the presence of the underlying conflict in individual consciousness. And the important thing is that you do not need to solve that problem for this capacity to be restored, you only need to understand it in a way you can share with others.

Such understanding is, therefore, the very seat of our power over it. So raw freedom is right, to simply let go of all the imposed limitations, but it is also only half the answer. Whilst the individual conflict persists, without any awareness, truly regenerative relating is not natural. What you get is simply a relational dynamic that reflects the conflicted state, an exact reflection. So you cannot force or coerce the kind of social dynamic that will emerge in the wake of awareness and understanding. And with the resolution of the underlying conflict such understanding overcomes, the hurdle itself is finally taken down, which is inimitable by virtue of the depth of energetic integrity and alignment it implies.

Only when you see the full nature of the problem, can you subtract it from the common human picture and see what intrinsic and healthy human functioning might look like. And only when you see that can you begin to explore how that might look when expressed collectively.

You see attempts at pure freedom in contexts like Burning Man, but that in and by itself such will simply produce a perfect balance of both agendas, and ultimately take us nowhere. But the removal and relinquishment of the suffocating negative weight of the subversive agenda on awareness will finally liberate the positive and

intrinsic potential which has been so oppressed for so long. Unity is the one thing we have not had, but it is also the one main by-product of this particular endeavour, should we choose to embark on such.

It could be that everyone will eventually be faced with this choice: The very fact of their being two distinct potentials available to each of us has profound implications for society. Because these states form the basis of whatever alignment you may ever find with others. So you have a fundamental choice.

No matter what creation you may choose, your destination must be one of these two states. There is nothing in between, and they are very different. You are either content to remain in the common state, or you are committed to moving beyond it and returning to a simpler and happier existence.

Up until this point you have not had this choice. Up until now your choice has been the common state, or the common state, because no available avenues of change have offered an alternative. But things are about to be very different. There has been no option, the self regulating nature of this event in the individual means that no other options represent true change – they only shift the problem somewhere else. The macro reflects the micro. Until now we simply haven't been able to see what is going on in the individual to produce this effect. But now we know, we can see how dynamic it is, and how incredibly resistant to change it is. There is simply no way to correct a collective imbalance that is coming from the individuals which make up that collective, without somehow regulating those individuals. We have no choice, if we want to be free, we have to resolve this in the individual. And to do that, we have to first restore our lost unity by sharing an understanding that this is even possible.

Which leaves us back at the beginning. This transition is not the end, it is just the beginning. Do your dream. Life is for living. The answer to the game is not to end the game, it is to play it. And the ultimate move in any game is one which changes the rules of the game in your own favour. In the common state the game is rigged, and winning is not possible no matter how well you play. So there is only one option, for you, and for the world.

This is not a spiritual awakening. It is only to once again become naturally human, pure and simple with all the inherited baggage that implies. It is to vanquish the delusion at the very root of the entire spiritual quest.

The problem with the world, then – is you. You just didn't realise. And so the answer is the same – it is you. And this does not now mean that great sacrifice is required on your part as you may imagine. Quite the contrary.

We have been duped. The ordinary and everyday emotional fulfilment possible in the free native state far surpasses even the highest potentials of the common state. There is no comparison. What you have been looking for was already there, you only need to claim it. Which is all just so many flowery words, of course, but what we are talking about here is not some intellectual level insight, it is a fully felt whole body experience. And beyond all else, it is an experience that will inevitably become available to anyone here, as soon as just a few of the right people get together to unpack all of this in practically applicable terms. We always had the ingredient, and now we have the recipe, so the only thing we need now is to get together and cook it.

Follow what you feel?

In this work we have so far mostly been viewing this transition from the perspective of energetic integrity, but we can also simply examine what it feels like. Which I have avoided precisely because it is so overwhelmingly distracting. The reason the relinquishment of this complex is permanent is because the common state is all about managing thwarted attachment, it is all about not feeling what you really want, or trying not to feel the results of not getting that. But in the transition to the native state all the scattered birds of attachment are unified in a single great love, and that love is completely free. It is everything, for nothing. That's what it feels like. It is the exact equivalent of all addictive highs in a single fulfilment which cannot be lost, and which costs nothing.

We need only work together to make this potential more easily accessible, and that will likely happen now regardless. The only choice now is perhaps this –

Sooner, or later?

So what can you do now? What does the future look like, and what will it all cost? The subversive agenda is an immensely complex and dynamic event, with so many potential forms it is impossible to easily quantify, but

occasionally I refer to it as having about five major obvious forms. But you can take it further than this, you can boil it down to only three.

Actually, you could boil it down to only one – suffering. Which is a bit meaningless. But at the level of only three, the greatest addictions on the planet are these – unawareness, poverty and fatigue.

These three things are its food, its strength, and its source of power over us. It just can't get enough of these three things. Therefore the answer is simple: awareness, energy and money. Put these three things in the direction of this potential, and join others in doing so, and you will change the world. Probably very quickly. You will ignite a very real wave of quiet change that will leave another kind of civilization in its wake.

The political solutions to the problems we are facing will simply be unnecessary in that case, because the problems they are seeking to solve will have been undone at their final source. Not to mention your own personal state having been restored to its full and open potential.

Very soon we will know how to light a fire on our own, with no help. Very soon the thing we now call 'spiritual enlightenment' will be easy, entirely commonplace. And it will have another name, one which befits its actual significance. It is not what most people believe it is, not even close. But what must now come first is understanding, then transmission, the first and perhaps last sustainable event spiral of this nature in a now global information culture.

It can only happen once. First in a small pocket, and then again, and then a flash point will be reached. A cascade of awakening will breach every fortress wall, light every darkened corner. You cannot burn a barn down twice.

Personal charisma will not achieve this. No bearer of the flame will carry this wave of realisation. It is beyond that. It is, in fact, the end of such people in our culture. They will be immediately redundant, and we will soon forget they ever existed.

Only information will carry this revolution, not personality. Simply a deeper knowledge of fire, that's all we need now. People have been trying to achieve this potential for millennia. But it's time for an update. Whatever can't make it into the new order, translated and reinvented in contemporary rational terms, will be discarded as obsolete and erroneous. We are going to need to drop the tatty old maps, because if it doesn't show up in the satellite images, it's probably not there.

People everywhere will help to ignite this coming wave if they can recognize and embrace the emerging paradigm as it reaches this threshold. And I am certainly not claiming to have achieved this here, it is only to say that the potential exists, and that sooner or later someone will ignite some kind of collective exploration in robust enough terms to allow for a spiral of development to occur. Maybe it will be you who does that!

In any case, it is an entirely new chassis for civilization as we know it. And it is probably coming soon. Things are about to get a whole lot better, and in ways we didn't even know were possible. Most people won't even see it coming, let alone need to contribute in any significant way. It is only going to take a few to do the heavy lifting for everyone else, so nobody else even really needs to know about all of this. At least not beforehand.

How can we save the planet, then? How can I be happy?

We usually presume that these questions are at opposite ends of the selfishness-benevolence spectrum. But what if both these questions had exactly the same answer? What might that be worth?

Gurus can only exist in a culture of pain, teachers can only exist in a culture of ignorance. In our lifetime, we will live to see the last Guru. And not because what they are touting is not real, quite the contrary. The difference will be the emergence of cultural understanding, the lifting of the veil, and the inevitable outcome that this potential will – like fire – soon become effectively free.

This tipping point is almost here, that's what it means. And with that, it could be that the sun is once again about to rise on humanity. It will be like waking up from some collective nightmare, into a bright new day.

EPILOGUE

The Greatest Gift

The problem with the idea I have sought to outline in this work is that it is simply too big to easily grasp – not only in terms of its complexity, but also its significance. It is just too big. There is so much more to it than what I have outlined here, I really haven't done it justice with this brief sketch. I can only hope that some of it made sense.

Together we are facing tremendously challenging issues as a planet, such as overpopulation and global warming. And we don't seem to have any answers. But we might have been looking at the whole thing backwards.

The answer lies with the individual, and that there are so many individuals. In particular, a potential exists for each person that results in a state which allows us to consume significantly less over time, and without effort - a much simpler state, and a much happier one.

It is difficult to achieve this shift at present, because it means confronting our deepest fears, but it exists nevertheless. It has simply never been noticed, not in terms that matter. It has not been noticed that whilst our fears are real, they are not founded in the actual reality of our situation. We imagine them into existence, and then try to imagine our way out of the resulting trap instead of simply undoing the original mistake at its root.

What it all means is currently beyond common understanding, even that this potential exists, which means nobody has even examined how close we might be to making this potential widely available.

When you understand what this disturbing activity is, and exactly what falls away in such a case, and especially why it exists and does what it does, then what might be done about it becomes obvious. It is a uniquely human problem. The way we conceptualise our own sense of being, and our place in the universe, is unique to us.

We have unknowingly imagined a serious emotional problem into existence by the way we frame our own particular sense of self. Which is not ever something we are being, it is merely something we are doing. And as a result of trying to keep a lid on this smouldering crisis in all of us, our entire culture has become a denial structure, it is a collective effort to avoid the very thing we have been defining. But we are also ready for this like never before. The only thing that has prevented this is that we did not even know it was there.

The existentially aware minority in the world is ready for this. People are ready now, searching, prepared, so it could even be that it is only going to take one small hole in the dyke.

Maps before journeys, however. Understanding must precede the transmission of the potential all this indicates. This idea – maybe not in the form you see it here because I probably don't say it well, but when someone does say it well – means the first bit of interest from the first well connected person will generate an unstoppable wave of development as collective attention descends on this with its full weight of awareness.

In particular, the true significance of what we see emerging here is not even defined so much by the scope and gravity of it all, but the terms in which it is being rendered. Instead of the fuzzy and slippery language we normally see applied to all things subjective – not only by spiritualized approaches, but also by much psychology – what we see are definitions of functional anatomy that can and will be articulated in the language of mathematics. We see systems theory and structural dynamics, and a burgeoning model that lands far more squarely in the field of engineering than it does in the philosophy department.

What this means is that it provides grounds for unity and integrated development. It means that all of this is no longer beyond the reach of those who have the unique ability to open it all up – and who were actually always the only ones who could. It means it is entirely open to science - hence the title of this book. All that remains now is to see whether or not scientists are up to the challenge.

Of course, everything outlined here will be ignored as ridiculous at first, if only because its implications are just too great. But that will only be until we begin to see the first practical applications, or until detailed models

begin to demonstrate the accuracy of the framework as a whole. Especially, once transmission of that big individual potential begins to occur, and science validates it as real and reasonable, it will eventually produce a singular and vast convulsion which will spell the end of many things we have presumed to be permanent features of human civilization. Including religion, perhaps even war.

This can't be stopped if these outlines are broadly correct. It is simply coming in that case. Once this paradigm is rendered in a form that is accessible to an ordinary intelligent person, in a way they understand and can apply, that's it. You can't stop ordinary people from doing this, not if it is directly accessible to them, even at home. So it's a hand-made revolution in the making, and it will probably be over before anyone in power even sees it coming.

In the end it may well turn out that we are not a bad species – but that we were simply riddled with unnecessary angst. This state is a terrible experience for us subjectively, but it also has dramatic outward effects on the ways we behave, and on our environment.

Some people believe that human beings are greedy and lacking in conscience, but this is not so. We are simply struggling with an enemy we cannot even see – a struggle that can be brought to an end with enough courage and insight. I believe it is time to come of age in this sense. We are the emerging intelligence of this beautiful planet, we must reconnect with the body and serve it. For in serving it, we serve ourselves. But it is almost as if this beautiful baby of human imagination is being born with the cord around its neck, and that a very particular manoeuvre is now going to be required in order to spell the difference between disaster and an emerging utopia.

Removing the underlying negativity allows the lost positive to naturally re-emerge. And here we return back to what we discovered earlier, and the life of your dreams. With the return of the heart our compass is once again awakened, and we can begin to ask the question again with trust and faith in our own nature – what do I really want? We restore our navigation systems, and our creative engines come back on line. And there is one thing that everyone who truly asks that question eventually comes across, if they are to ever answer it.

It is the most simple and abiding realisation, and perhaps the most profound one there is. And it is as simple as this – it is better to give than to receive. Not for any altruistic reasons, but even only from a purely selfish and enclosed perspective.

It simply feels better. It feels better to engage people on the basis of a belief in reciprocal dynamics, than it does to engage people from an opportunistic or predatory stance. And so, sooner or later, as we restore our own depth and connection to ourselves, we gain this singular and almost unavoidable economising of all possible options set before us – which is that whatever it is we are looking for, it is not something that we will get, but ultimately something we will give.

This immediately halves our confusion, and doubles our power. Until you have at least reached this elementary point, you have not even begun to ask this question. In which we see the final insult – the subversive agenda ultimately steals our creative power, the crown of which is our own unique and defining gift to the world.

Do you feel powerless in life? That we are out of control?

I hope that if you got nothing else out of this work, that you got this one thing: that it is within the power of each of us to save the world, and save ourselves. It starts right here, right where we are, with the courage to confront our own inner demons. And, with support and understanding, to strategically outwit and defeat them.

Life within the common state could be likened to a dream, in that the same imaginary identity is in evidence, creating a context of emotionally charged events, devoid of actual substance. In the common state, this whole drama is overlaid upon the reality of life, adding illusory significance to things which actually have little or even none. Like a dream.

Thus 'I' do not awake from this dream. 'I' is, in fact, the dream from which we awaken.

So there is another whole world laid right before us, if only we could see. It is already here, right now. We simply need to look through different eyes, through the innocent eyes of a child. That innocence is available, it can be restored – even permanently – in the adult state.

As the Buddha said - "This very world, the lotus land of paradise"

Existence feels good when you participate in it fully. When you pull back, you create suffering. And it is natural, in response to the resulting suffering, to pull back even further, but can you see where this leads? This is clearly not the answer.

We must surrender into life. Which does not mean that we stop thinking clearly. Quite the contrary, this can only truly occur in the wake of profound insight and clarity. But the whole prospect of embracing surrender as a path does confront us with a more fundamental issue – is existence OK? Can we trust it to take us where we want to be?

We doubt. We don't want to let go. But this is just the common state. This experience is our unique exception, not the universal rule. It is natural in the deluded common state to imagine that all is not well with life. In our own self generated panic we externalise our fear. So in the transition to the native state, the fear is that if you let go you will not maintain that freedom, that you will fall back. Meaning that we have lost our basic trust in existence itself. This is the common state. But in the very same way, to experience the native state, free of conflict and artificial restriction, is to realise that everything is actually OK, just as it is.

We fall in love with our own true nature, and the marriage is consummated in bliss. Once again we naturally extend our own inner state to the way we see the rest of the cosmos. And then, just as clearly, it becomes obvious beyond all doubt – all is OK.

You can likely never know who you truly are ultimately, any more than a wave can comprehend the ocean. The spiritual search is pointless. All you can know for sure is surrender, and in surrender to simply BE who you truly are.

In some strange and paradoxical way, all we can finally hold onto is letting go. All that can be got, is not-getting. Simply because all else is effort. So it comes down to this –

Can existence be trusted? And the answer is this – Do we really have a choice?

You are not the victim of a greater process. You ARE that process, you simply do not feel that because you have contracted back from life.

In the end, hope is fading as the realities of our current heading begin to indicate an increasingly bleak future for us all. But there is an option, and it starts right here, with you alone.

When you boil it all down, this is where it leaves us at the end of the day, this is the unavoidable and final truth –

Human unhappiness is a hunger that is consuming the world. Meaning that, ultimately, the only real or significant gift you can ever offer the world is your own true, deep and lasting happiness. It is the only final answer, and it also lies clearly within our reach now, if we choose to open all this up together, and bridge this gap.

This is not an intellectual transformation. It is a permanent and radical physical change. Beyond that point new rules will apply – because if the individual changes, then this changes everything. What will be found there is an ability to surrender fully to the process of existence, in a way that does not simply dissipate, but which becomes stronger and deeper with every moment. Even now you can find it, if only momentarily. Breathe and relax. Feel.

But here is the real point of all of this - It is not only that we might all find that place where we can finally let go into life, and restore our trust in existence itself, but that this possibility is about to become directly accessible and in a very reliable sense. For everyone. Everywhere. And in the wake of that, certain things will inevitably become clear, not only intellectually, but as directly felt realities.

Mind, in all its forms, is ultimately illusion. The cosmos is okay. That there is nowhere else to go, because you are already home. We will all come to trust existence with our entire being, and know that who we truly are has, in all likelihood, always been safe here.

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